



The Manipur conflict could pose a threat to national security if left untamed, INDIA's 21-member team tells governor Anusuiya Uikey even as Congress's Vivek Tankha lavishes praise on her and urges the BJP leadership to impose Central rule in the strife-torn state **Flap Opp**

A 16-year-old Indian-origin boy was ambushed and stabbed on his birthday along with two of his friends in an unprovoked attack while they were playing basketball in Melbourne **P 13**

China accuses US of turning Taiwan into an 'ammunition depot' after the White House announces a \$345m military aid package for Taipei, and the self-ruled island says it tracked 6 Chinese warships in waters off its shores **P 13**

President Vladimir Putin says an African peace plan floats a series of possible steps to defuse the conflict, including a Russian troop pullback, but that a fresh Ukrainian offensive has made it hard to realise **P 13**

Part of vacant Bandra bldg falls

A portion of an unoccupied 12-storey building on Carter Road in Bandra collapsed Sunday morning. No injuries were reported. The skeleton of the unfinished building has been lying abandoned for several years now. **P 2**

Man stabs wife on Khar street

A 30-year-old man stabbed his wife in the neck after a fight on a Khar street Sunday night and fled. The woman has survived the attack and is hospitalised. Police said the couple, residents of the Dharavi belt, have been going through a matrimonial dispute. **P 2**

3 processionists electrocuted in Raj

Three youths were electrocuted when they came in contact with a high-tension wire on their way to the burial of tazia in Rajasthan's Dholpur on Sunday, taking the toll across four states to 11 in the last 36 hours. **P 10**



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Times Interact | P 6 & 8

Wet July turns 10% national rain deficit into 6% excess

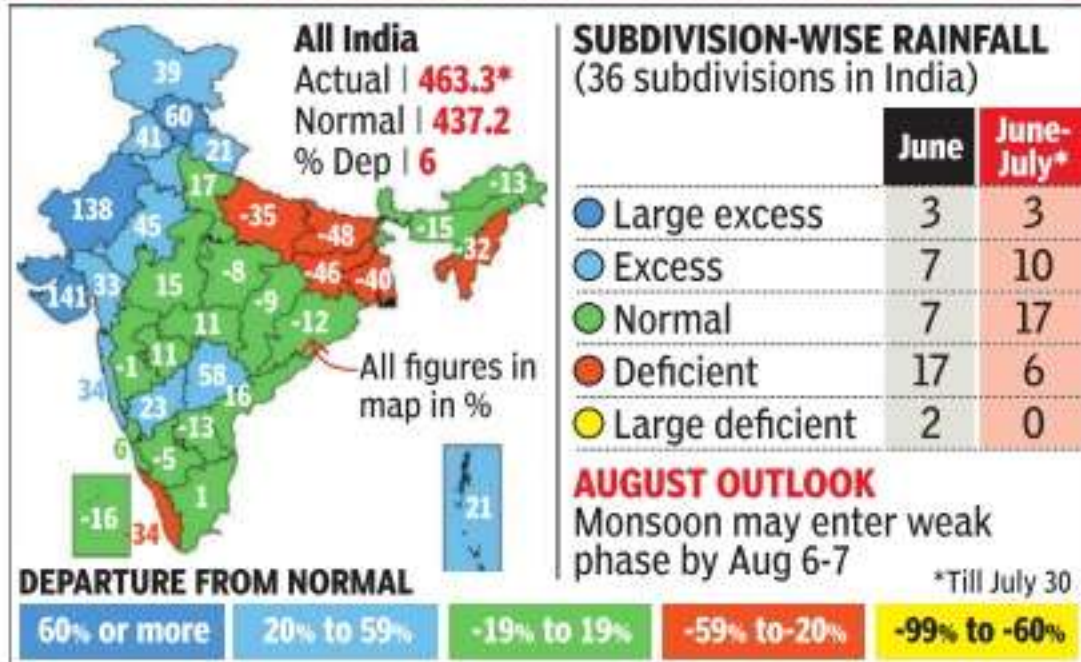
After Active Run, Monsoon Enters 'Weak Phase'

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New Delhi: Exceeding expectations, the monsoon in the crucial month of July has been around 15% higher than normal, pulling countrywide rainfall in the season from a 10% deficit in June-end to 6% above normal by end of this month. This was thanks to an unusually long run of active monsoon conditions that has lasted nearly 35 days.

However, this spell appears to be coming to an end and the monsoon is likely to enter a weak phase by August 5-6, a top India Meteorological Department official said. Alrea-

DEFICIT SUBDIVISIONS DOWN FROM 19 TO 6



dy, rainfall activity in southern and many parts of central India has reduced, leading to daily nationwide rain figures dropping below normal in the past two days. Despite continuing fears of a strengthening El Niño impacting rains in India in the second half of the season (August-September), the long wet spell has raised hopes that this year's monsoon could end up in the normal range (96% to 104% of the long period average), as forecast by IMD. The active phase began around June 24, and 24 of the next 34 days (till July 28) saw above normal daily rainfall in the country.

Relief from heavy showers for city

After a week of intense rain in Mumbai, Sunday saw very little rain. IMD's Colaba observatory recorded 1mm during 8.30am-8.30pm while Santacruz recorded 3.3mm. The IMD, in its five-day forecast, said light to moderate rain is likely on July 31-August 1. For Wednesday, it has issued a yellow alert forecasting heavy rainfall at isolated places. **TNN**

During this unusually long active period—aided by favourable phases of an eastward moving equatorial storm system called Madden-Julian Oscillation—large rain deficits in southern and central India were wiped out.

► **El Niño remains a worry, P 9**

PM: Varanasi tourist figures top 10cr level, a big boost to economy

New Delhi: Tourist footfall in Varanasi have crossed 10 crore a year, heralding not only a "cultural renaissance", but also creating a cascading effect across the temple town's economy and generating significant employment for the poor; PM Modi said on Sunday.

PM announces drive to honour martyrs, P 10

In his 'Mann Ki Baat', Modi said, "The number of devotees visiting Ayodhya, Mathura and Ujjain is also increasing rapidly. All these are the result of our collective cultural awakening. Now, people from all over the world are thronging our pilgrimage sites for 'darshan'." **TNN**

► **Tourism income up, P 10**

TOI, JULY 11, 2023

Calligraphy turns women of Mana, Niti into entrepreneurs

TOI was among the first to highlight how women in Mana, regarded as the last village before the India-China border in Uttarakhand, began using calligraphy on bhoj-patras

Modi lauds women for biz of calligraphy

In his 'Mann Ki Baat', the PM lauded the women of Mana for commercialising calligraphy on bhoj-patra (birch bark), calling the effort a means of "preserving our tradition" and furthering "economic progress". **P 10**

State info chief post vacant since Feb: CM

The posts of chief information commissioner and three information commissioners (out of the total 7) have been vacant, CM Shinde informed the legislative council last week, adding that the government issued advertisements inviting applications for the posts in February and scrutiny of applications was under way. In a reply to a question, the CM also said over 1 lakh second appeals were pending before the state information commission as of May, reports Chaitanya Marpakwar. **P 5**

J&K soldier home for Eid feared abducted by terrorists

Srinagar: A soldier from the Army's 3 J&K Light Infantry, Javid Ahmad Wani, has been reported missing since Saturday evening from his native village of Asthal in south Kashmir's Kulgam district, triggering suspicion of a possible abduction by terrorists, reports Saleem Pandit.

► **Post selfies with tiranga: J&K admin to officials, P 10**

Wani (25), who is posted in Ladakh, had been on leave at his home since June 29 to celebrate Eid ul Azha with his family. His plan was to fly back to Leh Sunday and resume duty Monday. He disappeared after



Wani was to fly back to Leh on Sunday & resume duty Monday

he went at 7.30pm to Chawalgam village in an Alto car to buy groceries and mutton.

► **Let him go: Mom, P 9**

AirAsia suspends staffer over gov's missed flight

Three days after an AirAsia India's Hyderabad-bound flight took off before Karnataka governor Thawar Chand Gehlot could board it at Bengaluru, the airline's station manager at Kempegowda International Airport, Zico Soares, has been suspended for a month. Two more staffers are likely to be suspended, ahead of a scheduled meeting of AirAsia officials in the governor's office on Monday. The officials will explain to Gehlot or his team the situation that led to him missing the flight as well as the action taken. **P 6**

Probe: 70% of city's street furniture items overpriced

Mumbai: The BMC-appointed committee set up to probe alleged irregularities in the Rs 263-crore street furniture works has found that nine of the 13 items did not have standard rates. The investigation also found that the rates of the nine items had been fixed by getting estimates from urban planners, and most of them were overpriced compared to the BMC's schedule of rates of similar items.

Earlier this month, the BMC had ordered the probe and issued orders to stop work and payment to the contractor—Shantinath Roadways—on directions of

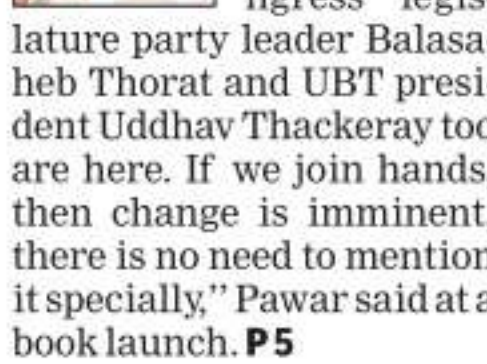
CM Eknath Shinde after three MLAs—Mihir Kotecha from BJP, Aaditya Thackeray of Shiv Sena (UBT) and Rais Shaikh from Samajwadi Party—alleged a scam in the street furniture contract.

"Nine out of 13 street furniture items were fair items, which means they were not part of the BMC's schedule of rates," said a civic official. In May, Thackeray had written to governor Ramesh Bais urging him to instruct the state government for a Lokayukta inquiry. Chaitanya Marpakwar reports.

► **Probe halts purchase, P 2**

Pawar: Change imminent once MVA allies unite

Breaking his silence on the current political situation, NCP president Sharad Pawar said on Sunday that once NCP, Shiv Sena and Congress decide, then change is imminent. "I am here, Congress legislature party leader Balasaheb Thorat and UBT president Uddhav Thackeray too are here. If we join hands, then change is imminent, there is no need to mention it specially," Pawar said at a book launch. **P 5**



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SUNRISE

Tuesday: 06:15 hrs

SUNSET

Monday: 19:17hrs

Relative humidity:

Colaba

84%

Santacruz

86%

FOR LIVE UPDATE

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BMC probe halts purchase of ₹263cr worth street furniture

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Mumbai: A probe by a committee appointed by the BMC into the alleged Rs 263 crore street furniture scam has found that nine out of the 13 items were overpriced.

"The rates for pigmented concrete finish sandblasted cylindrical and square seats, pigmented concrete finish cylindrical dustbins, pigmented concrete finish square tree grates, rectangular glass fibre reinforced polymer flower pots/planters and glass fibre reinforced polymer benches rates seem to be extremely high even after negotiating with the contractor," said a civic official.

Officials said only a fraction of the street furniture items have been purchased. Shiv Sena (UBT) leader Aaditya Thackeray had written to governor Ramesh Bais urging him to instruct the state government for a Lokayukta inquiry into the scam.

"There needs to be a fair inquiry, transparency and accountability towards MLAs and most importantly, clarity on whether it has been scrapped or kept on hold by BMC. The inquiry ordered by the government is vague and inadequate," Thackeray said. "I have also asked

INQUIRY VAGUE, INADEQUATE: AADITYA

► BMC awards contract to buy and install street furniture worth ₹263 crore across the city to Shantinath Roadways

► Of the 13 street furniture items, only 4 are standard items, including benches and railings, rates for which had already been fixed by BMC

► Rates for other 9 items fixed on the basis of estimates given by urban planners and designers

THE 13 STREET FURNITURE ITEMS AND THEIR COST

Price for each piece

Pigmented concrete finish sandblasted seats

► 2,913 cylindrical seats • ₹19,520

► 2,773 square seats • ₹18,440

Pigmented concrete finish tree grates

► 6,867 square grates • ₹12,800

► 4,132 circular grates • ₹12,750



Total ₹263cr

Glass fibre reinforced polymer flower pots/planters

► 3,719 rectangular planters • ₹82,490

► 4,165 rectangular planters • ₹95,990

► 2,851 circular planters • ₹72,990

Glass fibre reinforced composite bollards

► 9,722 900mm-high bollards • ₹17,561

► 2,430 600mm-high bollards • ₹14,471

► 38,922 glass fibre reinforced composite railings for footpaths • ₹25,017

► 1,717 glass fibre reinforced polymer benches • ₹10,7990

► 3,067 pigmented concrete finish cylindrical dustbins • ₹26,390

► 2,215 40-litre stainless steel grade bins • ₹11,213

the governor to direct BMC to furnish me with the documents I have sought regarding this scam...the payment already made to the contractor must be recovered and no further work orders must be given."

In his reply to Thackeray, BMC's deputy municipal commissioner Harshad Kale, who handled the tender, denied irregularities and said

that the work order was issued on March 23, and work started on April 1.

BJP's Mihir Kotecha, who had first raised the issue in February, had said in the legislative assembly that the government had decided to scrap the contract. But Chahal had told TOI that following instructions from chief minister Eknath Shinde, BMC set up an inquiry

committee which will submit its report in a month. "Once the report is received, a decision on whether or not to scrap the contract will be taken. For now, additional municipal commissioner Sudhakar Shinde has ordered to stop issuance of work orders, stop payments, not install the items received and stop further supply of the items," Chahal had said.

120 residents evacuated from 8-storey Mumbra bldg

Thane: As many as 120 residents from 25 flats of an eight-storey building in Mumbra were evacuated after locals complained of structural damage on Sunday afternoon, officials said.

Yasin Tadv, chief at the regional disaster management cell, Thane, said the corporation was alerted by residents of major damage to a ground floor pillar in the C-wing of Zoha society in Almas Colony. A team rushed to the spot and noticed the cracks, following which the residents were evacuated and the structure was sealed.

"The building is barely 20 years old and was not part of the 'dangerous' structures classified by the corporation ahead of the monsoon. However, as a precaution, families staying in around 25 flats were evacuated. The rest 18 flats and two commercial units were locked. Power and water supply has been cut. The residents claimed they made their alternative accommodation arrangements," he said.

Officials said there are three mobile towers installed atop the building and the residents have been asked to remove them, following which its stability will be analysed.—Manoj Badgeri

Part of unoccupied multi-storey building collapses at Carter Rd

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Mumbai: A portion of an unoccupied multi-storey building on Carter Road in Bandra West collapsed at around 7.30am on Sunday. The skeleton of the unfinished building has been lying abandoned for several years now. Following the collapse, the road leading to Sherly Village was closed, inconveniencing residents. Locals pointed out that though no injuries were reported, it could have been disastrous, had the incident happened at any other time or any other day as a primary school is operating adjoining the building. According to a board in the compound, the building is owned by National Building Corporation.

"The St Francis Xavier School is next to the building. Primary school children could have been hurt in the incident. Parts of the building, which are about 40 years old, had fallen in the compound and on the road earlier too. Subsequently, the builder put a net," said Debbie Fernandes, a resident of Sherly Village.

Former corporator Asif Zakaria said "The building has been in a dilapidated condition for many years. I was told that the building was supposedly sealed due to some FSI and property record violations. Neighbours have complained about parts of the building falling earlier too. The BMC should have taken some precautionary measures. If



The skeleton of the unfinished building has been lying abandoned for years

Minor and two others injured in separate incidents of wall collapse

Mumbai: Three persons including a minor were injured in two separate incidents of wall collapse in Deonar and Chembur on Saturday. While the two injured in the Deonar wall collapse were treated and discharged, the minor has been admitted to Rajawadi Hospital and is said to be stable. In the first incident, Ganesh Kamble (12), suffered injuries after a part of the wall on the first floor of a ground plus one storey structure, in Chembur (West), collapsed. In the second incident, two persons including a woman, were injured, when a portion of the wall on the first floor of a ground plus one storey structure, in Suhasini Chal of Deonar, collapsed. TNN

the building is in the C-1 category, then it should be pulled down in order to safeguard life and property in the vicinity." H-West Ward officer Vinay-

ak Vispute was not available for comment.

Executive engineer Milind Kadam did not respond to phone calls.

AMID TORRENTIAL RAIN, STATE GOVT IN DAMAGE-CONTROL MODE



The pothole-ridden Village Road at Dattamandir junction in Bhandup on Sunday

CM hits road again, draws cheers as well as sneers

Ambarish Mishra

Mumbai: For a chief minister, Eknath Sambhaji Shinde has the roadie's passion for travel; he invariably makes his way to the spot to rap errant officials, dispense quick justice and distribute aid to the needy.

Critics dismiss his sojourns as grand roadshows aimed at garnering votes and hogging the limelight. A section of the bureaucracy thinks the CM away from his work as a policymaker is not a good idea as critical matters of state can suffer. However, such criticism hardly bothers the feisty Thane trooper. His snow-white Toyota-Lexus is on the move, rain or sunshine.

Shinde has maintained that his absence from the state secretariat has in no way affected his official duties. "I read and sign urgent files even when I am travelling," he said at a party workers' conclave recently.

Last week, Shinde scrambled up a hill to reach Irshal-

wadi—a remote and hilly tribal hamlet in Raigad district, which was buried under a massive landslide that killed over 80 villagers. Early this month he had similarly rushed to Buldhana, with deputy CM Devendra Fadnis in tow, following a bus accident on the Samruddhi highway in which 25 passengers were charred to death. This Sunday, he was inspecting the Thane-Nashik highway.

Political experts said the former Shiv Sainik views his role as a CM through the prism of the Shiv Sena's rough-and-ready brand of politics, which requires contact with the masses and meeting out instant justice. Shinde has styled himself as the antithesis to Uddhav Thackeray who drew criticism for restricting public interactions and limiting access to a chosen few.

"Actually, Shinde functions more like a 'karyakarta' who abhors the executive, and its 'fatwas' and government gazettes," said political

commentator Vishwas Sohoni on Sunday.

"Shinde's voyages could well be part of a PR strategy but it seems to be working. He has been gathering eyeballs and that matters a lot. Last week, images of Shinde stepping into a murky nullah in a Mumbai suburb were flickering on the television screen all through the day," said Ahok Dhamanaskar, a former official who has witnessed the tenure of seven CMs in Mantralaya.

He likened Shinde to Sharad Pawar who, after the 1995 serial blasts in Mumbai, presided over a meeting of BMC, MTNL and police officials right under the damaged Bombay Stock Exchange building in south Mumbai on a muggy afternoon.

"Politicians often find bureaucracy and its paraphernalia cumbersome. With the next election breathing down their neck, they are eager to expedite the government machinery and assure voters that they are doing something," said Sohoni.

Shinde travels on route to Nashik, asks for quick fix

Thane: CM Eknath Shinde on Sunday morning inspected the Kharegaon-Padgha stretch and Khadavli Phata on Mumbai-Nashik highway and other roads in Thane and instructed the district administration to undertake immediate remedial measures like filling up potholes using the latest technology and plugging all accident-prone spots like illegal cuts in dividers.

"We are working on building temporary truck bays along highways where heavy vehicles can park during traffic congestion so that priority can be given to city



motorists," Shinde said. Traffic wardens will be deployed on the affected stretches and service roads will be developed. Shinde was accompanied by officials from the MMRDA, MSRTC, NHAI, PWD among others.

Of late Thane has witnessed heavy rainfall resulting in potholed roads, prompting Shinde to set up a task force to resolve the issue. Questioning the poor quality of roads despite the CM's promise of a pothole-free Thane before monsoon, NCP spokesperson C Crasto asked what action has been taken against erring officials and whether Shinde's road inspection was "too late". —Manoj Badgeri

Cops want special PP to try suspect in student's 'murder'

Say There's Only Circumstantial Proof & Last-Seen Theory

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Mumbai: With only circumstantial evidence and the last-seen theory to rely on in the alleged mysterious murder of MBBS student Swadichcha Sane, the city crime branch has proposed to appoint special public prosecutor Ashwini Raykar on the case.

Sources said crime branch officials decided to propose Raykar's name looking at the cases she has represented where she managed to get convictions. "This is not a simple case as due to delayed investigations, the accused got ample time to prepare and legally defend themselves, and hence, after scrutinising and evaluating evidence collected in the case, we have proposed to the law and judi-

ciary wing to appoint PP Raykar. The accused have taken advantage of doubts. We wanted a senior, experienced person who could present the case properly and get a conviction. After discussion, Raykar's name was suggested," said an officer.

A dedicated special PP will pursue the case, ensure witnesses are protected, establish the last-seen theory, join the dots with corroborative evidence and get a conviction, added a police officer.

The main accused, Mithu Singh, already enjoys the benefit of doubt. Initially, it was believed he was the last person to see her alive. He had taken a selfie with her. Singh had claimed that despite his warnings, Swadichcha stepped down on the rocks on

the Bandra waterfront and he feared she had been washed away. Later, after admitting to the murder in police custody and leading investigators to the spot where he allegedly dumped Swadichcha's body in the sea, he retracted his statement. Mithu Singh ran a food stall at Bandstand.

Swadichcha, a resident of Palghar, was pursuing third year MBBS from Grant Medical College. On November 29, 2021, she left home at 5.30am; when she didn't turn up in college, a friend Sadaf called up her family. Her brother Sanskar Sane lodged a complaint with Boisar police. Her last mobile location was Bandstand. Bandra police registered a kidnapping case and the case was later transferred to the crime branch.

Close shave for 45 passengers as bus on fire

Thane: Alert staff ensured around 45 passengers travelling in a Thane Municipal Transport (TMT) bus were evacuated after the vehicle suddenly caught fire early on Sunday, officials said.

While the driver Anand More complained of minor breathlessness while trying to firefight till rescuers arrived, conductor Chandrakant Naik guided passengers to safely exit, alight from the rear door as the engine cover went up in flames within minutes. More was shifted to a local hospital and discharged after treatment, a TMT official told TOI.

"The incident occurred around 8.30am when the bus had crossed Central Maidan and was on the way to Chendani Koliwada from Narpoli," said Yasin Tadv, in-charge at the Thane regional disaster management cell. —Manoj Badgeri

SHY MOUSE DEER SPOTTED IN RAIGAD



A rarely spotted mouse deer was rescued from Mangaon township at Raigad last week. A very shy animal, the female mouse deer, which weighed around 4kg, was spotted hiding amid logs of wood at a sawmill left many confused, yet surprised. A local, Krishna Gandhi, had alerted wildlife lover Shantanu Kuveskar who with the help of his colleague Shubhankar Vanarase caged the mouse deer before alerting forest officials. Kuveskar said it could have scampered out due to flooding. Forest officer Aniruddha Dhage said many mouse deer exist in the forest area some 4 km away from the market. It was later released into the wild. — Umesh K Parida

'Bogus' path labs grow, state 'ignores' issue, say docs

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Mumbai: Public health minister Tanaji Sawant has once again sidestepped deciding on how to address the issue of 'bogus' laboratories in the state, said pathologists.

The presence of numerous laboratories in the state operated by technicians without any pathologist on board, despite Indian Medical Council Act 1956 mandating that diagnostic reports be certified by qualified pathologists, has been a contentious matter. Also, there is no need for registration, which means anyone can start a laboratory without proper qualification or supervi-

PATHOLOGIST ON BOARD IS A MUST

The issue

► State pathologists body says illegal laboratories are mushrooming

► As per law, a qualified pathologist must sign all path reports. So, labs should not function without one

► However, "illegal/bogus" labs are operated by technicians without qualified pathologists on board



sion. To address these issues, the state had formed a 17-member panel in 2021—a third such over years—to frame rules to register new laboratories and their overall regulation. The

panel submitted its report in 2022, reportedly recommending that the state explore the possibility of including pathology labs under the ambit of Bombay Nursing Home Act. However, the committee re-

port is yet to be acted on by the public health department.

During the ongoing assembly session, in response to questions about action taken on the panel's recommendation, Sawant provided a written reply stating they are awaiting additional information from the panel. However, sources said the minister had given a similar response at the assembly session in March, without any clarity on what specific additional information the department was waiting for.

"It is absolutely clear that the state government doesn't want to act against illegal laboratories," said Dr Sandeep Yadav, president of Maharashtra Association of Practising Pat-

hologists and Microbiologists (MAPPM). The association's data indicates that the state has an estimated 13,000 laboratories, with 8,000 lacking a qualified pathologist on board. Dr Prasad Kulkarni of MAPPM said 80% of such laboratories are in urban areas.

The demand to eradicate illegal labs has been present for years, but it gained momentum after an activist in Sangli staged an expose alleging his diagnostic report was from a lab operated by a technician. This led to calls for a survey of labs in the district and even an order to shut down those without pathologists. However, the lobby of technicians allegedly approached local politi-

cal leaders and overturned the order. Dr Yadav said that subsequent meetings with Sawant remained unproductive.

Sawant, in his written response, said there was no law for registration of laboratories, but technicians are registered through the Maharashtra Paramedical Council Act, 2011 and these councils have the authority to take action. However, Dr Kulkarni said the paramedical council has been dissolved as the National Commission for Allied and Healthcare Professions (NCAHP) Act, 2021 is in the process of coming into effect. Also, the paramedical council has not taken any action against erring labs in the past.

Thane to get its 1st cancer hospital within two years

Thane would soon boast of an advanced cancer treatment hospital, CM Eknath Shinde announced on Sunday. The facility will mostly be operative within two years and is likely to provide relief to patients and their relatives who till now had no option in the public sector but to travel to Mumbai or Navi Mumbai, civic officials said. The hospital is being jointly developed by the Thane corporation, Tata Memorial Centre and Jain International Trade Organisation. Spread over 1 lakh sq ft, it will have 600 beds along with associated facilities, including OPD and day care centres. The charges are likely to be on a par with Tata Hospital. Proton beam therapy will be available at affordable rates. "Cancer is a silent killer. The hospital was the need of the hour and once operative will be beneficial for the entire state. This structure was earlier designed as an incubation centre and later modified to accommodate a 1,200-bed Covid hospital," Shinde said, following the ground-breaking ceremony of Dharmaveer Anand Dighe Cancer Hospital by RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat and spiritual leader Deepakbhai Desai in Saket. Dy CM Devendra Fadnis expressed concerns about "alarming" cancer projections for 2035. "Cancer not only affects the patient but impacts his entire family," he said. —Manoj Badgeri ► Also see P4

Employee, friend held with stolen laptops

Mumbai: A 19-year-old employee of an electronic shop from South Mumbai, who stole 20 laptops worth Rs10 lakh from his employer's shop and connived with his friend, who in turn tried to sell them to his employer, were arrested after the employer tallied his inventory and found the serial number of the laptop belonged to his stock.

Alok Pardeshi (19) and his friend Ronit (20) were arrested by Tardeo police after his employee Ganpatraaj Jain caught Ronit redhanded when he came to sell them to Jain on Saturday. Jain, who runs Yogesh Computers at Lamington Road in South Mumbai, said on July 28 while his employee informed him that a person had come to sell a laptop, Jain reached the shop and checked the laptop and its serial number.

"Jain tallied it with his inventory and was shocked to find the serial number of the laptop matched with his invoices. He kept the deal on hold and checked the CCTV footage and found the laptop was stolen by Alok, when he used to open the shop," said an officer. — **A Ahmed Ali**

Cargo worker held for purse theft at airport

Mumbai: A cargo worker at Mumbai International Airport was booked by Sahar police for stealing the purse of a female visitor. An FIR was lodged on the basis of a statement from a security supervisor at the airport. On July 11, a woman arrived at Chhatrapati Shivaji International Airport's Terminal 2 to pick up her father who was arriving in a New Delhi-Mumbai flight. After she met him, the duo arrived at the P-6 parking around 1.50pm. The woman discovered her purse was missing from the trolley. She reported the incident to security personnel and sought to view CCTV footage of the premises. **TNN**

College complains of plagiarism; two institutes say sorry to NAAC, 'let off'

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Mumbai: A Chembur-based teacher training college, which was recently accredited by the National Assessment and Accreditation Council (NAAC) in the fourth cycle, was shocked to find that two other institutes had submitted identical self-study reports (SSR). When it raised an alarm about its report being "plagiarised", the nation's assessment body merely closed the cases after accepting a "doddering" excuse of a "technical glitch" from the institutes.

An SSR is like a statement of purpose — it highlights the college's core strengths in academics, infrastructure, staff and students, its achievements, research carried out, laurels won, as well as a roadmap of its grand plans and how it plans to achieve them.

ATS confirms drone, Chabad House image seizure from suspects

Pune: The state anti-terrorism squad (ATS) officials confirmed on Sunday that they have seized, among other things, a drone, images of Chabad House and Colaba area and some locations in Pune besides 500 GB data from the phones and a pen drive of the two members of the ISIS-inspired Sufa group arrested in Pune on July 18.

TOI in its Sunday edition had reported about the seizure, which the ATS has confirmed.

Earlier, the city police, who made the arrests before the ATS took over the probe, had only confirmed recovery of parts of the drone during a search at the duo's rented flat at Meethanagar in Kondhwa.

The data from the phones and the pen drive is being thoroughly examined, the officials said. They have recovered books, videos of a particular individual and PDF files which are suspected to be meant for indoctrination of people,

IIT-B warns its students not to crack casteist or sexist jokes

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Mumbai: IIT-Bombay has issued guidelines aimed at ending discrimination among students based on their caste. "Each hostel and department/centre, too, have had posters from various cells. This year, the content from various cells' posters/orientations, in the context of anti-discrimination, has been compiled into one poster and is being circulated for both new and existing students," said a spokesperson for the institute.

The guidelines state that the institute considers it inappropriate to ask a fellow student about their birth/admission category, as it could lead to conscious or subconscious bias. "It is equally inappropriate for students to ask others about their JEE ranks/GATE scores... While the student asking the question may feel it is innocent and it may be driven purely by curiosity, asking the question may have an adverse impact on the other student..." mentioned the guideline.

The institute went a step further and urged students to introduce, interact, or bond over commonalities such as

'BOND OVER MUSIC, CITY INSTEAD'

Dos & Don'ts Of The Guidelines

- Inappropriate to ask a fellow student about birth/admission category
- Introduction, interaction, bonding of friends should happen through commonalities like department, sports, music, movies, schools, hobbies and cities
- It is prohibited to exchange/forward messages, including jokes, that are abusive, hateful, casteist, sexist, exhibit bigotry, or ones that can be construed as harassment or bullying
- Students should be polite and sensitive towards others' feelings



Measures taken to reduce academic stress

- No branch change option at the end of first year to reduce unnecessary pressure over students
- Early exit option at the end of third year with a BSc (engineering) degree
- Reducing total number of credits in both semesters in the first year
- Students will be graded at the end of the first semester instead of mid-semester grades

department, sports, music, movies, school, college, village, town or hobbies. The guidelines prohibit students from exchanging or forwarding hateful, casteist messages or jokes or the ones that exhibit bigotry based on religion or sexual orientation or those that can be construed as harassment or bullying. It also prohibits students from posting such messages on online forums, such as WhatsApp, Facebook, e-mail.

The administration warned

students of severe punishment in case of violations of rules and added that politeness and sensitivity towards others' feelings is expected from all. The guidelines mentioned that the institute implements the reservation policy under the Constitution in letter and in spirit, and strives to provide equal opportunities to all admitted students.

The institute has stepped up its initiatives to curb caste discrimination on the campus, said a student, hoping that it would make a difference. Another student affiliated to the Ambedkar Periyar Phule Study Circle said a leaflet was circulated even last year with certain guidelines, but they were not so explicit.

Last year's leaflet spoke about caste discrimination in general and mentioned what it comprises, including ridiculing and taunting students who have availed reservation, mocking at students for their JEE ranks and labelling them as undeserving, less meritorious or using caste slurs, etc, along with a list of dos and don'ts. But it did not direct students against asking each other their JEE ranks.

Diagnostic scan racket: Another ward boy arrested

Ahmed.Ali@timesgroup.com

Mumbai: The Bhoiwada police probing the diagnostic scan racket at the Tata Memorial Hospital have arrested another ward boy who allegedly connived with private centres and referred patients to these labs for a commission.

Police on Friday arrested Dinesh Ramchandran Mohite (27) on charges of cheating, forgery, breach of trust and criminal conspiracy. Mohite, who was produced before the local court, was remanded to police custody till August 4. He is the 13th accused to be arrested in the case so far. Police are looking for another 8 to 10 people, including diagnostic centre's employees/owners. Police said most of the arrested are ward boys working for the hospital, and only one manager of Infinity Medical Centre, Sanjay Sonawane, has been arrested.

Though the accused have been running the racket hand in glove with private diagnostic centres for a while now, the scam came to light recently after senior TMH officials learnt about it.



Film producer buys 3 Pali Hill flats for ₹103cr

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Mumbai: In a big-ticket deal, film producer and director Dinesh Vijan of 'Street' fame has booked three apartments in an under-construction skyscraper at Pali Hill, Bandra, for Rs 103 crore.

The Nargis Dutt Road building is coming up as part of a society redevelopment project undertaken by Mumbai-based developer Rustomjee. Parishram Society (now renamed Rustomjee Parishram) is one of several old buildings in Pali Hill being redeveloped into ultra-luxury apartment blocks.

According to IndexTap.com, the transaction was registered on July 25 and a stamp duty of Rs 6.2 crore was paid by the buyer. The three apartments are spread over a built-up area of 9,000 sq ft (7,791 sq ft carpet). When completed, the tower will stand 20 storeys high.

The deal is the latest among several property transactions involving people from the film industry. In June, actor Karthik Aryaan purchased a 1,916 sq ft apartment in Juhu for Rs 17.5 crore. Last year, actor Ranveer Singh bought a sea-facing Bandra Bandstand quadplex for Rs 119 crore.

The city's lucrative real estate market has always been a safe haven for Bollywood bigwigs to invest their millions and buy marquee properties. TOI had earlier reported that Salman Khan's family planned to build a hotel on a prime, sea-facing plot at Carter Road, Bandra.

Actor Hrithik Roshan and his father Rakesh are big investors in the city's property market, picking up

The deal is the latest among several property transactions involving people from the film industry

Teen killed after car falls off bridge, 4 hurt in 2nd mishap

Kalyan: A 14-year-old boy from Kalyan died after the car in which he was travelling with his family fell off a bridge near Malshej ghat, near Kalyan, in Thane district, on Sunday. His parents and three other relatives who were also in the car escaped with minor injuries. In another accident, four men from Nashik were injured after their car overturned, also near Malshej ghat.

The boy and his family had gone for a day's outing to Kalu waterfall. As their car was passing over a bridge, the driver lost control and the vehicle flipped over and veered off the road, landing in a gorge about 25 feet below. The boy, Harshavardhan Wagh, a class 9 student, had sustained serious injuries. He was taken to the primary health centre where doctors declared him 'brought dead'.

The teenager's father was driving when the mishap took place, said assistant inspector of Kinbhavali police station, Sachin Kulkarni.

In the other accident, four youths who had come to Malshej ghat sustained injuries after their vehicle flipped over. They suffered minor injuries and were taken to hospital, said police sub-inspector Sachin Sansare.

Malshej ghat is a popular tourist attraction due to its beautiful surroundings. Many picnickers from Mumbai, Thane, Nashik and Pune visit the place. — **Pradeep Gupta**

Man takes friend to shop for wedding, is arrested for rape

Ahmed.Ali@timesgroup.com

Mumbai: A 25-year-old man from Beed district who befriended a woman in Mumbai and, under the pretext of going for her wedding shopping, took her to a lodge in Dadar has been arrested for allegedly raping her and then filming the act. He forced her to marry him and when she got married to the man of her choice, he sent the intimate pictures to her husband.

The Gamdevi police have arrested Sumit Santosh Maske and booked him for rape, threat and blackmail.

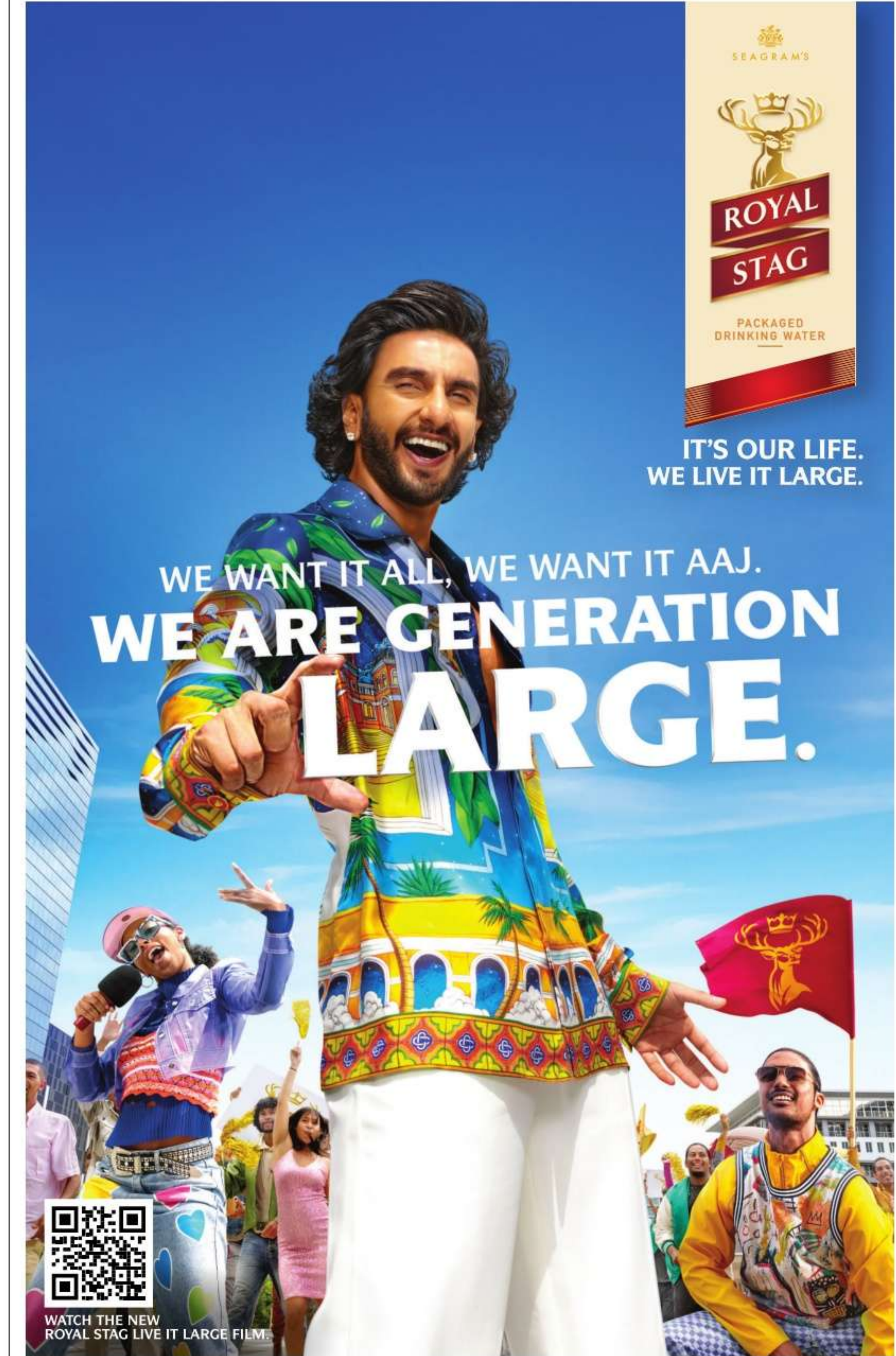
The complainant said she narrated her ordeal to her husband when the accused sent those objectionable visuals to her husband.

The woman had got introduced to Maske through social media and they chatted on phone. When she

came to Mumbai to stay at her uncle's house, he too came to Mumbai and they spent time with each other as friends. The woman's family had asked her to stay away from Maske.

In June last year, the woman told Maske that she was to marry in May this year. She even told Maske that she was going to Mumbai to shop for the wedding function. Maske told her that he was in Mumbai and would like to meet her. On March 10, Maske told her he knows places to shop for the wedding ceremony and could help her get her some good wedding sarees, but instead took her to a lodge and raped her and took pictures and videos of the act.

Now, days after her wedding, the woman's family members received the photos. The police then arrested Maske from Beed.



CITYLIGHTS

Bird Savior

Breathing life into an almost-dying creature can be soul-satisfying. Navi Mumbai resident Sarvesh Benkar (23) agrees hands down. He recently spotted a fallow-looking young egret fledgling fallen on a street in Sanpada while returning from the gym. The commercial artist gently scooped up the bird and took it home, hoping against hope that he could save it, but unsure it would make it. "I wanted to do whatever I could for it to survive," he says. He took it home, fed it some water and after some internet-searching plied the bird with a boiled egg. The famished creature, still lying down and looking feeble, pecked at the egg. Tummy full and well-energised, it showed signs of



LONG LINE OF UMBRELLAS: Commuters wait for autorickshaws outside Andheri station last week

springing back to life and exhibited traces of energy, says Sarvesh. Though it was late evening, he took the bird all the way to Thane CPCA, a veterinary facility. By the time he

handed the bird over to the vet, it seemed to have come back to life, Sarvesh said, adding: "Yes, breathing life into an almost-dying baby gives much joy."

Musical Milestone

Bhajan and ghazal singer Anup Jalota who turned 70 on July 29 said reaching this important milestone gave him

the feeling of being more energised than ever. Jalota who began singing when he was all of 7, reached Mumbai from Lucknow at 20. His father was bhajan legend Purshotam Das Jalota, who had sung even before Mahatma Gandhi. "I owe a lot to Mumbai which has given me so much. God has been kind to endear me to people and I have got more than what I asked for," said the globe-trotting artist who flew into the city from Delhi where he had landed from the US last week. He was about to catch a flight to Mumbai when he was told that Prime Minister Narendra Modi wanted to speak to him. "The PM invited me to the inauguration function of the International Exhibition-cum-Convention Centre (IECC) complex at Pragati Maidan," said Jalota. Among the best performances of his career so far, he said, was the one in 1985 when he had toured America and Can-

ada with ghazal maestros Mehdi Hasan and Ghulam Ali. "Sharing stage with them was like touching the stars."

Monsoon Trouble

The recent downpour led to a disruption of train services and unending traffic snarls. Among the many photographs on commuter strife that went viral was a picture posted by a civic activist. It was of a road pockmarked with potholes of varied sizes. He called it a work of modern art: "Art gallery address 15th Road Bandra and viewing timings 24x7". Then there was a viral clip of commuters trying to board an AC local with the automatic doors unable to shut until some stepped out while others were squeezed inside.

(Contributed by Alex Fernandes, Mohammed Wajiduddin & Somit Sen. Compiled by Rucha Chitrodia)

Bhide on Gandhi: BJP leaders' silence is telling, says Chavan

Abhijeet Patil@timesgroup.com

Kolhapur: An employee from Congress leader Prithviraj Chavan's office lodged a police complaint on Sunday after a threatening mail was received earlier in the day. "The one-line mail abused and questioned Chavan whether he wanted to stay alive or not," an officer from Karad city police said. "We have sent our teams to nab the sender..." Satara superintendent of police Sam-eer Shaikh told TOI, but did not get into the specifics of the locations.

legislature. Congress has launched a state-wide protest against Bhide who runs the right-wing outfit Shiv Pratishthan Hindustan over his remarks.

Chavan told TOI, "The police are taking necessary action... However, the silence of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and top leaders of BJP is telling. We all know who killed Mahatma Gandhi, and they now want to erase him from the memory of people. When BJP leaders say they have nothing to do with Bhide, why are they not condemning the attempts made to denigrate him [Gandhi] in such a way?"

Deputy chief minister Devendra Fadnis has condemned Bhide's statements and said police will take appropriate action. Meanwhile, hundreds of Bhide supporters from Sangli gathered and poured milk on Bhide's photo, claiming he has said what some authors have written.



Sena UBT leader moves HC over gov nominees on legislative council

Mumbai: Shiv Sena (UBT) leader Sunil Modi has filed a public interest litigation before the Bombay high court over governor's nominees on the legislative council. "It will come up for hearing before a division bench presided over by Chief Justice Devendra Kumar Upadhyay on July 31," Modi said.

Nashik businessman Ratan Luth had filed a special leave petition before the Supreme Court over the failure of the then governor B S Koshiyari to fill up 12 MLC posts despite a 2020 recommendation made by the then chief minister Uddhav Thackeray's council of ministers. While Luth withdrew his petition, Modi filed an intervention application, saying his petition should be considered as the original application.

On July 11, the SC allowed Luth to withdraw his special leave petition, while Modi was granted permission to move the appropriate court for redressal of his grievance. Accordingly, Modi filed a public interest litigation before the Bombay high court.

According to reports, with the Supreme Court lifting its stay on appointing 12 MLCs to the state legislative council from the governor's quota last week, the Shinde-Fadnis-Ajit government is likely to send fresh names to Governor Ramesh Bais for nomination. Sources said a 6-3-3 formula has been finalised under which the BJP will get six MLCs, the Shiv Sena three and Ajit Pawar's NCP faction will get three.

12-year-old dies from snake bite after being sent to four hospitals

Umesh K Parida

Navi Mumbai: In a case of alleged negligence by government health staff, a 12-year-old girl from Jite village died due to a snake bite after being taken to four hospitals.

Locals in Pen, Raigad held a protest after Sara Thakur's death, alleging delay in treatment. The girl was shifted from the primary healthcare centre in Jite to the sub-district hospital-Pen, then to a private hospital in Pen, back to SDH-Pen, and then the civil hospital in Alibaug before ending up at MGM hospital in Kamothe for treatment. Activists alleged that she died due to lack of anti-



Raigad residents took to the streets to protest the apathy of civic hospitals

snake venom (ASV) injections in both government and private hospitals across the district as well as ambulance services. However, a civil surgeon refuted allegations of unavailability of ASV. Dr Ambadas Devmane, the Raigad district civil surgeon, said, "21 ASV vials were administered to her. The

girl died due to a delay in administering the ASV in a suspected case of a cobra bite. The delay was caused at the primary health centre and subsequently at SDH-Pen to some extent as the newly appointed doctor did not know the correct medical procedure for a case like this. She referred the patient to a pri-

private hospital." Sara was bitten by a venomous snake around 1:30am on Wednesday. The family rushed her in an auto to the PHC in Jite. The doctor was unavailable and had switched off his mobile phone. No ambulance was available to transport the girl, said her family. She was taken to SDH-Pen where the doctor referred her to Dr Mahajan Private Hospital for an expert opinion. However, she was referred back to SDH-Pen. Around one and a half hours of crucial time was wasted. She was then sent to the civil hospital in Alibaug by a private ambulance and was put on ventilator support and was to be sent to MGM Hospital in a cardiac ambulance but it was not available. Sara breathed her last at around 9am after reaching MGM hospital.

India can be world leader if citizens are united: RSS chief

Thane: Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) chief Mohan Bhagwat lauded the united efforts taken by the country to combat Covid and urged countrymen to maintain the same union to take the country to become the world leader in the next 25 years.

Bhagwat was addressing a motley group at a function in Thane where he spoke about the potential of the country to lead the world. "During the pandemic, everyone — from the business community to

doctors and others — worked in tandem and assured common man that there was someone to take care. This helped us sail through the crisis, while in contrast, many countries witnessed mayhem... We achieved independence 75 years back and nothing will stop us now from being the world leader by the time we turn 100," he said.

Bhagwat stressed on need for good education and healthcare facilities and urged for better cancer treatment facilities in state. —Manoj Badgeri

Potholed Bhiwandi road triggers a row, troubled neta takes the train

The Eknath Shinde-Devendra Fadnis-Ajit Pawar government woke up only after Congress legislature party leader Bala-saheb Thorat and Samajwadi party legislator Rishi Shaikh brought to the notice of the legislative assembly that for several months, travel from Mumbai to Bhiwandi has been a nightmare. Against the travel time of one or one and half hours, it now takes at least five to six hours to reach owing to potholes and absence of traffic personnel.

The maintenance of the road was entrusted to the Maharashtra State Road Development Corporation (MSRDC), which was till recently headed by CM Eknath

Shinde. A fortnight ago, the responsibility of MSRDC was entrusted to senior Shiv Sena leader Dada Bhuse. Incidentally, Bhuse is a resident of Malegaon, which requires him to travel frequently to his hometown via Bhiwandi. NCP leader and cabinet mem-

ber Chhagan Bhujbal, a resident of Nashik, also takes the same route. However, when Bhujbal found out that it now takes this long to reach Nashik by road, he changed his mode of transport. These days, he travels by train. Alarmed by growing criticism over the

state of Bhiwandi bypass, the CM has himself swung into action and ordered to fill all potholes in a time-bound period.

When MLA's exposé backfired: Shrirur-Haveli NCP legislator Ashok Pawar is facing a piquant situation. A week ago in the legislative assembly, Pawar had raised an issue of rampant irregularities and corruption in a Zilla Parishad school in his constituency. Unexpectedly, Pawar's statement backfired. Villagers not only condemned his statement, but even threatened to ban his entry in the village. A resolution to that effect was passed in the village and in parents' meeting. Pawar had informed the house that

the school headmaster and two outsiders were collecting Rs 25,000 to Rs 35,000 for admission, and that the school management has not given statement of accounts under the CSR funds to the Pune Zilla Parishad chief executive officer. The contention of the school management and parents was that Pawar's statement had defamed the school, which was declared a model school in 2018. Following a complaint lodged by him, block development officer conducted a probe, which confirmed that the then headmaster and two outsiders did collect donations for admission. Subsequently, the headmaster was suspended and later reinstated.

SBFI
Stressed Assets Resolution Group (SARG), Corporate Centre,
21st Floor, Maker Tower 'E', Cuffe Parade, Mumbai-400 005.
REQUEST FOR EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)
EOIs are invited from Insolvency Professionals registered with IBBI for
empanelment with SBI for handling IBC matters. For details on eligibility,
other terms & conditions, please visit our website <https://bank.sbi/under-sbi-in-the-news-empanelment-of-vendors>. Interested Insolvency
Professional may apply in prescribed format and completed EOI must be
delivered to the address mentioned in EOI format on or before, date:
11.08.2023 by 5:00 p.m.
Place: Mumbai **Sd/-**
Date: 31.07.2023 **Deputy General Manager(NCLT)**

Notice Inviting Expression of Interest (RIL/E&P/EOI/2023/02) (Under International Competitive Bidding) For KG-DWN-98/3 (KG-D6) Block

Reliance is India's largest private sector company, with a consolidated revenue of ₹976,524 crore (\$118.8 billion) and net profit of ₹74,088 crore (\$9.0 billion) for the year ended March 31, 2023. Reliance's activities span hydrocarbon exploration and production, petroleum refining and marketing, petrochemicals, advanced materials and composites, renewables (solar and hydrogen), retail and digital services. Currently ranking 104th, Reliance is the largest private sector company from India to feature in Fortune's Global 500 list of "World's Largest Companies" for 2022.

Reliance Industries Limited (RIL), as Operator, on behalf of itself & its co-venturer BP Exploration (Alpha) Limited invites Expression of Interest (EOI) from reputed and experienced Contractors for 'Design and Supply of steel tube umbilicals including technical support during installation and commissioning' for KG-DWN-98/3 (KG-D6) Block.

Interested Vendors are requested to visit our website www.ril.com (eB2B) For Suppliers> E&P Notice for EOI) for further details on the above and submit their EOI through e-mail on deveoirresponse.eandp@ril.com on or before **21 August 2023**. Subject of the mail should mention "RIL/E&P/EOI/2023/02". For documents size beyond 10 MB, Vendors should request RIL through e-mail to provide FTP link for uploading EOI documents.

Address for Communication

Chief – Supply Chain Management,
Reliance Industries Limited, Petroleum Business (E&P),
Reliance Corporate Park (RCP),
Building No 11, 'A' Wing, Second Floor,
Thane-Belapur Road, Gansoli, Navi Mumbai - 400 701, India.
Email: deveoirresponse.eandp@ril.com
CIN: L17110MH1973PLC019786



GUJARAT METRO RAIL CORPORATION (GMRC) LIMITED
(SPV of Govt. of India and Govt. of Gujarat)
Block No.1, First Floor, Karmayogi Bhavan, Sector 10/A,
Gandhinagar; 382010, Gujarat. (CIN): U60200GJ2010SGC059407
LOCAL COMPETITIVE BIDDING
TENDER NOTIFICATION No: GMRC/DEPOT/M&P-L8/2023 Dated : 31.07.2023
E-Tender is invited from reputed and experienced Contractors for the following tender :

Tender Name	Tender Fees
E-Tendering for "Design, Manufacture, Supply, Installation, Testing and Commissioning of Driving Cab Simulator"	INR 25,000/-

Interested bidders are requested to visit <https://tender.nprocure.com> for eligibility criteria, applying / downloading the tender document. **The last date and time for Bid Submissions of Tender is till 15:00 Hrs on 14.09.2023.** Any alterations in Eligibility Criteria cum Qualification Requirements, and terms of the Tender Document, or any amendment to the Tender Document, etc, will be uploaded on <https://tender.nprocure.com> and GMRC's Website www.gujaratmetrorail.com without any obligation or press notification or other proclamation.
Sd/-
Managing Director, GMRC, Gandhinagar

WESTERN RAILWAY - RAJKOT DIVISION
CONSTRUCTION OF BOUNDARY WALL AND INTERLOCKING OF LEVEL CROSSING
E-Tender Notice No. 16 of 2023-24
Date: 24-07-2023 Sr.No.1 : e-Tender No. DRM-RJT-23-E-41 Name of work: Construction of boundary wall between on approaches of major cities vulnerable for trespassing at Rajkot, Jamnagar and Wankaner. **Approximate NIT Cost:** ₹ 2,00,44,710.23 **Sr.No.2 : e-Tender No. DRM-RJT-23-E-42 Name of work:** Rajkot Division - (Clubbed Work) Interlocking of Level Crossing No. 38 at KM 62/34-5 between Bala Road-Surendranagar Section, Level Crossing No. 71 at KM 67/15-6 between Vagadia-Thane Section and Level Crossing No. 102 at KM 71/6/3-4 between Sindhavadar-Kankot Section. **Approximate NIT Cost:** ₹ 62,79,983.77 **For All Tenders: Date & Time of Opening of Tender: 16-08-2023, 15:00 Hrs. Address of the Office & Website particulars:** Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), Western Railway, Kothi Compound, Rajkot, Gujarat-360 001. **Website: www.irops.gov.in** **RJT-051**
Like us on: [facebook.com/WesternRly](https://www.facebook.com/WesternRly)

LL-44
The Odisha State Cooperative Bank Ltd.
Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru Marg
Bhubaneswar - 751 001
Contractual Recruitment of Resource Persons
Application in the prescribed format are invited from the permanent resident of Odisha for the following posts under the Business Diversification & Product Innovation Cell (BDPI) of the Odisha State Cooperative Bank on contractual basis for a period of three years.
1. Resource Person 2: Agriculture Expert
2. Resource Person 3: Banking - IT Expert
All other details of eligibility criteria, application process and the Terms and Conditions of the recruitment are available on our website www.odishascb.com and the same may be downloaded by the prospective candidates.
The filled in application should reach to The Managing Director, Odisha State Cooperative Bank Ltd, Pt. J.N. Marg, Bhubaneswar-751001 within 15 days from the date of this advertisement through Courier / Registered Post / Speed Post inscribing on the Envelop "Application for the Post of Resource Person 2/3 in BDPI Cell of Odisha State Cooperative Bank". Any application received after the stipulated period will not be considered. Applications of ineligible candidates shall be summarily rejected and no correspondences in the matter of rejection shall be entertained on any circumstances.
Sd/-
Managing Director
OIPR - 39012/11/0012/23-24

KALYAN DOMBIVLI MUNICIPAL CORPORATION, KALYAN
Notice Inviting Tender (NIT)
Notice No: 44/2023-24
The Commissioner, Kalyan Dombivli Municipal Corporation invites online sealed proposals (Technical and Financial) from eligible bidders / consortiums through e-procurement tendering process for below mentioned Project.

Sr. No.	Name of the Work	Cost of the Tender (Rs.)	Earnest Money Deposit (Rs.)
1	Request For Proposal For Design- Build-Operate-Transfer (DBOT) of 150 bedded Modern Maternity Home & Cancer Hospital on Public Private Partnership Mode on Turkey Basis for the period of 30 Years at Existing Sutika Gruha, Plot-C.S.No. 6398, having plot area of 3219.20 square meters With all permissible FSI as per UDPCR at Gajbandhan Patharli, Dombivli, East- 421 201	Rs 5000/- + 18 % GST Total= Rs.5900/-	Rs.1,00,00,000/- (Rupees one crore, only)

KDMC invites interested entities having experience as envisaged in the RFP document, to submit their Proposal. Interested entities can download the RFP document from the website <https://www.mahatenders.gov.in> through the e-tendering system from 3.30 PM on 31/07/2023 to 14/09/2023 up to 3.30 PM. The completed RFP document is to be uploaded till 14/09/2023 up to 3.30 PM. The RFP will be opened on 15/09/2023 at 4.00 PM, if possible. A pre-bid meeting is arranged on 24/08/2023 at 15.00 hours, on the below mentioned address to discuss any queries with respect to bidding for the Project.
Venue for the Pre-bid Conference: Office of the Commissioner, KDMC, Kalyan.
Rights to reject any or all the RFP, without assigning any reasons thereof, are reserved by the Commissioner, KDMC, Kalyan and whose decision will be final and legally binding on all the bidders.
Sd/-
(Dr. Bhausaheb Dangde, (I.A.S.))
Commissioner,
Kalyan Dombivli Municipal Corporation, Kalyan
KDMC/PRO/HQ/471
Dt. 28/07/23

THE SALEM DIST.CO-OP. MILK PRODUCERS' UNION LTD.,
Sihaur, Thalwadi Post, Salem- 536 302, (T.N)
Office Phone : 7373704802 Telefax : 0427-2386871 E-Mail: silmaavin.purchase@gmail.com **ICO**
GSIN : 33AAAT3146P1ZA
TENDER CALL NOTICE
Online e-tenders are invited (<https://ntenders.gov.in>) from the Manufacturers Authorised dealer / suppliers for the supply of Dairy/Packing materials and Consumables for the year 2023-2025
1) Cost of tender form (inclusive of tax) & last date / time for issuing Tender forms: Freely downloadable from <https://ntenders.gov.in> from 01.08.2023 upto 30.08.2023
2) Date / Time for Pre-Bid Meeting: 11.08.2023 at 11.00 AM to 12.00 PM
3) Last Date / time for e-submission of Online tender: 31.08.2023 upto 3.00 P.M.
4) Date / Time for opening of Technical bids: 31.08.2023 at 3.30 P.M.
5) Date & time for opening of part II commercial bid: will be intimated later
6) Period of Tender: Two years (2023-2025)
All other details - Refer tender documents. Corrigendum Details of Tenders, EMD S.D. Qualifications, Terms and Conditions, name of packing material & consumables, requirements, specifications and other details can be downloaded at (<https://ntenders.gov.in>) on free of cost. Technical bid shall be opened through e-procurement portal (<https://ntenders.gov.in>) on the above mentioned date. The tenderer should submit their bids only through e-procurement portal (<https://ntenders.gov.in>)
DIPR/ 4135 /TENDER/2023 **GENERAL MANAGER, SALEM DAIRY**

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER (BUILDING) PWD OLD PALASIYA INDORE
Email:- apdpuiindore@gmail.com
S.NO./F-3/2023/Gen/Chif.eng.(building)/NIT-12/2292 Indore Date :- 24/7/23
Online percentage rate bids for the following works are invited (SOR w.e.f. 15.09.2022) from Registered Contractors and Firms of reputed fulfilling registration criteria Interested bidders can view the detailed NIT- 11/ 2023 on the website <http://mptenders.gov.in> The Bid Document can purchased only online. For Amendment to NIT, if any, would be published on website only, and not is newspaper.

S. No.	Tender Portal No.	Name of Work	District	Probable Amount (Rs. in lakh)	Erarnest Money Deposit (EMD) (In Rs.)	Cost of Bid Document (In Rs.)	Completion Period (months)
1	2023_PWPIU_292506_1	CONSTRUCITON FOR THE BALANCE WORK OF NEW DISTRICT COURT BUILDING AT PIPIYAHANA INDORE MP SECOND CALL	Indore	25333.95	50,00,00 0	50,000	18
2	2023_PWPIU_293211_1	External Electrification Works Zonal Works in Various building Under Public Works Department Building JHABUA MP	Jhabua	103.00	1,03,000	12,500	6
3	2023_PWPIU_293154_1	Construction of New Government Law College Building at Jhabua MP	Jhabua	672.25	6,72,250	20,000	12
4	2023_PWPIU_293721_1	EXTERNAL ELECTRIFICATION WORK AT VARIOUS BUILDING UNDER PWD (B) KHARGONE DISTRICT KHARGONE(M.P.)	Khargone	70.00	70,000	10,000	12

(Key Date) :-
1. Document Download/Sale Start Date : 21.07.2023
2. Bid Submission Start Date : 24.07.2023
3. Bid Submission End Date : 08.08.2023
4. Bid Opening Date : 10.08.2023
G-17498/23 **Sd/-**
Chief Engineer (Building) PWD Zone Indore
कोरोना में सावधानी हटी, समझो दूरटना घटी।

BANGALORE WATER SUPPLY AND SEWERAGE BOARD
INVITATION FOR TENDER (Only through KPP - Portal)
BWSSB invites tenders in two cover system from eligible tenderers for the following works

Name of the Work	Amount put to tender
Office of the Chief Engineer (Kaveri - O&M), 6th Floor, Cauvery Bhavan, K.G Road, Bangalore- 560 009.	EMD
No.: BWSSB/CE(K-O&M)/TE/TA-01/2022/459/2023-24	Date: 27.07.2023
Work of Upgradation of 66/6.6 KV Switch Yard at T.G.Halli.	Rs. 1,04,00,000/- Rs. 1,84,000/-
Last date and time for receipt of tenders will be on 14.08.2023 upto 15:00 hrs. The Technical bids will be opened on 16.08.2023 at 16:00 hrs.	Sd/- Chief Engineer (Kaveri - O&M)
Office of The Chief Engineer (South), 7th Floor, Cauvery Bhavan, KG Road, Bangalore-560 009.	
No.: BWSSB/EIC(CE/S)/ACE(S)-1/DCE(M)-1/TA(S)/1310/2023-24	Date: 28.07.2023
Work of providing and laying of 200mm dia DI feeder pipeline from Bannerghatta Circle (Opp. to Bannerghatta Police Station) to Bannerghatta National Park with fixing of DI valves for providing water supply facilities to Bannerghatta National Park coming under AEES-1-1 Sub Division.	Rs. 120.82 Lakhs Rs. 2.14 Lakhs
Last date and time for receipt of tenders will be on 16.08.2023 upto 15:00 hrs. The Technical bids will be opened on 18.08.2023 after 16:00 hrs.	Sd/- Chief Engineer (South)
The details regarding the tender and participation in the kpp portal process can be obtained by logging on to https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in . For further details contact the abovesigned office during working hours.	

DIPR/CP/MIA/7/11/2023-24

Kanjur land for Metro car shed belongs to state: Min

Mumbai: The Kanjurmarg land where the erstwhile MVA government had proposed to construct a Metro car shed belongs to the state government, so the transfer of 15 hectares to the MMRDA for Metro-II car shed is valid, revenue minister Radha-Krishna Vikhe-Patil told the legislative council last week. Last year, the Centre had asserted its ownership and title over the land.

"As per the orders of the Konkan divisional commissioner, dated May 21, 2015, and then revenue minister, dated November 1, 2018, it is clear that the Kanjurmarg land belongs to Maharashtra government...so the transfer of land to MMRDA is valid," Vikhe-Patil said, in a written reply to a question raised by Sena (UBT) MLC Anil Parab. "After MMRDA took possession of the 15 hectares in April, the Centre's deputy salt commissioner took objection to the land survey, and was informed by the Mumbai suburban collector that the land belongs to the state government."

Pointing out that the state government would have saved Rs 10,500 crore if all Metro car sheds been constructed in Kanjurmarg, former environment minister and Sena (UBT) MLA Aaditya Thackeray said: "We had proposed to construct car sheds for Metro 3, 6, 4 and 14 in Kanjurmarg. Now, MMRDA is trying to acquire land in Thane for Metro 4 and 14, we don't know through whom. There is no land for Metro 6. We have been saying that the Kanjurmarg land belongs to the state, but the Centre played dirty politics..."

—Chaitanya Marpakwar

CM, dy CM meet exec director of World Bank

Mumbai: CM Eknath Shinde and deputy CM Devendra Fadnis met executive director of the World Bank for India Parameswaran Iyer on Sunday. "Maharashtra's partnership with the World Bank will improve the quality of people's life in the state," Shinde said, adding that Maharashtra has the best skilled manpower, excellent infrastructure in the country and the state is making substantial efforts in the fields of green technology, renewable energy, disaster management, healthcare and port infrastructure.

Fadnis said that the aim is to make Maharashtra drought-free, especially through the river-linking project. He said that the priority is to divert the water of the rivers originating in the west and flowing towards the Godavari basin and to use them to end the drought in the districts of eastern and western Vidarbha. Officials said the World Bank is expected to fund projects like the Nanaji Deshmukh Krishi Sanjeevani Project, Mumbai Metropolitan Transport Improvement Project, Green Energy, economic development in every district and providing fast services to citizens. Nanaji Deshmukh Krishi Sanjeevani Yojana 2023 is an initiative to provide financial assistance to farmers and protect them from drought and flood losses. Mumbai Urban Transport Project was started in 2002 by the state, Railways and the MMRDA, with financial assistance from the World Bank to find long term solutions to the city's transport and communication issues. **TNN**

Flying drones banned till Sept 15 in Thane

Thane: The flying of all remote controlled drones, missiles, paragliders or micro light aircraft within the limits of all police stations in Thane has been prohibited till September 15, informed officials. "Those wishing to operate the gadgets will need to seek prior police permission. The police department has been exempted from the orders for conducting aerial surveillance," officials said. The police have warned violators of action under section 188 of the IPC. **TNN**

No info chief for 6 mnths, 1L appeals pending: CM

Chaitanya Marpakwar
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Mumbai: Chief minister Ekanth Shinde told the legislative council last week that posts of the chief information commissioner (CIC) and three information commissioners (ICs) are vacant in the state. In a written reply to a question raised by MLCs Ranjitsinh Mohite-Patil and Satyajit Tambe, Shinde said the government issued advertisements inviting applications for the posts in February 2023 and scrutiny of applications was going on. Shinde said over 1 lakh second appeals were pending before the state information commission (SIC) as of May 2023.

The term of the last CIC, former chief secretary Sumit Mullick, ended earlier this year. Officials said retired IAS officers, who are usually appointed as CIC and ICs, especially those like former chief secretaries, lost interest in the post after tenure was re-

duced from five to three years. Former IAS officer Sunil Porwal who is the IC for Mumbai, is also holding charge for CIC. "Retired bureaucrats want five-year post retirement postings and not just three years, and so they are not applying as enthusiastically as they used to. Many officers who retired recently have applied for postings that have a fixed five-year tenure," an official said.

The selection committee to pick the CIC and ICs comprises the CM, deputy CM and the opposition leader (of the legislative assembly) but there has been no opposition leader in the assembly after the NCP's Ajit Pawar joined the Shinde-Fadnis government. "At the moment, existing ICs are holding additional charge for the vacant posts. Based on the search committee's recommendations and on approval of the governor, the appointments of CIC and ICs will be made," Shinde said in his reply.

Officials said vacancies remain from six months to over a year. IC posts in Maharashtra have been created as per geographical zone — Mumbai, Brihanmumbai, Konkan, Nashik, Amaravati, Pune, Nagpur and Aurangabad. Commissioners are yet to be appointed for Amravati, Chhatrapati Sambhajnagar, Konkan and Mumbai headquarters. Citizens and activists have been demanding the appointment of experts as information commissioners instead of retired bureaucrats in order to speed up clearance of appeals.

The RTI Act states that people of 'eminence in public life' can be appointed as ICs. But out of the eight posts in the state information commission, including that of the CIC, most have been former bureaucrats barring a few exceptions like journalist Rahul Pande, who was appointed IC for Nagpur and is holding charge for Amravati division too.

1st time after revolt, Pawar says change is imminent

Prafulla Marpakwar
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Mumbai: NCP president Sharad Pawar on Sunday broke his silence on the current political situation, saying once NCP, Shiv Sena and Congress decides to unite, change is imminent. "I am here, Congress-legislature party leader Balasaheb Thorat and UBT president Uddhav Thackeray, too, are here. If we join hands, then change is imminent, there is no need to mention it specifically," Pawar said.

Pawar was speaking at the launch of a book published by V K Rajwade research foundation in the presence of Uddhav Thackeray and Balasaheb Thorat. "Currently, it is difficult to interact with the state government, I am sure, soon there will be a way out, once the dispute is resolved, then it will be binding on the government to assist the foundation in its research work," Pawar said on the issues raised by the foundation.

Pawar recalled the huge contribution made by Uddhav Thackeray to the Mumbai Marathi Granth Sangrahalaya headed by him. When Uddhav Thackeray was the CM, he had donated Rs 5 crore to it from the CM relief fund. In addition, he had come to the rescue of a section of literary organisations. Sharad Pawar reacted for the first time after his nephew Ajit Pawar joined hands with Eknath Shinde and Devendra Fadnis.

Mum University signs MoU with two universities in America

Mumbai: In a step towards the internationalisation of higher education, Mumbai University signed an MoU with two renowned American universities - the University of Illinois and St Louis University - on Sunday. The MoU was signed during the Akhil Bharatiya Shiksha Samagam 2023 held at Pragati Maidan in New Delhi. It is the first state university to sign such agreements with international universities in line with the objectives laid down in the National Education Policy.

The event in Delhi was organised to mark the completion of three years of NEP. With the University of Illinois, the collaboration will help in offering joint and articulated degrees, dual degrees, credit transfers academic programmes, internships, joint teaching and research activities, faculty development and exchange of scientific instruments and technology. The collaboration with St Louis University will also enable similar dual degree programmes, student exchange, joint cultural activities and sharing or creation of educational resources. **TNN**

'Gokhale bridge to be partially opened in Nov'

Mumbai: About 62 metric tons (MT) of steel, arrived at the Gokhale bridge site on Friday, Mumbai suburban guardian minister MP Lodha took stock of the work on the bridge. Lodha claimed that it would be partially opened by November. The BMC had planned to open the bridge partially by September. But the factory in Ambala, where the girders are being made, was affected by flooding, Lodha said.

The steel will help start the assembly work for the girders. He also visited locations in the city to check on the pothole filling work. **TNN**

Ex-corporator questions BMC on GMLR contractors

Mumbai: After the BMC finalised a joint venture between J Kumar and Nagarjuna Construction Company (NCC) as the contractors for the construction of Goregaon Mulund Link Road (GMLR) project's twin tunnels, former Congress corporator Ravi Raja questioned the move. He said, "While commuters travelling on that road will experience relief soon, I am concerned about why this project was given to companies that can't even build good roads," said Raja. **TNN**

Tradition As Habit?

Santosh Desai

A member of our staff recently lost his 90-year-old mother and as per tradition, shaved off his hair and undertook to stay off milk or any dairy product for a year. This was a truncated observance of the original rituals that involved, among other things, walking barefoot for a year. The change in the tradition happened organically as it became impossible to follow its rigours, so a practical accommodation was made, as is the case with several traditions.

When we regard traditions in today's day and age with a contemporary lens, it is usually with some suspicion. This is understandable because in the name of the past, we can justify many practices that are impractical and more importantly, regressive. The operating assumptions governing society have changed, and to fight against the organic evolution of norms in the name of tradition can be stifling and constraining. This is true of many traditions, but particularly that involve the role of women. Social customs of an era tend to support the dominant power structures of that time and a mindless insistence on continuing these in the name of tradition can mean the perpetuation of these power imbalances.

That being said, the truth is that human beings need tradition. We need to be reminded that we are part of a continuous chain of life, that our over-investment in the idea of being individuals does not blind us to the fact that we are small links in a large, interconnected chain. We are born out of life, not just into it, and life will go on well after we are gone. We need to mark extraordinary events like birth, death and marriage with a special kind of awareness that everyday life does not provide us with. We need to acknowledge their significance and remind ourselves that we are part of something much larger, something that gives our lives shape and meaning.

Tradition is the temporal representation of continuous time. It translates this

abstract idea into lived reality. It is only by practising something, which visibly does not belong to the present and which has been practised by generations before ours, that we are able to experience some sense of being connected with the past. To be modern and to be only modern is to be suspended terrifyingly in an unmarked landscape with no familiar features.

And yet, it is common to think of tradition as something vestigial that holds us back from moving ahead. We value the new and the ever changing, we breathlessly ask what the future might bring. The past is seen either as a chain or cast in an idealised mythic form to support a political project. Our relationship with tradition is becoming more self-conscious, either by becoming more contentious or more performative.

There is a modern tendency to overvalue other people's traditions and undervalue one's own. The traditions of an exotic other define their uniqueness and must be preserved while one's own traditions are regarded as being less defining of who we are.

but the sense of continuity that they provide does not depend on that.

There is an inert part of tradition that allows us to follow it without really knowing what it is that one is following. Take the example of weddings. Unlike the western world, where marriage vows are increasingly deliberately crafted and consciously taken, in India, few have any idea what the wedding mantras that are invoked mean. The vows are implicit in our understanding of the institution of marriage. While modern priests do give a little sermon on the meaning of marriage, this is usually lost in the cacophony that surrounds a modern Indian wedding.

Everything about the wedding today is a modern retelling of tradition, but importantly, there is little desire to move from tradition as an anchor. The ceremony might be compressed into an attention-span friendly duration, the bride might wear aviator glasses and have her own bara-raat, but the ritual of the bara-raat isn't going anywhere. We need the familiar flagstones of the past to travel in the present in our own way. The comfort of being cocooned in some version of tradition is a source of great comfort.

Is this a kind of hypocrisy, this playing tradition-tradition even as we hollow out its intent? Or is this what tradition is meant to be, an ever-evolving part of our lives that anchors us without limiting our choices? However much it may have changed, the wedding today is essentially a celebration of tradition no matter how progressive the people who participate in it may regard themselves.

The larger issue is that we think of the modern not as the outer skin of time, but as time itself. Implicitly, by locating ourselves in the now, the only connection we have with time is our possible future rather than our already lived past. The fact that we will, in the fullness of time, be nothing but tradition is lost in a world that is obsessed with enacting modernity. We are constructing tradition every single day even as we believe that we are dismantling it.

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CITY CITY BANG BANG

But we can never really escape tradition. We might trade one kind for another but the idea of following a routine that we invest in with meaning above the ordinary is a deeply ingrained one. We make traditions as easily as we disregard them. Every family constructs its own little traditions, be it a made-for-Facebook Diwali puja or an annual family reunion at an exotic location. The traditions we make may not survive time, but they serve the same function as those we confer with cultural value.

The difference between routine, ritual and tradition is a matter of time and meaning. Routines provide comfort but are a trifle shy on meaning whereas rituals have meaning embedded in them even if that is not always apparent. Rituals are often followed without full or even partial awareness of their origins and meaning,

Muddy water kills fish in Kalyan pond

Kalyan: In a shocking incident, hundreds of fish have been found dead in Gauri Pada pond in Kalyan. Locals suspect the overflowing drains and muddy water during the recent heavy rain might have entered the pond, causing pollution, and eventually leading to the deaths.

Residents claimed that fishes were spotted dying since the last three days. But on Sunday, the shocking scene came to light after many people going for a walk near the pond spotted dead fishes floating in the lake and informed

the Kalyan-Dombivli Municipal Corporation (KDMC).

The Gauripada Lake, which is spread over 22,700 square metres, is a natural water source in the area for many years.

Three years ago, around 85 turtles were found dead in the lake.

Sachin Jadhav, a local resident, said, "Due to recent heavy rain, muddy and sewage and drainage water entered into the pond, which may have caused the pollution due to which the fish died." —Pradeep Gupta

Debunking fake news on violence in the country

MEET FOUR OF THE CHAIN-BREAKERS

Watch out for

- Fake News Of The Day column on page 2
- Weekly round-ups of top trending fake news and appeals to join the fight against fake news by sharing these on your social networks, so that communities, near and dear ones are made aware

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Step 1: Save the number **9819888887** on your phone as 'Times Verified'

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Jaiditya Abrol
(Maharashtra)

Vanita Giri
(Maharashtra)

Shobhit
(Kolkata)

Rajesh Desai
(Gujarat)

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

After two players from the Scotland cricket team tested positive in a dope test conducted by ICC, West Indies were allowed to qualify for the ICC 2023 Cricket World Cup. This was among thousands of forwarded messages including, "Due to the rise of violence in country, France Government has banned visas and passports of people from all 57 Muslim countries" and "Nepal has banned all private Indian television channels, except DD News", that **TOI** recently busted as fake.

Under the 'Times Verified' campaign, readers send suspicious messages circulating on social media to this paper on the WhatsApp number 9819888887. To verify their credibility, our expert panel — made up of reporters, editors and representatives from the municipality and government — taps into its

carefully-cultivated network of trustworthy sources.

Launched nationally on November 21 last year, the 'Times Verified' initiative aims to break the chain of viral misinformation and disinformation that has been infecting social media groups. Since the launch, **TOI**'s editorial team has received nearly 1.7 lakh mes-



sages, over a half of which turned out to be false.

Besides misleading headlines such as, "A newly constructed overhead metro in Pune collapses and leaves over 100 people injured. This has made people question the authorities involved in Pune metro project" to "Japan has created a special robot that recently beat a human oppo-

nent in a table tennis match. This innovation shows the country's technological advancement in the field of AI", the deluge of misinformation also included messages like, "The Supreme Court has decided to set up a committee to form an All India Organization of taxpayers, which will be the biggest organization in the world. No matter which government is ruling, without the approval of this organisation, no free electricity, free water, free distribution, or loan waivers can be announced by any government".

In this scenario, the job of our vigilant army of chain-breakers assumes greater significance. The alert brigade includes Kolkata's Shobhit, Maharashtra's Vanita Giri and Jaiditya Abrol and Gujarat's Rajesh Desai. To join them, send anxiety-causing headlines doing the rounds of social media networks to our expert panel.

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VISIT BIHAR & BENGAL TOO, SITUATION THERE WORSE, BJP NETA SAMRAT CHAUDHARY TELLS OPPN TEAM

THOSE IN POWER IN KARNATAKA ARE BUSY DOING POLITICS TO SAVE THEIR POSITION, SAYS BOMMAI



Shah to introduce bill today to replace Delhi ordinance

Oppn Likely To First Insist On No-Trust Vote

Akhilesh.Singh@timesgroup.com

New Delhi: Home minister Amit Shah is set to introduce on Monday the Government of National Capital Territory of Delhi (Amendment) Bill that seeks to replace the May 19 ordinance that wrested the control of bureaucracy from the Delhi government by neutering the Supreme Court verdict, which had vested superintendence of "services" in the elected regime.

Sources said copies of the bill were circulated among MPs on Saturday. Though passage of the bill looks a formality in Lok Sabha, the move will heighten tensions between the government and the opposition that has been rallied by AAP, and can lead to skirmishes.

The opposition is likely to

3 PARTIES HOLD KEY

> Oppn is likely to insist that the NCT of Delhi (Amendment) Bill be kept aside until the vote on no-trust motion
> Govt's stand is passage of key bills mustn't be put off until last week when headcount is likely to be scheduled
> YSR Cong, BJD & TDP hold key in the showdown in the Rajya Sabha, which should closely follow the vote in LS

insist that the NCT services bill be kept aside until the vote on the no-trust motion, whereas the government's stance has been that passage of important bills should not be deferred until the last week when the headcount is likely to be scheduled.

AAP has successfully mobilised all opposition parties, but there are doubts about the success of its lobbying with regard to the response of YSR Congress, BJD and Telugu Desam Party in Rajya Sabha. These parties hold the key in the showdown in the Upper House which should closely

follow the vote in LS. AAP's stance that the bill not be brought for passage until the SC has disposed of the challenge to the ordinance shows it is not confident about the numbers. On the other hand, the government refraining from filling up two vacancies in the 'nominated' category is seen as a sign of its confidence about the neutrality of the three "swing players".

The bill will have identical provisions for appointments and postings of senior officers in the Delhi government like the ordinance promulgated on May 19. It provides for all transfers and postings of senior officers in the Delhi government to be done by a three-member panel headed by the chief minister.

The ordinance was promulgated by the central government a week after the SC handed over control of services in Delhi, excluding police, public order and land, to the elected government, headed by CM Arvind Kejriwal.

"With a view to give effect to the intent and purpose be-

hind the provisions of Article 239AA of the Constitution a permanent authority, headed by the chief minister of Delhi, along with the chief secretary and the principal secretary (home), government of NCT of Delhi, is being constituted to make recommendations to the lieutenant governor regarding matters concerning transfer postings, vigilance and other matters," the statement of objects and reasons of the bill said.

While the BJP-led NDA enjoys a comfortable majority in LS, it has to rely on regional parties for passage of bills in RS. Andhra Pradesh CM Jagannathan Reddy's YSRCP has already announced its support to the government in both Houses. With nine members in RS, YSRCP's support will help BJP steer clear of any resistance.

The Union government has also listed 13 draft legislations for consideration and passing in Lok Sabha even as a notice for moving a no-confidence motion is pending before the House.

AirAsia staff who 'didn't wait for gov' suspended

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Bengaluru: Three days after an AirAsia India's Hyderabad-bound flight took off before Karnataka governor Thawar Chand Gehlot could board it at Bengaluru, the airline's station manager at Kempegowda International Airport (KIA) has been suspended for a month.

Besides manager Zico Soares, two more airline staffers are likely to be suspended over Thursday's "lapse" before a scheduled meeting of AirAsia officials in the governor's office on Monday, KIA sources said.

KIA airport sources confirmed Soares had been suspended since Saturday on charges of not waiting for the VIP and giving the AirAsia (now AIX Connect) plane the go-ahead to fly with regular passengers.



Raj Bhavan claims Gehlot had arrived on time but missed the flight because of the 'lapses' on the part of the ground staff

Raj Bhavan maintains that the governor had arrived on time but missed the flight because of the "lapses" on the part of the airline's ground staff. Gehlot took another flight 50 minutes later to Hyderabad.

The sources said Gehlot was to board IS972 at 2.05pm. "The governor's arrival was awaited as two of his staff had already reached with his

bags. But he reached the VIP gate only at 2.07pm and was heading in his official car on the tarmac towards the flight. By then, the flight, packed with passengers and scheduled to take off at 2.05pm, had already pushed back after the doors were closed and the ladders removed," said a senior official.

In Monday's meeting, senior airline officials will explain to Gehlot or his team the situation that led to the governor missing the flight as well as the action taken in the form of the suspension, the sources said.

An AIX Connect spokesperson had in a statement earlier "regretted" the episode and cited an ongoing internal probe.

Gehlot's office had told TOI that a complaint had been lodged with the civil aviation ministry in the matter.

Slain don-neta Atiq's lawyer held in UP in Umesh Pal case

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Prayagraj: UP Special Task Force (STF) and Prayagraj police on Sunday arrested a lawyer of slain gangster Atiq Ahmed and his younger brother Khalid Azim alias Ashraf in the Umesh Pal murder case. Confirming the arrest of lawyer Vijay Kumar Mishra, Prayagraj city DCP Deepak Bhuker said the former was wanted by Dhoonganjan police in the murder case.



"Further investigations are on," the officer added. This is the second lawyer in Atiq's team to be arrested for the February 24 murder of Umesh Pal. The main lawyer, Khan Saulat Haneef, was arrested earlier.

Umesh Pal, who was also a lawyer, was the main witness in the 2005 murder of BSP MLA Raju Pal. He was shot dead in broad daylight along with his two security guards outside his house in Sulemsarai in Prayagraj on February 24 this year. Atiq and Ashraf were the main accused in the murders of both Raju and Umesh. The gangster duo was shot dead by three assailants when they were being taken to Colvin hospital here for a medical test on April 15 this year.

Dhoonganjan police claimed that Mishra was arrested on the basis of Haneef's statements. During interrogation, Haneef shed light on Mishra's involvement in the murder, and electronic evidence pointed out that Mishra was leaking information about Umesh's movements to Atiq and his accomplices, police sources said. They added that enough evidence to nail Mishra had been collected.

Hanif's name was added in the Umesh Pal murder case in April and he was arrested under IPC Section 120-B (criminal conspiracy).

Post selfies with 'jhanda, mitti, diya' as DP, J&K admin orders officials ahead of I-Day

Saleem.Pandit@timesgroup.com

Srinagar: The J&K administration has directed all government officials to use selfies with images of "Jhanda (flag), Mitti (soil) and Diya (earthen lamp)" as display pictures (DPs) on their social media handles ahead of August 15 and urged people to join in the Centre's Meri Mitti Mera Desh campaign this Independence Day.

The decision was taken on Sunday at a meeting chaired by the Union territory's



Surat traders prepare 1 crore flags ahead of August 15

chief secretary, Arun Kumar Mehta, to review August 15 arrangements and is part of the Meri Mitti campaign announced by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in his Mann

Ki Baat programme. "All government officers and the public at large will hoist the tricolour over their houses," an official order states, adding that this should be done in accordance with the Flag Code.

The directive applies to all government buildings, schools, colleges and universities, which also to be decorated with special lights.

Officials should upload videos and confirm compliance. "All should share videos with respective divisional commissioners," it says.

The ADG Police (security) was directed to ensure fool-proof arrangements at all venues across J&K and IG (Traffic) to devise routes and parking plans for the main events in Srinagar and Jammu. "No government employee shall avail leave on Independence Day 2023, except under exceptional circumstances. All employees will participate in celebrations," reads the order which to inaugurate projects executed over the past year and lay foundations for key plans until August 15.

2 sisters, school student (16) in Alwar gangraped

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Jaipur: Three cases of alleged gangrape have been filed this weekend in Rajasthan's Alwar. The first incident involves the abuse of two sisters whose families stay and work at a private farmhouse and the other an assault on a 16-year-old schoolgirl.

The first case was filed on Sunday by the father of the sisters alleging his daughters were raped "for 18 months" by two staffers of the farmhouse and that both have become pregnant. The older girl is aged 15, said police, adding the younger one's age is being verified.

Man 'waits for people to leave market', rapes 5-yr-old in Ker

A five-year-old girl was kidnapped, raped and murdered on Friday and her body was recovered in Aluva, Kochi on Saturday. Police arrested the accused, a Bihar native. The incident took place in a market area and the accused was allegedly inebriated. A cop, however, said, "He was not intoxicated. He waited for people at the market to leave before committing the crime." TNN

In the second case, filed on Saturday, the family has alleged that the student was drugged and raped by two bike-borne men who abducted her on July 27. "At knife-point, she was forced to sit on the bike. She was then given sugarcane juice laced with sedatives, taken to a room and raped by the duo," said a police officer.

Police have registered cases in both the incidents and have started probe.

These come at a time BJP has tried to corner the Congress government over crimes against women. PM Narendra Modi, too, had tagged "Rajasthan and Chhattisgarh" while denouncing Manipur's May 4 strip-and-parade horror.

BJP worker drinks poison on FB Live over rape case

Bareilly: Veer Singh, district convenor of BJP Kisan Morcha in Moradabad, hit the headlines after he was thrashed recently by locals at a temple and subsequently booked on charges of raping a woman. On Saturday, he consumed poison and broadcast the act on Facebook Live, saying he "couldn't face" his daughter after the serious accusation, reports Kanwardeep Singh.

Singh was taken to hospital by cops, and his condition is now better. In the video, the 40-year-old said, "I have a 15-year-old daughter, and it is difficult to show my face to her after this humiliation. The rape allegations are false... This accusation is part of a larger conspiracy by jealous members of my party due to a property dispute." SP Sandeep Kumar Meena said Singh had an altercation with the president of a temple committee on Thursday, leading to both men filing police complaints, including a case of sexual assault against Singh.

THE SPEAKING TREE

APOCALYPSE NOW

We are gripped by annihilation anxiety as we experience the signs of an impending mass extinction, writes NARAYANI GANESH

Why won't you have children?" asked the aunty of her 40-year-old niece. The exasperated niece tried to explain patiently, "Aunty, we are facing the sixth mass extinction, with water shortages, global warming, rising oceans, pollution, toxic vegetables and species going extinct — why would I bring new life into this wretched world?"

Her head is filled with disaster scenarios, ruminated aunty, who had grown up in a joint family, listening to many stories, including those of the birth-death cycle not just of individuals, communities and kingdoms, but also of planets, stars and the universe. "Sixth extinction? Balderdash," exclaimed aunty. "Don't you know we've been through infinite cycles of creation and dissolution that happen at all levels, across yugas, kalpas and pralayas?"

According to Tamanna Begum writing for the UK's Natural History Museum, extinction is part of life; nearly 98 per cent of all organisms that have ever existed on our planet are now extinct. "When a species goes extinct, its role in the ecosystem is usually filled by new species, or other existing ones. Earth's 'normal' extinction rate is thought to be between 0.1 and 1 species per 10,000 species per 100 years. This is known as the background rate of extinction. Mass extinction is when species vanish much faster than they are replaced.

Several youngsters today worry that solutions to mass extinction issues are not in their circle of influence. Their circle of concern is much larger. But the work of influencers like Sweden's Greta Thunberg, broadcaster David Attenborough, primatologist Jane Goodall, forest-creator Jadav Payeng, anti-pollution crusader Sunita Narain and others has the world's attention, representing those who are as concerned but are limited as influencers. As wilful destructors, if human beings could become extinct first, that would liberate flora, fauna, and the planet from all these problems. We tend to think in terms of human cycles of time and so our canvas is small and self-centred. To expand the mind, we need to grasp the idea of geological and cosmic timescales.

Sages say that Shiv is not really the destroyer; he is redeemer in the infinite cycle of construction and destruction. His body is the universe, an inseparable part of the indestructible eternal. When the universe dissolves, everything gets redeemed in due course. Nothing ever goes away, it all comes back, perhaps in different ways, if not now, then later.

While we are in the temporal world, it's good to become aware of the eternal nature of existence. Western ideas were rooted in human mortality and timescales, and now in the mortality of Planet Earth. But Indic wisdom reveals the larger canvas of immortality, where time cycles are not limited to days, months, years and centuries, but in yugas and kalpas that sweep across googles of millennia.

In Hindu cosmology, yuga cycles are four — *satya*, *trita*, *dvapar* and *kali* yugas — and one thousand yuga cycles are contained in a kalpa, one day of Brahma, lasting approximately 4.32 billion human years, as does one night of Brahma. A kalpa culminates in pralaya, deluge, and the cycle continues — there is *mahakalpa* followed by *mahapralaya*. The cosmic cycle completes trillions of years before rebooting to another set of cycles, in an infinite play of creation and extinction — sixth, trillionth-plus or otherwise — ad infinitum. ■

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DEATH ANNIVERSARY

1st Death Anniversary

SORAB PESI KHANDALAVALA

First Anniversary Mass on Monday, July 31, 2023 at 6.30 pm Holy Name Cathedral, Wodehouse Road, Colaba, Behind Campton School

REMEMBRANCE

SHARING MEMORIES

3rd Death Anniversary

MRS. MINAL PISAT

Death : 31/07/2020

remembered by Relatives & Friends

19th Death Anniversary

MR. SATPAL C. SAIGAL

Your Memory Continues to Inspire and Guide us in our Life. Fondly Remembered by : Sanju (wife) Ravi, Rupali, Karan & Simram.

9th Death Anniversary

EDWARD JOSEPH DSOUZA

Death cannot weaken the bond we share Flavia & Children

SAD DEMISE

1st Death Anniversary

Monica D'Souza

(28/03/1948 - 31/07/2022)

Fondly Remembered by Patrick D'Souza & Family Ashley Fernandes & Family

SAD DEMISE

Capt. Xavier Fernandes

Beloved Husband of Joan

Loving Father of Joel, Jayson & Johann

expired July 26, 2023

Funeral on August 01, 2023

Viewing at 3:30 pm, followed by Mass at 4:00 pm.

Sacred Heart Church, Santa Cruz (W), Mumbai

Burial at Juhu Cemetery.

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“Focused on inclusive growth of the state of Uttarakhand, the guiding light for the government is the motto, ‘Reform-Perform-Transform’. Uttarakhand’s potential in significant areas are being buttressed so that direct benefit accrues to the young generations. To spearhead and encourage a conducive ecosystem, investors and stakeholders have the support of the government in all initiatives.”
- Pushkar Singh Dhami
Chief Minister, Uttarakhand



PARVATMALA PROJECT

This project is all geared to change the fate of the state in the times to come

Kedarnath and Hemkund projects have been approved under the Parvatomala project. This project is also worth more than Rs 3,000 crore and it is expected to increase pilgrimage and tourism in the state by leaps and bound.

Destination Uttarakhand

Uttarakhand marching towards development path

TAKING FORWARD UTTARAKHAND GOVERNMENT’S COMMITTED DEVELOPMENTAL ACCOMPLISHMENTS

Under the able leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the proactive leadership of Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami, Uttarakhand is achieving greater dimensions in its developmental journey, thanks to the force and might of its double-engine government

FOCUS ON ‘NAVRATNA’ OF DEVELOPMENT

PIC CREDIT: DIPR, GOVT OF UTTARAKHAND



Reconstruction work in Kedarnath-Badrinath Dham worth Rs 1,300 crore



Tehri Lake Development work at a cost of Rs 1,930 crore



Foundation of Gaurikund, Kedarnath and Govindghat Hemkund Sahib ropeway



More than 4,000 homestays developed



Manaskhand Temple Garland Mission

PIC CREDIT: DIPR, GOVT OF UTTARAKHAND



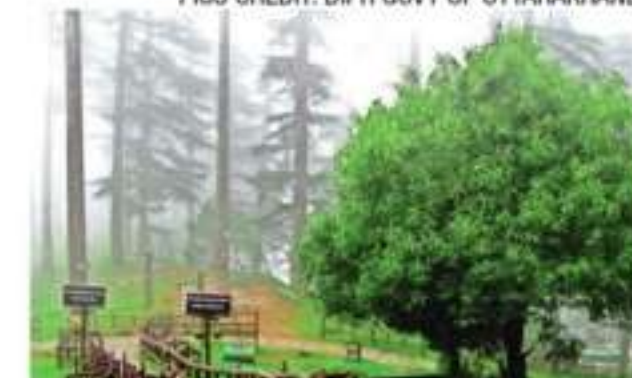
Satellite Center of AIIMS, Rishikesh, at Udham Singh Nagar



Uttarakhand became the center of adventure tourism and yoga



Survey of Tanakpur-Bageshwar rail line



Development of 16 eco-tourism destinations

MULTI-MODAL CONNECTIVITY EASING TRAFFIC

NEW AVENUES OF DEVELOPMENT AND EMPLOYMENT ARE EMERGING FAST

Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s goal for the all-round development of Uttarakhand is not only seeped in religious faith, but his dream is to make Devbhoomi self-sufficient and thriving. Under the guidance of the state government headed by Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami, there are new initiatives and unprecedented work being done on multi-modal connectivity.

PM Modi laid the foundation stone of the dream project Sonprayag-Kedarnath ropeway. The distance of seven hours will be completed in 30 minutes.

SONPRAYAG-KEDARNATH ROPEWAY

- The ropeway when completed will be about 9.7 km long till Kedarnath Dham. It will connect Gaurikund to Kedarnath. The travel time between the two places will come down to around 30 minutes from the present 6-7 hours.
- The project is targeted to be completed by June 2026. About a 9.7 km long project will cost Rs 1,268 crore.
- The first option is to make Kedarnath Yatra safe by securing the foot journey, especially for the elderly, children and the disabled. Another option is Heli service which is not possible for all.
- The option of ropeway will be very convenient, due to which the journey of children, old people, soldiers and disabled will be easy. Also, it will make this religious journey adventurous as well as safe.



PIC CREDIT: DIPR, GOVT OF UTTARAKHAND

THE STATE GOVERNMENT IS MOVING FORWARD WITH ITS EFFORTS TO MAKE UTTARAKHAND THE BEST STATE IN THE COUNTRY BY THE YEAR 2025

26 schemes worth Rs 306 crore were dedicated to the public

PIC CREDIT: DIPR, GOVT OF UTTARAKHAND



- The newly constructed Gadarpur bypass and Khatima bypass were also included in the schemes.
- In Udham Singh Nagar district, 26 schemes worth Rs 30,606.75 lakh have been started for the public. The inauguration of the newly constructed Gadarpur bypass and the newly constructed Khatima bypass were also included in this.
- Length of the 4-lane Gadarpur bypass inaugurated is 8.8 km and the cost is Rs 170 crore while Khatima bypass is 2-lane with a paved shoulder. Its length is 8.25 km and the cost is Rs 95 crore.
- With the inauguration of the bypass, the long-standing demand of Khatima and Gadarpur area residents has been fulfilled. Local people will get

- Kailash Mansarovar will be done through these routes only.
- During the last five years, a road and rail network is being laid to strengthen the infrastructure projects in Uttarakhand. After the completion of the construction of all these projects, the road connectivity in the state will be very good.
- In the last three-four years, work on road and transport facilities has been hastened in the state. Work is going on everywhere from the plains to the mountains. Due to this, road connectivity in the state will be very good in the coming times resulting in huge increase in tourism for Chardham Yatra. Out of the major development projects sanctioned in the State during the last five years

- In Udham Singh Nagar district, 26 schemes worth Rs 30,606.75 lakh have been started for the public.
- Length of the 4-lane Gadarpur bypass inaugurated is 8.8 km and the cost is Rs 170 crore
- Soon work will also be done on 4 lane road from Tanakpur to Sitarganj and Pilibhit to Khatima.
- During the last five years, a road and rail network is being laid to strengthen the infrastructure projects in Uttarakhand.
- In the last three-four years, work on road and transport facilities has been hastened in the state

benefit from the construction of both these bypasses. Both Khatima and Gadarpur cities will also get relief from jams. With the construction of the bypass, the travel time from Rudrapur-Tanakpur and from Rudrapur to Kashipur or other nearby cities will be reduced.

■ Soon work will also be done on 4 lane road from Tanakpur to Sitarganj and Pilibhit to Khatima. This route is also an important stop for Kailash Mansarovar, in the coming days the journey of

- The most important is the Dehradun to Delhi elevated expressway which is about 200 km long.
- With this project of more than Rs 2,000 crore being built in phases, the distance from the national capital to Dehradun will be just two hours.
- With the construction of this expressway, there will be a huge increase in Chardham Yatra and along with it tourism and industrial development will also gain momentum.

Bringing prosperity through connectivity

The only way to economic prosperity and well being of the people of any region is connectivity with the people of the world. The vision of Honourable Prime Minister Narendra Modi for making Uttarakhand state one of the leading states of the country is through physical connectivity. As per the development plans envisaged by the Prime Minister, the development of tourism whether it is religious, adventure or wildlife tourism, depends entirely on better connectivity through road, rail and by air. His personal interest in the development of infrastructure particularly at Kedarnath, Badrinath, Gangotri and Yamunotri temples has been note-worthy.

The ‘Char Dham’ All Weather road project worth Rs 12,000 crore will provide round the year connectivity to these revered shrines and boost tourism. The focus of the central government as well as the state government has been on improving connectivity through some mega projects. Already more than 15 lakh pilgrims had visited Kedarnath and Badrinath, an all-time record for the state.

- The work of Rishikesh-Karnprayag Prayag project is going on fast. Likely to be completed by 2024-25
- Agreement on Tanakpur-Bageshwar and Doiwala-Gangotri-Yamunotri rail line survey
- Government of India’s consent on doubling of Haridwar-Dehradun rail line

Air Connectivity

Uttarakhand Civil Aviation Development Authority has issued an aerodrome license to Naini Saini Airport, Pithoragarh by the Directorate General of Civil Aviation. This will be a big step towards strengthening the air connectivity of the state. The Chief Minister had requested the Civil Aviation Development Authority to grant an aerodrome license to Naini Saini Airport Pithoragarh.

- New terminal opened at Jolly Grant Airport
- Plan to develop Greenfield Airport at Udham Singh Nagar in Kumaon region

- Uttarakhand is the first state where Heli service has been started in air service

Communication Connectivity

- In present times, communication connectivity is also an aspect of development, and rapid development is not possible without communication facilities.
- Proposes to provide 4G/5G high-speed broadband and fiber internet facilities in rural areas of Uttarakhand
- Approval of 1202 towers of BSNL in remote and border areas of Uttarakhand
- Mobile connectivity has be-

The Rishikesh-Karnprayag railway line project is another milestone that aimed to change the economy of the entire region. The 126-kilometer-long railway line is going to be an engineering marvel as it would take the train to Garhwal Himalayas to facilitate pilgrimage and tourism besides

giving a boost to the local economy. The railway line being built is expected to be completed by 2024 end. The Union government is also determined to provide the best of air connectivity in the state.

Already, plans are afoot for the expansion of infrastructure at Dehradun Pantnagar Airport and Naini Saini Air-port at Pithoragarh.

PIC: ARUSHI CHAUHAN



come available for the pilgrims coming to Kedarnath Dham. Due to this, local people and devotees coming from other states will not have to face network-related problems. Along with this, 4G network facility has also been made available in Char Dham and Hemkund Sahib. The introduction of 4G service will benefit the pilgrims and the local people. A total of five towers are to be set up between Gaurikund and Kedarnath Dham. Three towers have been installed at Chhoti Lincholi, Lincholi and Rudrapur. The other two towers will also start functioning very soon.

Full-capacity towers have been installed at important travel stops like Sonprayag.

Road Connectivity

Road and rail network is being laid in the state.

- The state of Uttarakhand is continuously touching new heights of development in the government headed by Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami
- Today, under the leadership of Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi, the government is working on providing resources to the last person. Roads are an important link in the delivery of resources to the last man.

Rail Connectivity

- The sound of the train on the green hills of the Himalayas will write a new story of development of Uttarakhand.
- Uttarakhand declared as 100% electric traction state.
- Delhi-Dehradun Vande Bharat Express will ensure ease of travel as well as greater comfort for passengers.
- Vande Bharat train running between Dehradun to Delhi
- This train running from Doon is the 18th Vande Bharat train of the country. The train has started running regularly between Dehradun and Delhi.

HEMKUND SAHIB ROPEWAY WILL BE THE HIGHEST IN THE WORLD

With the construction of ropeway, the number of devotees coming to Hemkund Sahib will increase. 60 percent of the devotees going to Badrinath will also be able to reach Hemkund Sahib.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi laid the foundation stone of Hemkund Sahib Ropeway. It will be the highest and longest ropeway in the world. Now there will be no problem in walking on the difficult roads of Hemkund Sahib. Hemkund Sahib is situated at an altitude of 15,200 feet. This is the Gurudwara situated on the highest peak of the world where Sikh devotees come to pay their obeisance.

The portals here remain open for the devotees only for five months in a year. The length of the ropeway to be built from Govindghat to Hemkund Sahib will be 12.4 km. With the construction of the ropeway, the number of devotees coming to Hemkund Sahib will increase. 60 percent of the devotees going to Badrinath will also be able to reach Hemkund Sahib.

THE JOURNEY WILL BE COMPLETED IN 45 MINUTES
With the construction of a ropeway from Govindghat to Hemkund Sahib, the journey will be completed in just 45 minutes. At present, one has to trek for about 19 km to

PIC CREDIT: DIPR, GOVT OF UTTARAKHAND



reach Hemkund Sahib. With the construction of the ropeway, the devotees will reach Hemkund Sahib from Govindghat in just 45 minutes, while the expenditure and its construction will benefit the elderly and disabled devotees.

Text: Anjali Nauriyal

CONSUMER CONNECT INITIATIVE

Painful to see disruptions in House: Birla

New Delhi/Guwahati: Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla on Sunday expressed anguish over the manner in which Parliament proceedings are being disrupted and urged the legislators not to treat the House only as a physical building but a sacred place where the problems of people are solved through healthy debates and discussion.

The Speaker made these remarks while inaugurating the new assembly building in Guwahati. "All members, irrespective of their political affiliations, should try to preserve dignity and decorum of legislative bodies," the Lok Sabha speaker said while speaking on the role of public representatives in upholding and strengthening democracy. Reminding that the discussions held in legislatures have a profound impact on the general populace, he appealed to the lawmakers to use legislative forum for fulfilling the hopes of the people. **TNN**

CPM MP: Panel's adoption of report on data bill illegal

Writes To LS Speaker, RS Chairman

Swati.Mathur@timesgroup.com

New Delhi: CPM MP John Brittas has challenged the parliamentary panel's report on 'Citizen's Data Security and Privacy' adopted last week on grounds that the bill the report sought to examine has neither been introduced in either House of Parliament nor been referred to the standing committee for examination.

Calling the adoption of a report on the bill "illegal", especially because it was done despite the opposition's protests and the subsequent walkout from the panel's meeting on July 26, John Brittas wrote to the Lok Sabha speaker and the Rajya Sabha chairman urging



Opposition members walked out of the last meeting of a standing committee on communications and IT after two BJP MPs insisted that it adopt the Digital Personal Data Protection Bill without study

that they should not allow the report to be tabled in either House due to this "jurisdictional ouster".

All opposition members had walked out of the last meeting of the department-related standing committee on communications and IT after BJP MPs Nishikant Dubey and Anil Agarwal insisted that the panel adopt the Digital Personal Data Protection Bill, even though

the bill has neither been introduced in Parliament nor has the panel been allowed to examine it.

Brittas said the report, 'Citizen's Data Security and Privacy', contained recommendations of the House panel on the Digital Personal Data Protection Bill even though committees are "explicitly prohibited from examining any bills that have not been referred to them

by the chairman or speaker after their introduction in either House".

Citing rules of procedure of both Houses, Brittas said failure to follow the norms made it "evident that the above report of the standing committee on communications and IT, said to be adopted on 26th July 2023, is void ab initio and is ultra vires of the powers of the standing committee conferred by the rules".

"The rules proscribe the standing committee from examining such a yet to be introduced bill. It can be found beyond an iota of doubt that the impetuous action of the committee in including comments and recommendations on this bill is far beyond its jurisdiction and as such, rendering the report liable to be nullified," Brittas said. He added that he and other opposition MPs had registered their protest against the illegalities at the meeting.

BJP to launch drive to boost social media before '24 polls

Manash.Gohain@timesgroup.com

New Delhi: Given the significance of social media and its potential, BJP ahead of the 2024 elections will be launching "Shankhnaad" campaign to strengthen its social media machinery at the state level. The party has clubbed the states/UTs into seven zones and each zone's zonal prabharis and volunteers engagement prabharis were appointed on Saturday for overseeing the implementation of the campaign. State-level workshops are to be organised by August 30 which will also review the performance of the state social media team.

In a letter to the members, Arun Singh, national general secretary of BJP, stated, "...under the leadership of national president Shri Jagat Prakash Nadda ji, we will be launching the Shankhnaad campaign. Keeping the upcoming 2024 Lok Sabha elections in mind and the potential and significance of the machinery from the state to mandal level, we will expand the on-ground social media network."

The party in its two-pronged approach is going to conduct state and district-level so-

Cong survey: Five T'gana seats pose hurdle in plan to oust BRS

Subodh.Ghildiyal@timesgroup.com

New Delhi: As Congress seeks the "Karnataka effect" in neighbouring Telangana, an internal survey has shown that the party has dramatically improved in the last couple of months, but five parliamentary constituencies are its barren land that are posing a serious challenge to its ambitious bid to oust Bharath Rashtra Samithi from power.

The survey has found that Congress is winning virtually negligible seats in Hyderabad, Secunderabad, Malkajgiri, Adilabad and Nizamabad. The first three seats are in and around the state capital, the stronghold of AIMIM, with

Malkajgiri Lok Sabha represented by state Congress chief Revanth Reddy. Nizamabad was once a Congress stronghold, won twice by Telangana working president Madhu Yashki, but has drifted to BRS and BJP since 2014.

Out of the 35 assembly constituencies in these five LS seats, Congress is found to be winning practically nothing. The survey by party strategist Sunil Kanugolu was shared last week with a state Congress committee. The concern is that if Congress does not improve here in the run-up to the end-year polls, it would face the daunting task of scoring a high strike rate to touch the majority mark of 60 seats from the remaining 85-odd assembly seats.

Nicobar Islands for which Shantanu Kalita has been appointed as the organisational prabhar. The five states from south India—Karnataka, Telangana, Kerala, Puducherry and TN form zone 7 for which Giriraj has been appointed as the organisational prabhar.

Lack of master plan in 65% census towns led to construction chaos: Niti

Dipak.Dash@timesgroup.com

New Delhi: The Supreme Court observation of "city after city getting into bad shape" has once again brought to light how lack of planned development is resulting in "autonomous" expansion, posing serious threat to urban areas. As per Niti Aayog, almost 65% of urban settlements or census towns in India have no 'master plan', which has led to piecemeal interventions, haphazard construction and environmental pollution.

'HAS LED TO PIECEMEAL INTERVENTIONS'

The Niti Aayog report titled 'Reforms in Urban Planning Capacity in India', released two years ago, had revealed that as of 2021 about two-third of the census towns do not have master plans to guide their spatial growth. The data compiled by the Town and Country Planning Organisation (TCPO) of the housing and urban affairs ministry also showed that out of the 4,041 'statutory towns', 1,566 had approved master plans and another 359 were under preparation. In the case of 'census towns' only 650 out of the total 3,892 had approved master plans and 268 were under preparation.

Statutory towns are settlements notified under law by the state and UT concerned and have local bodies such as municipal corporations, municipalities, municipal committees. Census towns are settlements that are classified as urban in the census but these do not necessarily have urban local bodies.

Taking note of the "alarming" reality, Niti Aayog had said, "In the present scenario, about 52% of the statutory towns and 76% of the census towns do not have any master plan to guide their spatial growth and infrastructural investments. This implies that three-fourth of the urban centres in the country do not have any spatial strategy for the next 20 years."

Speaking at the National Urban Planning Conclave, Union urban affairs secretary Manoj Joshi had flagged how nearly half of the states and most cities don't have urban planners and smaller cities have none. He had added that the Centre wants all states and cities to have urban planners in adequate numbers.

Master plans are critical for managing urbanisation as these are statutory instruments to guide and regulate the present and future utilisation of land, expansion, and zoning of cities for 20-25 years.

All entry routes to NDA closed for Nitish: BJP netas

Patna: A day after Union minister and RPI chief Ramdas Athawale extended an open invitation to Bihar CM Nitish Kumar to return to the NDA fold, senior BJP leaders on Sunday said all entry routes to the party have been tightly shut for him and his JD(U), reports Manoj Chaurasia.

"The fact is that BJP has shut all its doors on Nitish and even if he wants to come, the party is not ready to accept him," BJP Rajya Sabha member Sushil Modi told ANI on Sunday.

Raj mulls bill to stop land auction over ryots' dues

Jaipur: Rajasthan's Ashok Gehlot government will bring to the assembly on August 2 a proposed law that aims to prevent auction of farmers' land in case they fail to repay loans, and allows for rescheduling and waiver of such debt.

Through Rajasthan State Farmers Debt Relief Commission Act, 2023—being brought ahead of assembly polls later this year—the government aims to reach out to farmers who suffer crop loss due to famine, flood, hailstorms and other natural calamities. **TNN**

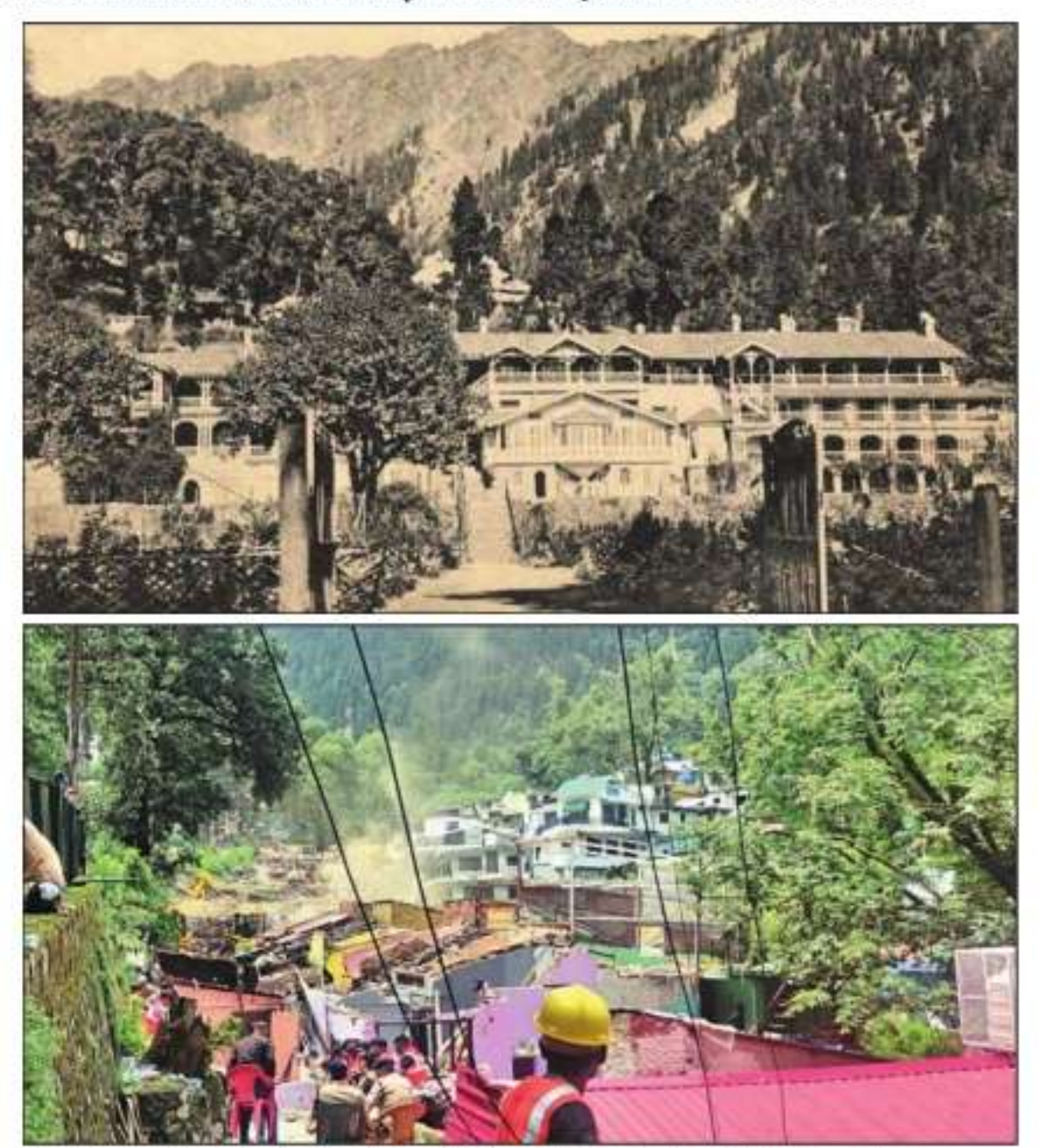
Haunt of celebs to parking lot, how a hotel's fortunes changed

Built in 1880, Nainital's Metropole Hotel was a lavish place frequented by celebrities—Jinnah spent his honeymoon there and Hungarian painter Elisabeth Sass Brunner created the 'Last Winter' while she was one of its guests. It was also one of the first designated enemy properties. Over a 100 families that had encroached on its land were recently evicted, reports Pankul Sharma

The recent demolition of encroached areas at the dilapidated Metropole Hotel in Nainital has put into focus the changing image of what was once the haunt of celebrities. Built in 1880, the hotel was spread over 10 acres and the roof design became so famous that it was replicated in other parts of the country and came to be known as the 'Nainital-pattern roof'.

The building was constructed by the British, later owned by Raja of Mahmudabad, Mohammad Amir Ahmad Khan, the leader of the Muslim League at the time of the Independence movement. When Khan moved to Pakistan after Partition, the hotel was leased by several people over the years, including famous historian Satyaketu Vidyalankar. Muhammad Ali Jinnah, the founding father of Pakistan, spent his honeymoon there in 1919. Hungarian painter Elisabeth Sass Brunner, along with daughter Elisabeth Brunner, was among the hotel's many celebrity guests. Brunner created a painting, titled 'Last Winter', there, inspired by the hotel's surroundings.

Nainital-based historian Ajay Rawat said, "Traveller and writer Rahul Sankrityayan stayed here for a long time while completing his book 'History of Kumaon'. Since Satyaketu (Vidyalankar) and Rahul were good friends, the latter came here on the former's invitation and they spent time discussing the history of the place. Kailash Nath Kat-



Metropole Hotel in its heydays (top) and encroachers being evicted

ju, a former cabinet minister in the Nehru government, often stayed here. Since the hotel does not have a lakeside view, it was less preferred by cine stars, but Vinod Khanna stayed here when one of his relatives was commissioner of the Kumaon division."

The decline began with encroachments after the hotel was declared "enemy property" in the early 1960s. The old building with 16 cottages and over 70 exclusive rooms became shabby due to disrepair. En-

croachers built their houses on the hotel's open land. About 134 families have been living in the hotel's compound for decades. They were involved in a long struggle to stop their eviction after the Centre made the district magistrate custodian of enemy properties in 2017. They were eventually evacuated this month following the Supreme Court's orders, setting into motion the plan for the encroached portion to be converted into a parking lot.

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El Nino remains a worry for rest of the season

Amit.Bhattacharya
@timesgroup.com

New Delhi: During the unusually long active phase of the Indian monsoon, spells of extreme rainfall in the north and states such as Gujarat, Maharashtra and Telangana caused floods. As things stood on July 30, the northwest India region had an overall rain surplus of 33% (since June 1), central India 14% and south India 6%. However, east and north-east India continued to reel under a deficit of 25%.

While 19 of the 36 rainfall subdivisions of the country had a monsoon deficit of 20% or more a month ago, the number had reduced to six by July 30. Five of these subdivisions are in the east and northeast which is likely to get some rain during the next few days.

"We are expecting good rainfall over the next five-six days in Bihar, Jharkhand, gangetic West Bengal, east UP and northern parts of Odisha and Chhattisgarh," said IMD chief Mrutyunjay Mohapatra. He added the monsoon trough is likely to shift towards the Himalayan foothills by August 6-7, signalling the start of a weak phase of monsoon.

While it's normal for the monsoon to enter a weak phase or a break following an active spell, the presence of an El Nino, which has remained weak till now, could add a crease of worry for the remainder of the season.

"El Nino is not going to slow down and remains a



A volunteer in Delhi teaches flood-hit children under a flyover

Part of h'way washed away, Badri NH blocked

The national highway (NH) connecting to Badrinath was blocked for over 24 hours—for the second time in a week—after a 20 m stretch of the highway washed away on Saturday afternoon at Chamoli district's Lambagad area, a chronic landslide zone. As a result, several people, mostly pilgrims, were stuck on both sides of the road for a long duration. Eventually, the highway was opened on Sunday afternoon, a Chamoli disaster management official said.

worry for the monsoon. We must not underestimate its likely impact in the next two months," Rajeevan said.

The latest government figures showed that the area under kharif sowing in the country as on July 21 was 8.4% higher than the corresponding period of last year, indicating a marked pick-up on account of good rainfall.

Kindly let him go, he is innocent & young, jawan's mom urges ultras

Srinagar: The family members of soldier Javid Ahmad Wani, who has gone missing, said he had requested his mother to prepare some dishes for him to take back to his base in Ladakh, reports Saleem Pandit.

Around 8pm, he informed the family over the phone that he would return home within five or 10 minutes. He had gone half-an-hour earlier to neighbouring village in car to buy groceries. However, he did not come back until 8.30pm when neighbours informed the family that his car was abandoned near an orchard in Parannah village. "When his car was unlocked, we saw mutton, some bananas, and a pair of slippers inside the car. There

Man dies in J&K lock-up, probe on

The district administration of Udhampur, J&K, ordered a magisterial probe into the death of a 35-year-old man after he complained of chest pain inside a police lockup in the district early on Sunday, officials said. Relatives of the victim, Daleep Singh, 35, blocked the main road for over 3 hours, demanding an impartial inquiry into the incident.

were some bloodstains in the vehicle as well," the soldier's father Muhammad Ayoub Wani said on Sunday.

The family suspects that he may have been abducted by terrorists and has appealed for his safe return. In a video message circulating on social media, Wani's mother made an emotional appeal to his suspected abductors. "Kindly let him go. He is innocent and young. If he has done anything wrong, I seek forgiveness," she said.

Scores of relatives, neighbours, and residents from nearby areas were seen at Wani's home on Sunday, pleading for his safe return. The security forces have launched an extensive search operation for the soldier. Cases of terrorists abducting off-duty soldiers and policemen have occurred in southern and central Kashmir in the past.

In March 2022, Lashkar-e-Taiba terrorists abducted and killed soldier Sameer Ahmad Malla from J&K Light Infantry, whose body was found in an orchard in Budgam. In 2021, the decomposed body of a soldier from the Territorial Army, Shakir Manzoor Wagay of Shopian, was found in the Kulgam area in September, over a year after his abduction.

Government of Rajasthan
Office of the Chairman,
NEET PG Admission / Counseling Board-2023
RUHS College of Dental Sciences (Government Dental College),
Subhash Nagar, Behind T.B. Hospital, Jaipur, Rajasthan | Phone: 0141-2280090
https://medicaleducation.rajasthan.gov.in/me/#/home/dptHome |
www.rajmdsneet2023.com

No. State PG Counseling Board/2023/18 Dated: 28.07.2023

NOTIFICATION
State Dental P.G. Seats (MDS) Allotments-2023
The registration for PG Dental course (MDS) in Rajasthan shall commence on-line from 31.07.2023. The schedule for allotment will be as below:

Schedule for Allotment process

Application form (Registration) Start date for filling of on-line application form and deposition of required application fee It is a mandatory step for subsequent process of counseling and allotment. Both the parts (Part 1 and Part 2) of the application form must be filled and completed.	31.07.2023
Last date for depositing the application fee at the website	05.08.2023 (4.00 pm)
Last date for submitting the on-line application form at the website	05.08.2023 (11.45 pm)
Publishing of Provisional Seat Matrix	06.08.2023
Verification of Disability certificate (issued by 16 centers approved by MCC) of all persons with disabilities (PwD) candidates of all categories (at 9.00 am sharp at Lecture Theatre no. 1 of Govt. Dental College, Jaipur)	08.08.2023, 9.00 am
Verification, Allotment and Reporting by Sr. Demonstrator candidates for In-Service Quota (sub quota), (before the Board, 9.00 am sharp at RUHS College of Dental Sciences, Jaipur) (after applying / registering as per the procedure) All such candidates must present themselves physically alongwith all original relevant documents, before the Board	08.08.2023, 9.00 am
Publishing of provisional seat matrix (after Sr. Demonstrator allotments)	08.08.2023
Publishing of provisional merit list	08.08.2023
Deposition of security amount (refer the Instructions Booklet for details)	09.08.2023 to 11.08.2023 (4.00 pm)
On-line choice filling locking of the choices by the candidates (including filling up and saving of the choices / changing the filled choices multiple times)	09.08.2023 to 11.08.2023 (11.45 pm) (auto-locking of choices at 11.45 pm on 11.08.2023)
Printing of the on-line application form after auto-locking of the choices filled and saved by the candidates	12.08.2023
Declaration of the result	16.08.2023 (midnight)
Printing of allotment letters on-line, Joining, document checking and verification (including prescribed eligibility criteria) at the allotted college along with printout of allotment letter, all original documents, deposition of prescribed one year tuition fee, required bonds etc. and other documents as listed in instruction booklet	17.08.2023 to 20.08.2023 (10.00 am to 5.00 pm)
Further Processes	To be published later

1. Refer information booklet, college information sheet and college fee structure etc. and other information at the website. Regarding fee, also refer order dated 19.05.2022 of Hon'ble Supreme Court in civil appeal no. 3978-3995/2017.
2. All PwD candidates must present themselves physically for document verification before the admission board on 08.08.2023 as per the notification and the list to be made available at the website.
3. All candidates are required to deposit non-refundable application fee of Rs. 3000/- (Rs. 1500/- for SC, ST, ST-STA category candidate of Rajasthan state domicile) + applicable transaction charges.
4. The candidates are advised to visit the websites regularly for registration and other relevant information.

Chairman
NEET PG Admission / Counseling Board-2023, Jaipur, Rajasthan

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No. State PG Counseling Board/2023/17 Dated: 28.07.2023

NOTIFICATION
State Medical PG Seats (M.D / M.S) / Post MBBS DNB / Post MBBS Diploma Allotments-2023
The registration for MD/MS. Post MBBS DNB and Post MBBS Diploma courses in Rajasthan shall commence on-line from 31.07.2023. The schedule for allotment will be as below:

Schedule for Allotment process

Application form (Registration) Start date for filling of on-line application form and deposition of required application fee It is a mandatory step for subsequent process of counseling and allotment. Both the parts (Part 1 and Part 2) of the application form must be filled and completed.	31.07.2023
Last date for depositing the application fee at the website	06.08.2023 (4.00 pm)
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On-line choice filling locking of the choices by the candidates (including filling up and saving of the choices / changing the filled choices multiple times)	10.08.2023 to 12.08.2023 (11.45 pm) (auto-locking of choices at 11.45 pm on 12.08.2023)
Printing of the on-line application form after auto-locking of the choices filled and saved by the candidates	13.08.2023
Declaration of the result	16.08.2023 (midnight)
Printing of allotment letters on-line, Joining, document checking and verification (including prescribed eligibility criteria) at the allotted college along with printout of allotment letter, all original documents, deposition of prescribed one year tuition fee, required bonds etc. and other documents as listed in instruction booklet	17.08.2023 to 20.08.2023 (10.00 am to 5.00 pm)
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4. The candidates are advised to visit the websites regularly for registration and other relevant information.

Chairman
NEET PG Admission / Counseling Board-2023, Jaipur, Rajasthan

National Highways Authority of India
(Ministry of Road Transport and Highways)

भर्ती सूचना / RECRUITMENT NOTICE

भार.रा.प्रा., प्रतिनियुक्ति आधार पर निम्नलिखित पदों के लिए भर्ती हेतु आवेदन आमंत्रित करता है:-

NHAI invites applications for recruitment to the following posts on Deputation basis:-

Name of the posts	No. of posts	Pay Scale
प्रबंधक (राजभाषा) Manager (Rajbhasha)	01	पीबी-3 (रु. 15600-39100) + ग्रेड पे र. 8600/- (7वें सीपीसी के अनुसार पे मैट्रिक्स में लेवल 11 के समकक्ष)
प्रबंधक (रिजि) Manager (Legal)	02	PB-3 (Rs. 15600-39100) with Grade Pay Rs. 6600/- (equivalent to Level 11 in Pay Matrix as per 7 th CPC).

2. भार.रा.प्रा. की वेबसाइट (www.nhai.gov.in) पर उपलब्ध विस्तृत विज्ञापन में दी गई प्रक्रिया के अनुसार आवेदक दिनांक 13.09.2023 (सायं 6:00 बजे तक) ऑनलाइन आवेदन जमा सुनिश्चित करें।

The applicant is required to ensure submission of online application as per the procedure indicated in the detailed advertisement, available on NHAI website (www.nhai.gov.in), by 13.09.2023 (upto 6:00 PM).

3. आयु सीमा, योग्यता मानदंड, अन्य शर्तों आदि से संबंधित विस्तृत विवरण भार.रा.प्रा. की वेबसाइट पर देखे जा सकते हैं।

Details regarding age limit, eligibility criteria, other conditions etc. may also be accessed on NHAI website.

4. इस विज्ञापन के संबंध में शुद्धिपत्र/अनुशोध/निस्वीकरण, यदि कोई होगा, तो उसे केवल भार.रा.प्रा. की वेबसाइट पर प्रकाशित किया जाएगा।

Corrigendum/Addendum/Cancellation to this advertisement, if any, shall be published on NHAI website only.

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PUBLIC NOTICE

Our client is intending to enter into a Sale Transaction with M/s. KALASA ESTATE, a Partnership Firm, registered under the Indian Partnership Act, at Mysore with registration number 1308/68-69 on 06-12-1968, having its registered office at Kalasa Estate, Kalasa, Chikmagalur District, Karnataka, PIN 577124, duly represented by its present partners 1. Mr. S. Sivasubramaniyam and 2. Mr. S. AlaghuVairam, both aged about 29 years, sons of Mr. So.S.Sockalingam, residing at No.28, Thirunagar Colony, 4th Street, Erode District, Tamil Nadu PIN 638003, who is offering to sell the below mentioned schedule property. The schedule property mentioned below, was purchased by M/s Kalasa Estate, through its partners vide sale deed No. 249/1966-67, registered in the Office of Sub-Registrar, Mudigere, Karnataka State.

SCHEDULE OF PROPERTY

Village/Mandal/ District	Registered Document number	Regd on	Purchased From	Survey number	Acres and Guntas
Mavinakere Village KalasaHobli Mudigere Taluk Chickmagalur District	249/1966-67	16-07-1966	Hasmukhlal Mavaji Chawada	154 159 160 27-20 161 208/P 209 210 211	29-05 145-30 27-20 22-08 19-37 04-09 12-01 99-37 15-15
Marasanige Village KalasaHobli Mudigere Taluk Chickmagalur District	249/1966-67	16-07-1966	Hasmukhlal Mavaji Chawada	26	06-06
Total land being sold					382-08

Therefore, my client as part of their Due Diligence is causing this Public Notice, on the principle of 'Caveat Emptor' to put the public on notice in regard to this transaction, so as to rule out any third-party claims on the schedule of property (land).

If any Person(s), Institution(s), Statutory Authority(s), Company(s), Trust(s), or any other legal or juristic person's has got any legal objection; right; title; possession; interest(s); mortgage(s); lien(s); easements; leases or licenses; charges; attachments; or any sort of claims or intending, to oppose, this Sale transaction, as against the above mentioned Schedule Properties, shall approach the undersigned, with appropriate valid and legal documents, within ten(10) days from the date of publication of this public notice, either in person (or) by issuing their reply/response in writing, or by email to the undersigned. If no objections are received within the above stipulated time, it would be deemed that, there are no claims and/or objections, from any persons or entities/authorities, against our client, in purchasing the above schedule property. Any subsequent claim(s) or objection(s) after the said ten days shall not be entertained and they shall not be binding our client.

Kasuganti Lakshman Kumar, Advocate
15th Floor, Kapil Towers, Nanakramguda, Hyderabad-500 032
Mob: 7013956131 or 9848129022
Email: Kasugantivakil@gmail.com or secretarial@kapilgroup.com
Dt: 31/07/2023

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RECRUITMENT NOTICE

No.AUD/01/HR/2023/
Dr. B.R. Ambedkar University Delhi, a Delhi Government State University, is one of the few Universities in India with the core objective of promoting the study of humanities and social sciences and it recognises these disciplines as pivotal to the understanding and imagination of a society in transition. University's aim is to reconceptualise social sciences with innovative curricular and pedagogic processes. The University invites applications from the prospective & eligible candidates for the following posts as mentioned:

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2.	Assistant Registrar	L-10	04 (On Deputation)	Online *

* - Please visit website www.aud.ac.in for Qualifications, General Instructions, Eligibility Criteria, application form & other details.
Commencement of online & offline application from: 20.07.2023.
Last date to apply online & offline application: 04.08.2023 (up to 23:59 hrs).
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क्रमांक - सूची/IGSY/2023/4784 दिनांक - 29.07.2023

Notice Inviting Bid

Bids for the selection of agency for infrastructural arrangements for organising Camps for Indira Gandhi Smartphone Yojana (IGSY) at each Block and District headquarters and other identified locations of bhiilwara rajasthan are invited from interest bidders upto 04 August 2023 12:00 Noon. Other particulars of the bid may be visited on the <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> and procurement portal <https://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in> of the state.

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PM: Panchayats to have inscriptions hailing martyrs

Launches 'Meri Mati Mera Desh' Campaign

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Sunday announced the launch of the 'Meri Mati Mera Desh' campaign in the run-up to Independence Day to honour martyred bravehearts of the country, with special inscriptions to be installed in panchayats in their memory.



PM Narendra Modi with veteran BJP leader Murli Manohar Joshi in New Delhi on Sunday

In his monthly radio talk 'Mann Ki Baat', the PM said 'Amrit Kalash Yatra' will be organised under the campaign and 7,500 pots carrying soil from different parts of the country will be brought to the national capital along with saplings.

"Amrit Vatika will be built near the National War Memorial by fusing the soil and saplings that will arrive in 7,500 urns. 'This Amrit Vatika' will become a grand symbol of 'Ek Bharat Shreshth Bharat'," he said.

Under the ongoing Amrit Mahotsav to mark the 75th anniversary of in-

dependence, over two lakh programmes have been organised. 'Meri Mati Mera Desh' will recall the memory of those brave men and women who laid down their lives for the country, the PM said.

Saying the whole country came together for the 'Har Ghar Tiranga' campaign last year, Modi urged people to continue the tradition of hoisting the tricolour at their houses this time too. "With these efforts, we will realise our duties, we will realise the innumerable sacrifices made for the freedom of the country, we will realise the value of freedom. Hence, every person in the country must join in these efforts," he added.

Referring to the recent floods, landslides and other natural calamities hitting different parts of the country during the monsoon season, he said people suffered at many places. Amid the natural calamities, people also brought to the fore the power of collective effort, he said.

Modi said it was encouraging to see people make novel efforts for water conservation at many places. He cited the record plantation of 30 crore saplings in a day in Uttar Pradesh, saying it was an example of public participation and awareness.

Over 60,000 'Amrit Sarovars' built during the 'Azaadi Ka Amrit Mahotsav' were helping in water conservation during the rainy season, he said, adding that over 50,000 more ponds were being built.

Modi said that during his recent visit to France, he met Charlotte Chopin, a yoga teacher who was more than 100 years old. "She gives credit for her health and this age of 100 years only to yoga. She has become a prominent face of India's science of yoga," he added.



Muskaan Ahmed & Mahima Anand | TNN

Some days, the students at SRM Public School in Chennai go around in circles; on other days they do a square dance. Sometimes it's two by two, and on a few days, the rows are back. Post-pandemic, some schools are turning the tables on classroom seating arrangements to give students a more social and interactive experience.

"When the students returned to school after the pandemic, we realised the importance of free, outdoor spaces as well as the need for better interaction among students in class," says Bhuvaneshwari, principal of SRM Public School. "We made our classroom seating arrangements flexible. Some of our creative, hands-on classes like robotics and art are taught in the broad corridors of the school, which are filled with bean bags and couches instead of regular furniture."

At the school, says Bhuvaneshwari, teachers have the freedom to change the position of the furniture according to their needs. "We observed since adopting this, there has been an increase in classroom participation, peer learning, and adaptability," she says.

Several schools such as SRM have done away with the traditional row layout of chairs and tables facing the blackboard.

KC High, for example, uses trapezoid-shaped tables that can be fixed together in different ways to facilitate group work and separated for solo tasks. "This arrangement helps teachers navigate easily through the class and interact with all the students. When put in smaller groups,

children feel free to express their opinions," says Sindu Sunil of KC High. "When children face each other, it improves their interaction, participation, and collaboration. They can observe small things in an interaction that cannot be seen in a traditional setup."

Schools need to be viewed as a



place of growth and development, says educationist K R Maalathi. "Seating arrangements play a role in promoting creativity in teaching methods and encourage students to think outside the box," she says. "The furniture in most traditional classrooms cannot be moved because they are heavy and of poor quality. School managements do not consider furniture an important part of learning. But the simple act of reorganising tables can help teachers develop new and effective ways of teaching that will pique the

Round tables, multi-level, conference or banquet style, schools are rearranging classrooms to enhance learning and interaction

Children, BE SEATED Eye to I, you to U

TRY THIS AT SCHOOL

ROUNDTABLE OR CONFERENCE STYLE |

Encourages group interactions and teachers can easily control discussions



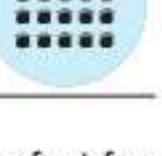
HORSESHOE |

Makes sessions more interactive



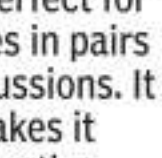
GRID: Perfect when you

want students to work individually or during tests



BANQUET | This

setup is perfect for activities in pairs or discussions. It also makes it easier for the teacher to go around and supervise work



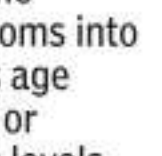
SEMI-CIRCULAR | Effective

when audio-visual aids and interactive boards are being used as it ensures clear visibility



MULTI-LEVEL | Can be used

to split the classrooms into various age groups or learning levels



FLEXI | This can be done by

using custom-made tables that can be fixed together in different shapes to facilitate group work and solo tasks



STUDIES SHOW THAT THE HORSHOE LAYOUT HAD THE BEST RESULTS IN TERMS OF PARTICIPATION

Up to 65% rise in Kashi's tourism-related income

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: The record-breaking increase in tourists in Varanasi in recent years is attributable to the opening of the revamped Kashi Vishwanath corridor as well as the Centre's fresh impetus to religious tourism. In his Sunday's 'Mann Ki Baat', PM Modi said the tourist footfall in Varanasi has crossed 10 crore a year.

Independent surveys have pegged the footfall in Varanasi at an eight-fold increase as compared to Goa in 2022. A survey by ICICI Direct suggested that while Varanasi received 7.2 crore tourists in 2022, Goa was far behind with 85 lakh.

The impact of the tourism boost, the PM pointed out, is being felt on lives and livelihoods. The survey said Varanasi's tourism-related income ballooned by 20-65%, while employment in the sector shot up by 34.2%.

This ties into the Union tourism ministry's own data, which pegs over 60% of tourism in India in the religious and spiritual tourism category. Ministry data also suggests that economies surrounding places of worship in India raked in close to Rs 1.3 lakh crore in 2022, up from Rs 65,070 crore in 2021. The PM also said that while Varanasi leads in footfall, other temple towns such as Ayodhya, Mathura and Ujjain are not far behind.

Modi also referenced two American pilgrims, who undertook the Amarnath Yatra inspired by the experiences of Swami Vivekananda. "They got so inspired that they them-



BJP leaders in Delhi listen to Mann Ki Baat

PM 'messiah of poor', says Shah, sounds MP poll bugle

Home minister Amit Shah on Sunday sounded the poll bugle in Madhya Pradesh's Malwa region by launching a scathing attack on the Congress party and the Kamal Nath government that was in power for one-and-half years in the state. Shah termed PM Modi a 'messiah of the poor' and a 'strong leader', who stood up to the challenges facing national security. He was addressing 'Vijay Sankalp Sammelan' of BJP booth-level workers.

Shah came for the Amarnath Yatra. They consider it as the blessings of Lord Bholenath. This is the specialty of India that she accepts everyone, gives something or the other to everyone," he said. The PM also lauded the efforts of French yoga practitioner Charlotte Chopin, who despite being over 100 years, is a prominent face of India's science of yoga and its strength.

'Bhojpatra calligraphy' biz by Mana women a boost for economy: PM

Kautilya.Singh@timesgroup.com

Dehradun: During the 103rd edition of 'Mann Ki Baat', Prime Minister Narendra Modi highlighted how the business of 'bhojpatra calligraphy' by the women of Mana village near Badrinath, regarded as the last village before the India-China border at Uttarakhand, has taken off, helping them improve the economy of the region.

On July 11, TOI was among the first to report how the tribal women here had begun to use calligraphy on bhojpatras as a means of earning in a region with few economic opportunities due to the tough geographical conditions. Found at a height of 3,000m or above, bhojpatra (Himalayan Birch) is a tree whose bark acts as paper on which text can be written.

The women write religious messages on bhojpatras, which are then sold for Rs 800 to Rs 1,200 per piece. At least 40 women have been trained till now and the bhojpatras prepared by them are being sold at the government outlet

Talking about the initiative displayed by the women, Modi said, "The letters written by some mothers and sisters of Devbhoomi Uttarakhand to me are touchingly heart-warming. They had never imagined that our erstwhile cultural heritage, bhojpatra, could become a means of their livelihood. Since ancient times, our

scriptures and books have been preserved on these bhojpatras. Mahabharata was also written on the bhojpatra."

The Prime Minister added: "Today, these women are making beautiful artefacts and souvenirs from the bhojpatra. I had appreciated their efforts and asked tourists coming to Devbhoomi to buy as many local products as possible during their visit. It has had a great impact. Today, the products of bhojpatra are very much liked by the pilgrims who are buying them at good prices."

The women write religious messages on bhojpatras, which are then sold for Rs 800-Rs 1,200 per piece. At least 40 women have been trained till now and the bhojpatras prepared by them are being sold at a government outlet in Badrinath.

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Sunday said India had created a unique record of destroying 10 lakh kg of drugs worth more than Rs 12,000 crore. In his 'Mann Ki Baat' on Sunday, the PM said, "Two weeks ago, India has taken a huge action against drugs". "After seizing about 1.5 lakh kg of drugs, it has been destroyed. India has also created a unique record of destroying 10 lakh kg of drugs. The cost of these drugs was more than Rs 12,000 crore."

"The increasing participation of youth in the campaign against drug abuse is very encouraging. These efforts lend a lot of strength to the campaign against drugs in India. If we want to

'4k women went on Haj sans male companion'

PM Narendra Modi said he has received a large number of letters from women who went on Haj without male companion. Sharing that reading these letters has given him satisfaction as more than 4,000 women went on Haj in this category this year, the PM said, this reflects a "huge transformation". "This journey of theirs is very special in many ways," the PM said.

save the future generations of the country, we have to keep them away from drugs. With this thought, 'Nasha Mukti Bharat Abhiyan' was launched on the August 15, 2020," he added.

MUNICIPAL CORPORATION CHANDIGARH

TENDER NOTICE

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Bid Submission Schedule (Online)	Opening Technical Bid (Online)
EXECUTIVE ENGINEER - MCPH Division No. 4			
1.	Operation, maintenance and Watch & Ward of Public Toilet Blocks in various markets and villages including maintenance of Public Health & Electrical fixtures/installations complete in all respects for period of 12 months under the EE MCPH Division No.4 Chandigarh (Ch.to: Revenue Head) (re-invite) Approximate Amount : Rs. 243.50 Lacs Time Limit : 12 Months	28.07.2023 To 04.08.2023 at 02:00 P.M	04.08.2023 at 03:00 P.M

Note:- All other terms and conditions and complete DNIT are uploaded on website <https://etenders.chd.nic.in>

EXECUTIVE ENGINEER
M.C.P.H. Division No. 4, New Deluxe Building, Room No.410, 4th Floor, Sector -17, Chandigarh

J'khand committee booked for insulting national flag

Daltonganj: Police in Jharkhand's Palamu district registered a criminal case against Kalyanpur Muharram Inteezamiya Committee after the magistrate on Muharram duty lodged an FIR against the accused for insulting the national flag. On July 28, a few committee members hoisted a lookalike of the national flag—which had saffron colour at the top, a white in the middle, and green at the bottom—but instead of the Ashoka Chakra, the flag bore a line in Arabic with a sword beneath it.

3 electrocuted in Raj during tazia procession; toll 11 across 4 states

Alwar/Jaipur: Tazia procession-related electrocution incidents continued unabated, with Rajasthan's Dholpur district reporting three such deaths on Sunday, taking the total toll across four states to 11 in the last 36 hours. On Saturday, four deaths were reported from Bokaro in Jharkhand, two from Amroha in UP, and two deaths from Rajkot in Gujarat.

In Dholpur, three youths were electrocuted when they came in contact with a high-tension wire on their way to the burial of tazia on Sunday morning, a day after Muharram, at Karbala Maidan under Kotwali police station area. A fourth youth, who too got the shock, survived and is undergoing treatment for burn injuries.

According to the police, as part of the tazia procession, several youths were on their way for the burial. "Suddenly, a portion of the tazia got in contact with an 11KV electricity line and four youths carrying it sustained burn injuries. Among the four, Muveem, Anwar and Waseem got severe injuries and were killed," a police officer said. The fourth, who became unconscious, was given CPR by the doctors at a hospital and he survived the shock, the officer added.

15% of over 13.5k kids rescued in 2016-22 worked in eateries: Study

Ambika.Pandit@timesgroup.com

New Delhi: More than 15% of over 13,500 children rescued from exploitative working conditions were employed in a hotel or a dhaba, revealed a study of data available with Kailash Satyarthi Children's Foundation. The 'mom-and-pop' automobile and transport industry was second in the list of sectors at 13%, followed by garments industry, retail shops/office and cosmetics.

The least number of rescues were made from the cosmetics industry; however, it employed the maximum number of children (26) in the tender age group of 5 to 8 years. The reasons for employing very small children is for packing of small items like lipsticks for which small hands are preferred. Also, employers do not like to pay for packing, so most of these kids do not get any money.

These findings released to mark World Day Against Trafficking in Persons observed each year on July 30 are based on a study of data available with Kailash Satyarthi Children's Foundation based on rescue operations carried out to free children from exploitative conditions from across 262 districts and 21 states in India between the year 2016 and 2022.

The study also analysed the data on factories from where children were rescued and the tasks assigned to them. Electricals and electronics factories employed the maximum number of trafficked children in bulb making, followed by wire packing and factory helper. UP saw the maximum number of children trafficked on an average per year.

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E-Mail: gmdrug.tnmsc@tn.gov.in, mngprdrug.tnmsc@tn.gov.in

Sealed Tenders are invited by the Tender Inviting Authority, Tamilnadu Medical Services Corporation Ltd., Chennai – 600008, from the bidders meeting the eligibility criteria indicated in the tender document for the supply of **Beltless Sanitary Napkin with Wings** to TNMSC Ltd for **two years** from the date of acceptance of the tender.

Sl. No	Description	e-Tender Reference	Tender Floating Period	e-Tender Submission Duration	Date and time of online opening of Technical Bids
1	Online Tender for the supply of Beltless Sanitary Napkin with Wings to TNMSC Ltd., under rate contract system for two years from the date of acceptance	e-009/M(P)/BL-SANIT/TNMSC/2023, Dated, 31.07.2023	31.07.2023 at 3.00 PM to 31.08.2023 upto 3.00 PM	14.08.2023 at 10.00 AM to 31.08.2023 upto 3.00 PM	31.08.2023 at 4.00 PM

The Prebid meeting is to be held on **08.08.2023 at 11.30 AM** at the Office of Tamil Nadu Medical Services Corporation Limited, No.417, Pantheon Road, Egmore, Chennai – 600008.

The tender document can be downloaded and the tender shall be submitted at <https://etenders.gov.in>. The tender document can also be downloaded at www.tnmsc.tn.gov.in for reference purpose.

DIPR/4096/Tender/2023

Tender Inviting Authority / General Manager (Drugs)

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PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and film trade in particular that one of Our Clients has acquired, from the legal heirs of Late Mr. Kishore Kumar ("Personality"), an exclusive license to adapt the life story of the Personality including without limitation his personal experiences, incidents, situations and events, including aspects of the Personality's life and his interactions with his family members ("Life Story"), for developing / producing/co-producing, distributing and exploiting the Hindi language feature film ("Film").

We state that, Our Client has the exclusive license to make / develop, produce/co-produce the Film based Life Story and distribute, market and exploit the (i) Film in Hindi language, (ii) dubbed and subtitled versions of the Film in all languages of the world ("Territory") and (iii) remake rights of the Film in all languages of the Territory; on all modes, medium and formats (whether existing now and arising in future) throughout the Universe in perpetuity ("Rights").

ANY person, firm and/or company having any claim, of whatsoever nature, against or in relation to the Life Story of the Personality and/or the said Rights by way of assignment, pledge, gift, mortgage, charge, sale, litigation, and/or transfer of any kind or in any manner whatsoever are hereby required to make the same known in writing along with documentary proof and evidence of the aforesaid claim at the address mentioned herein below, within 15 (fifteen) days from the date of publication hereof; otherwise the acquisition will be deemed completed without any reference to such claim and the same, if any, will be considered as waived for which we shall not be liable or responsible, which may please be noted.

Any claims and/or objection received after the expiry of the stipulated 15 (fifteen) days or claims without any documentary proof (certified true copies) or evidence shall not be entertained ("Defective Claims"). All such Defective Claims shall be deemed to be invalid and/or deemed to have been unconditionally renounced/waived by such claimants and we shall not be responsible for any such Defective Claims.

Place: Mumbai.
Date: 31st July, 2023

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No: KSMSC/DRUGS/TND/SHUCHI-SN/47/2023-24 Dated: 28.07.2023

TENDER NOTIFICATION

Ref: 1. Tender Notification No KSMSC/DRUGS/TND/SHUCHI-SN/47/2023-24, Dated: 01.08.2023 (IND-0023).

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Details regarding EMD, Terms and Conditions and other information are available in the Tender Document, which can be downloaded from the website <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> from **01.08.2023**. The eligible tenderers shall submit their e-tenders under e-procurement platform for above mentioned tenders. Further information if any may be obtained from this office.

Sd/- Managing Director
KSMSC, Bangalore

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Why several MBBS and PG seats remain vacant after counselling

Most seats that remain vacant are in the pre- and para-clinical courses which are not the top choices

Sonal.Srivastava
@timesgroup.com

According to health ministry data shared in Lok Sabha recently, hundreds of seats in MBBS and postgraduate medical courses have remained vacant after the NEET UG, PG in the past few years. Doctors attribute the vacancies to exorbitant tuition fees charged by private medical colleges and a lack of interest in para-clinical and pre-clinical courses, for this situation.

Bharati Pravin Pawar, Minister of State (MoS), for Health and Family Welfare, recently shared the data regarding vacant seats in UG, PG medical programmes in the past three years in the ongoing monsoon session of Parliament. In 2022-23, 4,400 PG seats remained vacant, signalling an increase of 17.5% in vacant seats in comparison to 2021-22, when 3,744 seats remained vacant. A total of 860 MBBS seats remained vacant in the past three years. In terms of the increase in the number of seats, according to the health ministry data, there were 83,275 MBBS seats in 2020-21 and the number increased to 107,948 seats in 2023-24.

Talking about why seats remain vacant, a health ministry official on the condition of anonymity, says, "Most seats that remain vacant are in pre- and para-clinical courses which students do not prefer as most of them are interested in clinical courses for professional reasons. Some seats remain vacant in private medical colleges that charge exorbitant fees that students might not be able to afford. Another reason why seats remain vacant in pre- and para-clinical courses is that the number of clinical seats has also increased in the past few years hence students do not find the need to opt for para-clinical seats."

The official adds, "About 1500-1600 seats remain vacant every year. Para-clinical courses have limited possibilities of clinical practice, and there is already a saturation in the job market, hence only a few students opt for them." The pre- and para-clinical courses include Anatomy, Biochemistry, Physiology, Community Medicine, Forensic Medicine, Microbiology, and Pharmacology.

Some seats remain vacant in private medical colleges that charge exorbitant fees which students might not be able to afford

Students avoid admissions to lesser-known, newly minted private colleges as they fear NMC might cancel their recognition. "Students fear that after taking admission and paying the hefty fees if the NMC cancels the recognition of private colleges, then there will be a huge problem. Also, there is a lack of coordination in the counselling process. The central and the state committees are not in sync, students may get a seat in the central round of counselling but they may opt for a seat in the state counselling if they get a better college. Consequently, the seat locked in the central round remains vacant. Government is also not generating enough jobs for doctors who study non-clinical courses, so students who get these seats prepare for another year to get a seat of their choice," says Dr Rohan Krishnan, chairman, FAIMA Doctors Association.

Talking about the importance of pre- and para-clinical courses, Dr Ajit Kumar, director, Sharda University, Greater Noida, Uttar Pradesh, says that private colleges charge a high fee even for pre- and para-clinical courses, hence students who get seats in such courses do not take them. Consequently, there is a dearth of quality faculty in these subjects and new private medical colleges find it difficult to recruit faculty in non-clinical courses.

He says that another reason for the seats remaining vacant is students do not prefer medical colleges in remote areas.

NCERT plans to provide Maths book in 22 languages

c-Aditya.Wadhawan
@timesgroup.com

The National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT) has translated the newly produced textbook of Maths into 22 scheduled Indian languages to create a regional medium of education. The translation of the textbook is done through the Anuvadini translation tool, which works on the principle of machine translation. The entire



process will take one year to complete and all the translated versions of the textbooks will be made available on the Diksha portal. The translated version of

the books has been sent to the SCERTs of different states where its faculty which is well versed in the local language is reviewing it.

Speaking to *Education Times*, a source in NCERT on the condition of anonymity, says, "In the initial phase, the newly introduced textbook of Maths meant for classes I and II has been translated in the 22 scheduled Indian languages. The same process of translation would be followed for other subjects, which will be based on the NCF for School Education guidelines."

NCERT's curriculum developers were also involved in the translation process. "The curriculum developers supported the Indian language translators as per their need, to ensure that the translated text conveys the exact meaning in the original and translated language," added the source.

Textbooks in 22 Indian languages will smoothen the learning process for students in the rural

belt, where most students struggle with any language other than their native language.

Amarendra P Behera, joint director, CIET-NCERT, says, "For translating the textbooks in 22 Indian languages, we have formed a translation cell that would oversee the work. The machine translation of classes I and II Maths book has been completed and the translated books are being vetted with the support of SCERTs in the states and union territories."

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Chandrayaan six days away from lunar orbit; slingshot at midnight

Thrusters To Be Fired At Closest Point To Earth

Chethan.Kumar
@timesgroup.com

Bengaluru: India's third lunar mission, Chandrayaan-3, is only around six days away from reaching the lunar orbit with another important manoeuvre—that will see Isro slingshot the spacecraft towards Moon—planned between 12am and 1am on August 1.

The midnight trans-lunar injection (TLI) manoeuvre is expected to last between 28 and 31 minutes and onboard thrusters of the spacecraft will be fired when the spacecraft is at the closest point to Earth (perigee) and not when at the farthest point (apogee).

Why is the slingshot attempted from perigee? At



The midnight trans-lunar injection manoeuvre is expected to last 28-31 minutes

present, the Chandrayaan-3 spacecraft is going around Earth in an elliptical orbit at a velocity ranging between 1km/second and 10.3km/second. The velocity is highest (10.3km/second) at perigee and lowest at apogee and while attempting the slingshot, the spacecraft will need to have a high velocity. The other reason is that its angle will have to change to travel towards Moon, which can be added if the operation is carried out at perigee.

PSLV puts 7 Singapore satellites into orbit; another mission likely in Sept

U.Tejonmayam
@timesgroup.com

Chennai: Isro's PSLV-C56, on Sunday, flew seven payloads, including the radar imaging earth observation satellite DS-SAR, to a 535km circular orbit before the rocket's upper stage was moved to a lower orbit to reduce its orbital life and mitigate space debris. Around 21 minutes after PSLV lifted off from the first launch pad at the Satish Dhawan Space Centre in Sriharikota at 6.31am, the rocket placed its primary payload—the 352kg DS-SAR.

Over the next three minutes, the other six satellites, weighing a total of 70.5kg, were injected into orbit.

Within 90 minutes of the injection of these satellites—Velox-AM, Arcade, Scoob-II, NuLoN, Galassia-2

and Orb-12 Strider—the rocket's fourth stage was moved to a lower orbit by using leftover propellants and firing the onboard thrusters to reduce its orbital life.

Isro chairman S Somnath said deorbiting PS4 to a lower orbit was a conscious effort to address the space debris mitigation problems. "We will have another PSLV mission in August or early September," he added.

The primary payload for Sunday's launch, the DS-SAR satellite, developed under a partnership between DSTA (representing the government of Singapore) and ST Engineering, has a synthetic aperture radar payload developed by Israel Aerospace Industries.

This allows the DS-SAR to provide for all-weather day and night coverage.

'Yelled at' for coming home late, girl kills dad

Hyderabad: A 45-year-old labourer died after his daughter, in her twenties, stabbed him in the neck with a broken bottle for reprimanding her over coming home late frequently, in Hyderabad's Amberpet area. Police said the crime took place around 11pm on Saturday after a drunk Jagadeesh scolded his daughter Nikhitha, who works as a salesperson at a store.

Following an argument, a furious Nikhitha picked up a broken bottle and stabbed her father in the neck.

Neighbours shifted Jagadeesh to the government-run Osmania General Hospital where he succumbed during treatment on Sunday. Nikhitha was taken into custody.

Nikhitha told cops that her father used to come home drunk and trouble her. Her mother also lives in the same house. A case was registered under Section 302 (murder) of the IPC. "She attacked him in a fit of rage as he yelled at her for coming late, and was not willing to listen to her," said a police officer. TNN

Constitution bench cases: Disposal rate drastically down in recent yrs

Pradeep.Thakur@timesgroup.com

New Delhi: According to the law ministry, there are 29 cases pending before the SC's constitution benches. Out of these, 18 are pending before five-judge benches, including the challenge to the dilution of Article 370. Six cases are pending before seven-judge benches and five are pending before nine-judge benches, the oldest for 24 years, two

others for 21 years and the fourth for 16 years.

Constitution benches disposed of 440 cases during 1950-1959 and 956 during 1960-1969. In recent years, the disposal rate went down drastically, with these benches adjudicating only 71 cases during 2010-2019 and 19 during 2020-2023. This could also be because of fewer cases being referred to constitution benches.

The SC, when it was cons-

tituted on January 26, 1950, had a sanctioned strength of eight judges, including the Chief Justice of India. Its strength increased to 11 in 1956 and to 14 in 1960. The sanctioned strength was further increased to 18 judges in 1977 and to 26 in 1986. The next increase happened after 23 years when the judge strength was raised to 31. It was again increased to 34 judges in 2019 to deal with rising pendency.

3 kids drown in UP pit; 30 die in 1 mth

Meerut: Over 30 persons, mostly kids, have died due to drowning in rainwater-filled open pits across western UP in the past one month, reports Krishna Chaudhary. In the latest incidents reported from Meerut and Baghpat, two boys, Lavish (8) and Chaand (7), drowned in a rain water-filled deep pit. In the other incident, a 10-year-old boy, Mohd Ikrar, drowned in a pit at a brick kiln.

Buddhadeb critical but stable: Hospital

Kolkata: Former Bengal CM, Buddhadeb Bhattacharya, who was admitted to hospital with breathing distress has bilateral pneumonia and upper respiratory infection. He is "critical but stable", sources at the hospital said. Bhattacharya, 79, has been put on ventilator. A 5-member medical team will conduct a CT of his thorax, blood tests, and ascertain his condition today. TNN

'Encounters' post Ulfa threat to DGP

Dibrugarh: Days after Ulfa (I) threatened Assam DGP GP Singh with "dire consequences" when a worker of the outfit was allegedly injured in police firing, two more rebels were wounded in suspected encounters, reports Rajib Dutta. Ulfa (I) linkman Jogen Gogoi tried to escape when he was leading cops to show them hidden cash forcing the team to open fire on him, police said.

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43 dead, 200 injured in suicide blast at rally by Pak govt ally

Local JUI-F Leader Dead; Attack A Bid To Oust Party Before Polls: Regional Chief



Rescue workers carry a wounded man to safety in Bajur district on Sunday

Omer Farooq Khan | TNN

Islamabad: At least 43 people were killed and 200-odd wounded in a suspected suicide attack on Sunday targeting workers' convention of the right-wing Jamiat Ulema-e-Islam-Fazl (JUI-F), an ally of Pakistan PM Shehbaz Sharif's PML-N, in the northwestern tribal district of Bajaur, bordering Afghanistan. A local party leader, identified as Maulana Ziaullah, was among the casualties.

The massive 4pm explosion threw asunder a gathering of more than 400 JUI-F members and supporters at a marketplace in Bajaur's Khar tehsil. JUI-F is part of the Pakistan Democratic Movement, a coalition that has been in government since April 2022. Akhtar Hayat Gandapur, the police chief

of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province, said a suicide bomber triggered the explosion just before the arrival of the party's senior leadership at the venue. Dr Faisal Kamal, the district health officer, confirmed 43 deaths, while Khyber Pakhtunkhwa's health minister Rizaz Anwar described the condition of at least 17 of the wounded as critical. Kamal said over 150 wounded people had been brought to Bajaur's district headquarters hospital, while those in a critical condition were being moved to Lady Reading Hospital in Peshawar. The province's interim CM, Azam Khan, sought a report on the explosion from police. Footage showed panic-stricken people gathering at the site following the blast as ambulances arrived to move the wounded to hospitals.



Rescue operation is underway after a bomb explosion in the Bajur district

Afterwards, a large police contingent cordoned off the area. JUI-F chief Maulana Fazlur Rehman urged PM Shehbaz Sharif and the Khyber Pakhtunkhwa government to launch an inquiry into the explosion. Abdul Rasheed, the regional chief of the party, said the attack was an attempt to remove JUI from the field before elections in November, but he said such tactics would not work. PM Sharif condemned the blast, saying it was a travesty that terrorists had targeted those who advocated the cause of Islam, the Quran and Pakistan. "Terrorists are enemies of Pakistan, and they will be eliminated," he said. Former PM Imran Khan's PTI party said Khyber Pakhtunkhwa "must not be allowed to bleed again". While no outfit had claimed

responsibility for the attack, the needle of suspicion pointed to Tehreek-e Taliban Pakistan, which has been responsible for most of the previous attacks in the region. TTP has declared war on Pakistan's security forces, the government and constituents of Sharif's coalition. For a long time, Pakistan's tribal areas were strongholds of TTP, but militancy declined following military offensives there in the past. With the return of the Afghan Taliban in Afghanistan, Pakistan has seen an uptick in violence in the border areas. However, in a statement to AP, the TTP condemned the bombing, saying it was aimed at pitching Islamists against each other. Zabullah Mujahid, a spokesman for the Afghan Taliban, said: "Such crimes cannot be justified in any way."

EYE ON THE DRAGON

US aid to Taiwan won't stop reunification bid: China

Taipei: China accused the United States of turning Taiwan into an "ammunition depot" after the White House announced a \$345 million military aid package for Taipei, and the self-ruled island said Sunday it tracked six Chinese navy ships in waters off its shores.

China's Taiwan affairs office issued a statement late Saturday opposing the military aid to Taiwan, which China claims as its own territory.

"No matter how much of the ordinary people's taxpayer money the ... Taiwanese separatist forces spend, no matter how many US weapons, it will not shake our resolve to solve the Taiwan problem. Or shake our firm will to realise the reunification of our motherland," said Chen Binhua, a spokesperson for the Taiwan affairs office. "Their actions are turning Taiwan into a powder keg and ammunition



The US announced a \$345m military aid package for Taiwan on Saturday

depot, aggravating the threat of war in the Taiwan Strait," the statement said.

China's People's Liberation Army has increased its military maneuvers in recent years aimed at Taiwan, sending fighter jets and warships to circle the island. On Sunday, Taiwan's ministry of national defence said it tracked six Chinese navy ships near the island.

Taiwan's ruling administration, led by the Democratic Progressive Party, has stepped up its weapons purchases from the US as part of a deterrence strategy against a Chinese invasion. AP

Italy min: Joining China's BRI atrocious decision

Rome: Italy made an "improvised and atrocious" decision when it joined China's Belt and Road Initiative four years ago as it did little to boost exports, Italian defence minister **Guido Crosetto** said in an interview published on Sunday.

Italy signed up to the BRI under a previous government, becoming the only major Western country to have taken such a step. Crosetto is part of an administration that is considering how to break free of the agreement.

"The decision to join the (new) Silk Road was an improvised and atrocious act" that multiplied China's exports to Italy but did not have the same effect on Italian exports to China, Crosetto told the Corriere della Sera newspaper. "The issue today is: how

to walk back (from the BRI) without damaging relations (with Beijing). Because it is true that China is a competitor, but it is also a partner," the defence minister added.

After a White House meeting with United States President Joe Biden Thursday, Italian PM Giorgia Meloni said her government had until December to make a decision on the BRI, and also announced she would soon travel to Beijing.

In an interview on Saturday with the TG5 Italian news programme, Meloni said it was a "paradox" that even if Italy is part of the BRI, it is not the G7 country with the strongest trading links to China. "This shows that you can have good relations and trading partnerships" even outside of the BRI, she added. REUTERS



\$60m refund sought by PAC hint at Trump money woes as legal fees soar

The political action committee that former President Donald Trump is using to pay his legal bills faced such staggering costs this year that it requested a refund on a \$60 million contribution it made to another group supporting the Republican front-runner, according to two people familiar with the matter.

The decision signals a potential money crisis for Trump, who has so far refused to pay his own voluminous bills directly and has also avoided creating a legal-defence fund for himself and people who have become entangled in the various investigations related to him.

It comes as Trump runs a campaign while under indictment in two jurisdictions and, soon, potentially a third, while also paying the legal fees of a number of witnesses who are close to him or who work for him. It is unclear how much



The refund was sought as the PAC, Save America, spent more than \$40m in legal fees incurred by Trump in various legal cases related to him this year alone

money was refunded. But the refund was sought as the PAC, Save America, spent more than \$40 million in legal fees incurred by Trump and witnesses in various legal cases related to him this year alone, according to another person familiar with the matter.

The numbers will be part of the Save America Federal Election Commission filing that is expected to be made public late Monday. That \$40 million was in addition to \$16 million that Save America

spent in the previous two years on legal fees. Since then, Trump has been indicted twice and has expanded the size of his legal team, and his two co-defendants in the case related to his retention of classified material work for him. The total legal spending is roughly \$56 million.

The PAC was the entity in which Trump had parked the more than \$100 million raised when he sought small-dollar donations after losing the 2020 election. Trump claimed he needed the support to fight widespread fraud in the race. Officials, including some with his campaign, turned up no evidence of widespread fraud. Trump used some of that \$100 million for other politicians in 2022, but he also used it to pay more than \$16 million in legal fees, most of them related to investigations into him, and at least \$10 million of which was for his own personal fees. NYT

'Immoral': Taliban stage bonfire of music equipment

Herat (Afghanistan): Authorities from Afghanistan's vice-ministry created a bonfire of confiscated musical instruments and equipment in Herat province at the weekend, deeming music immoral. "Promoting music causes moral corruption and playing it will cause the youth to go astray," said Aziz al-Rahman al-Muhajir, head of the Herat department of the ministry for the promotion of virtue and prevention of vice. Since seizing power in August 2021, Taliban authorities have steadily imposed laws and regulations that reflect their austere vision of Islam. Saturday's bonfire saw hundreds of dollars worth of musical gear go up in smoke. Women have borne the brunt of the new government regulations, and are not allowed in public unless wearing a hijab. AFP

PIO teen stabbed, robbed in Australia while playing

Melbourne: A 16-year-old Indian-origin boy was ambushed and stabbed on his birthday along with two of his friends in an unprovoked attack while they were playing basketball in Melbourne, according to a media report.

The incident took place in Tarneit City on Thursday, TV Channel 7News reported. A group of about seven to eight people set upon the trio, demanding they hand over their mobile phones and also ordered Rhyhan to give up his new Nike Air Jordan sneakers, which he had only just received as a gift, the report said.

The Year-10 student and his friends were due at a celebratory family dinner for his birthday. The aspiring cricketer was stabbed in his ribs, arms, hand and back, and was hit in the back of his head, the report said. One of his friends was also stabbed, according

to Victoria Police. Rhyhan was taken to hospital where he underwent surgery to save the fingers on his left hand. He is expected to remain in hospital for a few more days as he recovers, the report said, adding that, his two friends are also recovering in hospital.

According to the 7News channel, the gang had earlier ambushed other victims at a leisure centre in Caroline Springs the same afternoon. Police say the offenders left the scene in a dark-coloured vehicle which has not yet been located. PTI

A group of about seven to eight people attacked Rhyhan & his two friends and took their mobiles and Rhyhan's new Nike Air Jordan sneakers

Worms revived after 46,000 years frozen in Siberian permafrost

At a time when the mighty woolly mammoth roamed the Earth, some 46,000 years ago, a minuscule pair of roundworms became encased in the Siberian permafrost. Millennia later, the worms, thawed out of the ice, would wriggle again, and demonstrate to scientists that life could be paused — almost indefinitely.

The discovery, published this past week in the peer-reviewed journal PLOS Genetics, offers new insight into how the worms, also known as nemato-

des, can survive in extreme conditions for extraordinarily long periods of time, in this case tens of thousands of years.

In 2018, Anastasia Shatilovich, a scientist from the Institute of Physicochemical and Biological Problems in Soil Science RAS in Russia, thawed two female worms from a fossilised burrow dug by gophers in the Arctic. The worms, which were buried about 130 feet in the permafrost, were revived simply by putting them in water, according to the Max Planck Institu-



The roughly millimeter-long worms were able to resist extreme low temps by entering a dormant state called cryptobiosis, a process researchers are trying to study

te of Molecular Cell Biology and Genetics in Germany. Called Panagrolaimus kolymaensis, after the Kolyma River in Russia, where they were found, the worms were sent to Germany for further study. The creatures, which have a lifespan measured in days, died after reproducing several generations in the lab, researchers said. Using radiocarbon dating, researchers determined the specimens were frozen between 45,839 and 47,769 years ago, during the late Pleistocene.

The roughly millimeter-long worms were able to resist extreme low temperatures by entering a dormant state called cryptobiosis, a process researchers at the institute have been trying to understand. No nematodes had been known to achieve such a dormant state for thousands of years at a time, Teymuraz Kurzhachia, a professor emeritus at the institute, said. "The major take-home message of this discovery is that it is, in principle, possible to stop life for more or less an indefinite time and then restart it."

Researchers identified key genes in the nematode that al-

low it to achieve the cryptobiotic state. The same genes were found in a contemporary nematode called Caenorhabditis elegans, which can also achieve cryptobiosis. "This led us, for instance, to understand that they cannot survive without a specific sugar called trehalose," Kurzhachia said. While there are no clear practical applications of cryptobiosis, that should not be a reason to stop the research, he said. "Cryptobiosis could, perhaps one day, be engineered by humans." NYT

French embassy in Niger attacked as protesters waving Russian flags through the capital

Security in Niger took a turn for the worse on Sunday, as protesters marched through the capital in support of the recent military coup, the French embassy was attacked, and a regional economic bloc raised the possibility of military intervention if the president was not reinstated within a week. Thousands of junta supporters surged through the streets of Niamey, the capital, waving Russian flags, chanting the name of the Russian president and forcefully denouncing former colonial power France.

The protesters marched through the city to the French embassy, where a door was lit



Niger, world's 7th-biggest producer of uranium, is seen as the last reliable partner for the West in Africa's Sahel region. Wagner is already operating in neighbouring Mali, and Russia would like to expand influence in the region

on fire. Smoke could be seen rising from across the city. The army broke up the crowd.

Russian mercenary group Wagner is already operating in neighbouring Mali, and President Putin would like to expand his country's influence in the region. However, it is unclear yet whether the new junta le-

AROUND THE WORLD



STREET ART: Known as the 'capital of concrete', the city of Pristina is trying to revitalise its dull and grey image with vivid art on walls and buildings. More than 100 artists from 28 countries took part in a graffiti festival in Kosovo's capital over the weekend

Believe in angels? About 7 in 10 US adults do, poll finds

Compared with the devil, angels carry more credence in America. Angels even get more credence than, well, hell. About 7 in 10 US adults say they believe in angels, according to a new poll by AP-NORC Center for Public Affairs Research. "For a lot of people, angels are a lot safer to worship," Jack Grogger, a chaplain for the Los Angeles Angels. American belief in angels (69%) is about on par with belief in heaven and the power of prayer, but bested by belief in God or a higher power (79%). Fewer US adults believe in the devil or Satan (56%), astrology (34%), reincarnation (34%), and that physical things can have spiritual energies, such as plants, rivers or crystals (42%). Angels mean differ-

ent things to different people, and the idea of loved ones becoming heavenly angels after death is neither an unusual belief nor a universally held one.

Pilot lands plane in sea off France after engine failure A pilot landed his tourist plane in choppy waters off southern France on Sunday after the aircraft's engine broke down, with all occupants surviving unharmed, firefighters said. The Cessna 177 touched down 1,968 feet off the coast near the Mediterranean resort of Frejus shortly before 10 am. The fire service said the pilot chose the location to "avoid the beach, where there were already a lot of holidaymakers". "To pull that off, you need a lot of technical ability and a bit of luck," a spokesman said. Firefighters rescued two women and one man, who escaped unharmed but were shaken up. The plane sank, although no pollution has been detected in the sea so far.



A thought for today
We have roughly 3 lakh sq km of forest
suitable for tigers and we have only 10% of
it capable of holding them naturally
K ULLAS KARANTH

Do It Naturally

Success of Project Tiger is a good reminder why we need pristine forests. RS should debate forest bill

On Global Tiger Day, July 29, an update on India's tiger census provided a measure of the country's phenomenal contribution to the resurgence of the wild tiger population. The current estimate is that the upper limit is 3,925 tigers, while the average number is 3,682. It means three of four wild tigers in the world are to be found in India. Primary credit for the resurgence of wild tigers should go to Project Tiger, which counted biodiversity preservation among its aims.

Beginning with nine tiger reserves, we now have 53, covering 75,796 sq km. But that's a mere 2.3% of India's land area. Two aspects of GOI's statement on the tiger census stood out. Despite the overall increase in tiger population, there were localised declines in the Western Ghats, Jharkhand and parts of the Northeast. Also, about 35% of the tiger reserves urgently need enhanced protection measures. Despite the successes of Project Tiger, significant vulnerabilities remain. For example, Tiger Census, 2018, said only 65% of the tiger



population are found in reserves. Moreover, the state of forest report, 2021, said "continuous, undisturbed and non-fragmented landscapes are essential for the survival of Tigers".

These are factors Rajya Sabha needs to ponder when it debates amendments to

the Forest (Conservation) Bill, which was passed by Lok Sabha on July 26. The amendments are wide in their scope, seeking to tailor the law to realise the national target of achieving net zero emission by 2070. However, the amendments are loosely worded and can defeat the legislation's core goal of preserving forests, which are critical carbon sinks. Some shortcomings were highlighted by state governments that presented their case to a joint committee of Parliament.

One clause embodies the main fear of stakeholders: forest land situated up to 100 km from international borders can be exempt from the legislation's protection to carry out projects of strategic importance. States such as Nagaland and Sikkim told the joint committee that it potentially opens up all forests in the state for strategic projects to be identified by the relevant ministries in GOI. These are some of the richest areas globally in terms of gene pool diversity. Preserving them can eventually yield benefits that enhance India's strategic heft. Therefore, Rajya Sabha should carefully weigh the consequences of these loosely worded amendments. Preserving pristine forests is consistent with national interests.

Shadow Threats

Russia and China both have subversion tools they can and do deploy around the world. India should keep watch

The military coup in Niger last week found an early cheerleader – Russian private militia Wagner's boss, Yevgeny Prigozhin. He also offered up his fighters to restore order there. This leads to two crucial inferences. First, Moscow continues to find Wagner useful despite its abortive mutiny against the Russian military brass last month. And second, the militia continues to do Kremlin's bidding in Africa. Wagner has been associated with other coups in Africa in recent years, including ones in Mali and Burkina Faso. The group also has security contracts in countries like the Central African Republic. Thus, it has emerged as a tool for Moscow to erode Western influence in target countries.



Parallely, China's United Front Work Department (UFWD) of the Chinese Communist Party central committee has ramped up its influence and interference operations in democratic societies. UFWD – which Mao had described as one of CCP's 'magic weapons' – has received fresh funding and resources under

Xi Jinping to amplify pro-China voices and silence critics. It uses disinformation, news farms and sophisticated networks in elite circles in target countries to achieve its goals. Case in point, UFWD is alleged to have interfered in the 2019 and 2021 Canadian federal elections, whereas Britain's MI5 had issued an alert last year that a person linked to UFWD had infiltrated the British parliament.

Authoritarian states like China and Russia have developed effective subversive agencies to undermine democracies. And with Beijing and Moscow forming their own "limitless" strategic compact, there is reason to believe that the two could coordinate their influence and infiltration operations in third countries. India, which is locked in a border dispute with China and is increasing its strategic engagements with the West, should watch out for entities like UFWD and Wagner targeting its interests in Africa and South Asia. It would be best for New Delhi to coordinate countermeasures with Western partners to deal with this all-too-possible threat.

Court in crossfire

A law unto themselves – and how!

Himanshi.Dhawan@timesgroup.com



For ordinary folks, lawyers tend to inspire a sense of dread. Perhaps it's the black cloaks billowing in the air as they walk, bringing to mind images of vultures swooping in – or, it is that smug, *quod erat demonstrandum* look they have after they've spewed unintelligible Latin at you?

Don't get me wrong. I think they are eminently worthy members of society doing yeoman service. Having grown up on an unhealthy dose of Bollywood, I'm a big fan of court melodrama. I can close my eyes and hear the hero say, "Milard... mere muvakkil bilkul nirdosh hai" as the heroine chomps on her saree in tortured silence.

So imagine my disappointment, when as a rookie reporter in Mumbai, I found courts devoid of any theatrics. But some things have changed. After all, why make do with dull and droning arguments when bullets and bombs can add so much life (and even death)? And you don't even need to be in a courtroom anymore. Like almost everything these days, you have the option of toggling between the latest OTT show and live action from courtrooms, courtesy vloggers who incessantly record and upload content.

The videos would make any masala film a tedious watch. Two women pulling each other's hair in a family court, a lawyer beating up his client over unpaid dues, or a judge in tears as he urged a divorcing couple to patch up for the sake of their children – "ghar bas jayega to kitna achcha hoga."

And if tragedy's not your genre of choice, there's action as well. There was an IED explosion at the Rohini court in 2021, and in April, Saket was witness to a raging knifer. The Wild Wild West that is Tis Hazari rarely disappoints. Like Bigg Boss ka ghar the task just gets more challenging. If you must 'appear' at Tis Hazari, be ready to master the art of navigating narrow lanes, ducking overhanging wires and side-stepping aggressive touts. And now, you need Matrix-like reflexes to dodge bullets too. As for UP courts, let's not go there: The other day, a gangster was shot dead by a man dressed as a lawyer.

Seasoned lawyers tell me the future is virtual courts. But aren't the brick, bullet and mortar ones so much more fun?

Ashok Gulati and Raya Das



On July 20, 2023, government of India (GOI) banned exports of non-basmati white rice. That sent shockwaves in several countries. Even in the US, the Indian community rushed to stores to buy large quantities of rice to ensure their 'rice security'. Think of the panic it created in several African countries that rely on rice imports from India.

If India has to emerge as a responsible leader of the Global South in G-20, such sudden bans need to be avoided. Reason is simple: India is the largest rice exporter worldwide, accounting for about 40% of the total 55.6 million metric tonnes (MMT) of global rice trade in 2022.

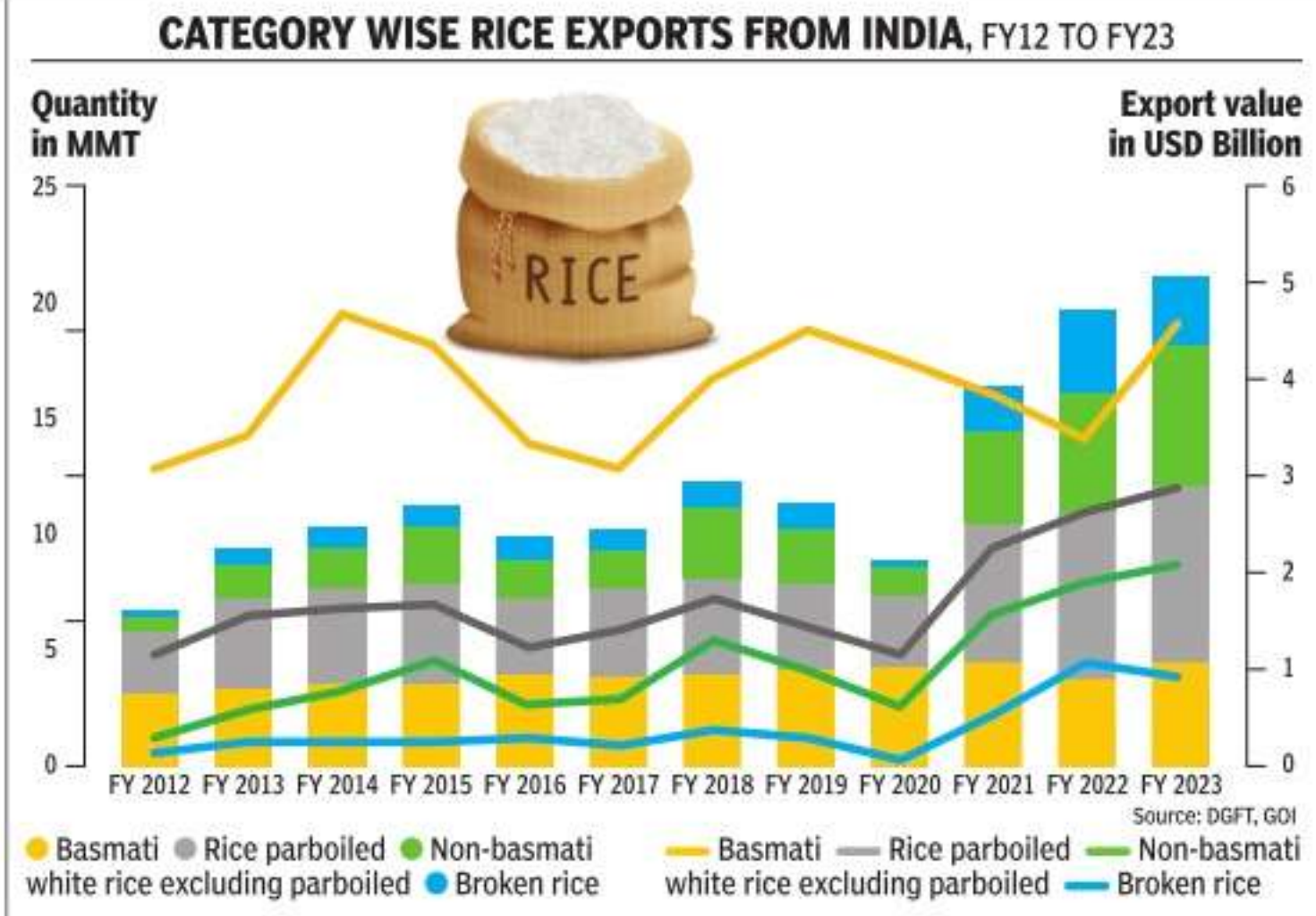
Domestic situation is comfortable

From GOI's standpoint, it could be 'India first' argument. The cereal inflation in June was in double digits, and given that monsoon has been somewhat erratic, the upside risk of inflation has increased.

But if one looks at the facts, this argument will not hold much ground. The rice stocks with Food Corporation of India (FCI) are at 40.95 MMT as of July 1, more than three times the buffer norm of 13.5 MMT. Also, area sown under

The rice stocks with Food Corporation of India are at 40.95 MMT as of July 1, more than three times the buffer norm of 13.5 MMT. Also, area sown under paddy on July 29 is marginally higher than the previous year

RISE OF RICE IN FARM EXPORTS



paddy on July 29 is marginally higher than the previous year. India Meteorological Department (IMD) also tells us that the cumulative rainfall of the current monsoon season remains normal or marginally in excess as of July 29.

So, one is puzzled to see this knee-jerk reaction of GOI, more so when rice exports already attract 20% export duty. That raises a question: what could be a better solution to ensure cereal security in the country?

In 2022-23, the overall cereal production in India was 330.5 MMT comprising 135.5 MMT of rice, 112.7 MMT of wheat, and 101.8 MMT of coarse cereals. And India exported more than 22 MMT of rice. In the current monsoon, the area under coarse cereals is marginally higher than last year. GOI also gives free wheat and rice (5 kg/person/month) to more than 800 million people under PM Garib Kalyan Yojana. It can also use nutri-cereals or cash options in PDS in lieu of wheat and rice.

Wheat: Mismatch in estimates

However, there could be a legitimate concern for wheat. Although GOI had a comfortable procurement of 26.2 MMT, and as on July 1, even wheat stocks were marginally higher than its buffer norm, the concern arises as production estimates of GOI are substantially higher than trade estimates.

So, if GOI wants to curb inflationary expectations, the solution for that is not export ban or imposing stock limits, but to make a special deal with Russia to import 5-7 MMT of wheat, *a la* its crude oil deal. The import duty on wheat needs to be immediately slashed from current 40% to say 10% or simply abolish it.

This is the right time to import wheat as the Black Sea price of Russian wheat is hovering around \$237/tonne as on July 23, much lower than US wheat or even our minimum support price (MSP) for wheat. Imports of 5-7 MMT of wheat could help build enough buffer stock for the coming months.

Why Courts Must Stick To The Law

Allahabad HC rejected an inter-faith couple's plea for protection on so-called moral grounds, going against SC practice and constitutional norms

Jyotika Kalra



The Supreme Court and high courts are expected to protect individuals and uphold their fundamental rights, yet high courts on occasion speak from a moral standpoint rather than enforce constitutional guarantees.

Recently, deciding a writ petition by an interfaith couple in a live-in relationship who sought protection from police harassment and the man's family, an Allahabad HC division bench espoused instead the fabric of Indian family life.

The court not only declined relief but suggested the couple's situation was a social problem, even saying their relationship was "haram" in Islam – the man being Muslim. HC referred to an SC judgment to infer that "SC's observations... cannot be considered to promote such relationships. Law traditionally has been biased in favour of marriage. It reserves many rights and privileges to married persons to preserve and encourage the institution. SC is simply accepting social reality and has no intention to unravel the fabric of Indian family life..." The judgment did not bother to spell out the provenance of this vague concept of "fabric of Indian family life".

India's religions have contradicting rules and rituals – where can a common fabric of Indian family life be found other than in the law of the land?

Call neighbours

Orders cannot be issued on the premise of "encouraging" or "discouraging" relationships, just as when acquitting any murder accused, courts cannot be said to have "promoted" murder.

To justify its dismissal, HC cited Islamic law to say sex outside marriage is not permissible. The court specifically referred to chapter 24 of the Quran. Surely this just intimidated the couple.

While denying them protection from police harassment, the court took recourse to the Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act, which recognises and protects "relationships in the nature of marriage".

In the writ petition, no relief under domestic violence had been claimed.

The bench used this very absence to say it is unknown how long the couple have been in a "domestic relationship". HC also expected the petitioners to have brought along neighbours as witnesses to testify their relationship.

It is impractical to expect neighbours to certify the nature of relationship between individuals, more so when the woman has not claimed any relief under the domestic violence act.

The court left no opportunity to emphasise that awareness should be created among "young minds" about societal and emotional pressures such relationships may create – as if arranged marriages absolve couples of societal and emotional pressures.

End relationship

The court also cautioned "young minds" about the legal hassles of live-in relationships by citing examples of hassles it perceived – division of property, violence, and cheating.

The petitioners' grievance was the alleged violation of their fundamental right of life and liberty by police and the mother of petitioner number 1. Rather than address this, the bench noted that the couple had not expressed willingness to marry in the near future – surely irrelevant to the point in law.

In short, the court suggested that rather than expect protection from police harassment, the couple should consider ending the relationship for the good of the so-called "Indian family system" and all its beliefs.

Not the Constitution alone but SC too in *Lata Singh vs State of UP*, had directed administration and police that inter-caste or inter-faith couples were not to be harassed. Protection to the couple ought to have been ensured.

The writ petition prayed for protection from disturbance of their peaceful life, not registration of FIR against the mother.

Yet HC, in order to justify its dismissal, suggested a rigorous course to the couple invoking criminal jurisdiction – that they should lodge a complaint at the local police station, an FIR against relatives, or escalate the matter to the magistrate concerned.

Reliving adalat system

India cannot be expected to be guided by such judgments. Given societal systems still exist that do not care for the rule of law, given honour killings are carried out with impunity to this day, the fears and apprehensions of any inter-faith or inter-caste couple are genuine and must be taken seriously.

Such judgments strike at India's foundation where inclusiveness is the basis of social fabric, where diversity is not only acknowledged but celebrated. In India, courts have been progressive and decriminalised adultery, the right to privacy has been recognised as a fundamental right, same-sex relationships have been decriminalised and questions related to same-sex marriages are sub-judice.

In this, the Allahabad HC time-travelled into a bygone era to intimidate and caution modern love. It found logic in the old adalat system where Hindu law was applied to Hindus and Quranic law was applied to Muslims, with the collector aided by pandits and kazis.

The idea, however, surely is to move society towards following the rule of law and not for the law of the land to follow "societal norms".

The writer is advocate-on-record, Supreme Court, and former member, NHRC

Calvin & Hobbes



Being Happy Is Truly Our Natural State

James Anderson

Introspect a while and ask yourself this question. Can you feel your true source of happiness?

Circumstances are only shifting sands and will always change. Look at everything that exists outside as just another circumstance: your relationships, home and possessions, even your loved ones. Are you looking for any of these to complete your happiness? You will be disappointed. The more we try to construct on the outside, the more miserably we become, as there is only impermanence on the surface.

Being happy is truly a natural state. It is normal and doesn't need any add-ons. We only have to live in an atmosphere of inner and outer harmony and equilibrium. It is our birthright. It requires effort to annul our conditioning and innate ignorance, factors

which reinforce our misery. We have to penetrate the folds of our nature to reach the Divine. It is hard work getting back to our source. But we must try. Experience shows that, on the Sunlit Path, surrender will remove every obstacle along the way. In Integral Yoga, one never dwells on difficulties but invokes all one's strengths. We are all divine in essence, after all. For this work, aspiration is needed, and a joy intervenes as the practice and work unfold. Happiness is always progressive: the more you engage in a true way of living, the happier you will become.

Look for the permanence in your life. What is permanent? Your own truth, for one thing. Your reality is lodged inside and realising it is the authentic aim of all life. This is the immortal in you. Set

this as your goal in life and move towards it and you will be happy. Love is also permanent but can only blossom in an atmosphere of truth. No condition gets more distorted by humanity than love. It does not reside in exclusive relationships or attachments, but true love is, in Sri Aurobindo's words, "a self-existent power of the Divine". It does not require any other justification for its presence. So, climb through the gradations to the love that exists beyond all bartering and exchange. You will find fulfilment in this process. Once we begin to love solely for the sake of loving, we enter the threshold of a sustained and sublime happiness. Love is a vibration that should be preserved and nurtured; it needs only to be lived. One becomes what one identifies with, so identify with love and you will

reach the pinnacle of happiness. However, never search for happiness. If you are doing that, you are taking the wrong path. Happiness is but a means to an end: an inevitable by-product of living our truth. You have only to become a flaming brazier for progress and you will be happy. Collaborate in the divine work of transformation and you will attain a supreme felicity. Be selfless enough to offer yourself as a crucible for the future of humanity and you will never have to look outside again for happiness. Your happiness will reach a new pitch as you move into new realms of the supreme Ananda. Give yourself entirely to this work and you will reach an unbounded state of delight, because this is only what you truly are.

The writer is the coordinating editor of NAMAHA, the Journal of Integral Health, published from Puducherry



THE SPEAKING TREE

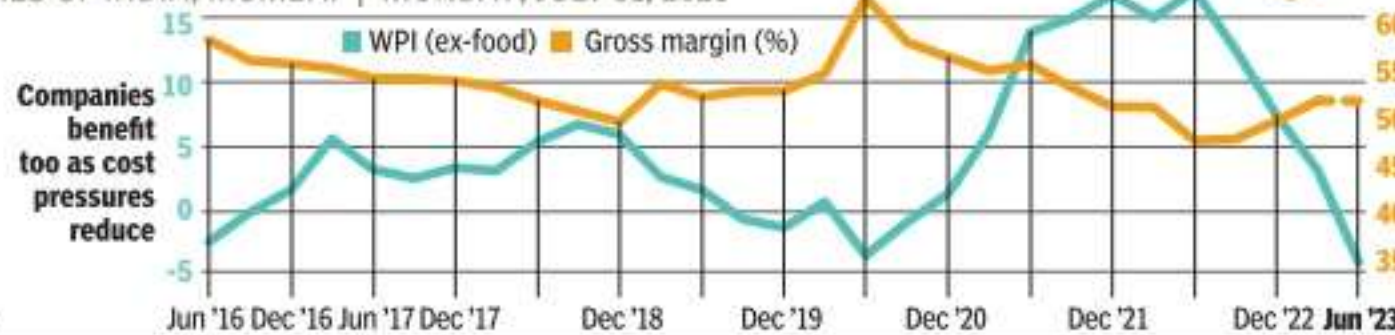
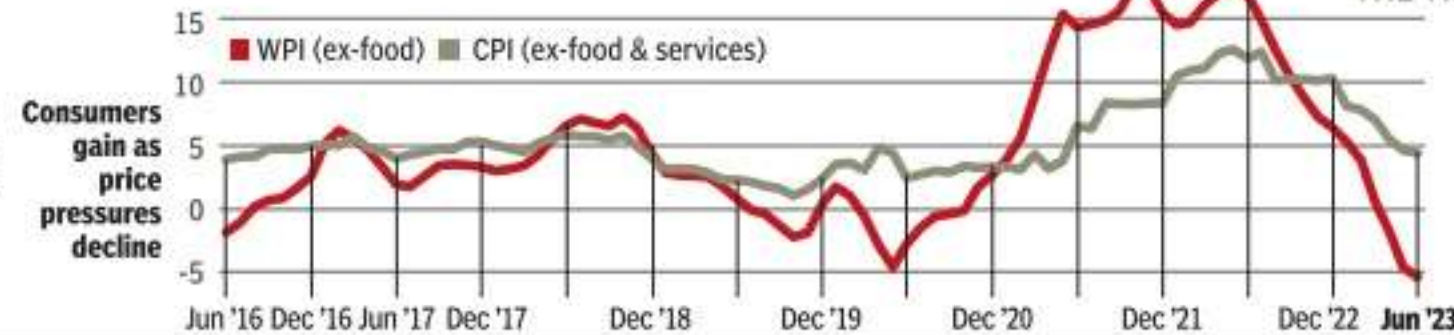
Cos' Profit Margins Rise As Inflation Moderates

Wholesale price inflation came in at -4.1% for June 2023, the lowest in 92 months. It may fall further if global oil, commodity and other raw material prices slip afresh. While their producers are feeling the heat, companies using them as inputs — and consumers of goods made from them — are heaving a sigh of relief

Source: Crisil

TIMES BUSINESS

THE TIMES OF INDIA, MUMBAI | MONDAY, JULY 31, 2023



Indian units of foreign cos face GST queries on ESOPs

Authorities See 'Import Of Service' That Attracts 18% GST

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Mumbai: GST authorities are raising inquiries in cases where shares of a foreign parent or holding company are being allotted to an Indian subsidiary's staff under schemes like employee stock option plan (ESOP) and employee share purchase plan (ESPP).

Indian subsidiaries — largely in the technology sector where ESOP is a popular employee incentive — are facing this issue in GST audit. Separate inquiries are also being raised by authorities. According to tax experts and industry watchers, GST authorities in Karnataka were the first to raise this issue and officials in other states have followed suit.

The stand adopted by GST authorities is that the overseas entity, whose shares are allotted to the employees of the subsidiary company, is not the employer. The obligation of providing shares under the employment contract rests with the

Experts: ESOP Part Of Pay, Outside GST Ambit

Employee stock option plan (ESOP) is a popular incentive, especially in the tech sector

GST Authorities' Stand	What Tax Experts Say
A promise in the nature of incentives to employees is made by, say, 'ABC India'	ESOP is a part of salary and is outside the ambit of GST
However, the financial service is fulfilled by an 'ABC International'	Staffers covered by ESOP pay income tax
Import of service is done by 'ABC India' to keep up its obligation to employees	An exception should be created such that ESOP is not treated as an import of service, but rather a reimbursement mechanism, PwC partner Pratik Jain said
Hence this 'financial service' comes under 'HSN code 9971', which is subject to tax under reverse charge at the hands of 'ABC India'	ESOPs are in the nature of securities which are outside the ambit of GST, he added

Indian subsidiary, but in turn is fulfilled by the overseas entity. Thus, it is an import of service by the Indian entity/subsidiary, which is subject to 18% GST.

Tax experts attached to a few companies said that ESOP is a part of salary and is outside the ambit of GST. Employees who are covered by ESOP plans, however, pay income tax on the same.

"Technically, there is no underlying supply. The recovery of ESOP cost by the overseas entity from the Indian subsidiary is more from the accounting treatment standpoint and the underlying transaction is only that of employer vs employee. There cannot be any supply attributed to such transactions," Pratik Jain, partner at PwC, said.

According to Jain, GST authorities are demanding the tax when such amount is cross-charged from the overseas company to the Indian entity. "Under GST law for import of service from related parties, a tax liability arises when such amount is accrued in the books of accounts of Indian entities or paid, whichever is earlier," he added.

Indian subsidiaries are at various stages of litigation. Some have replied to the show-cause notices, whereas in other cases, the matter has moved forward and appeals have been filed with the GST Commissioner (Appeals).

Jain said that an exception should be created where the ESOP arrangement is not treated an import of service, but a mere reimbursement mechanism. Alternatively, it could be clarified that ESOPs are in nature of securities which are outside the ambit of GST.

All hopes are pinned on the forthcoming GST council meeting.

TCS revamps senior mgmt under CEO Krithivasan

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Bengaluru: TCS, under new CEO K Krithivasan, has revamped its senior management and put in place a new operating structure.

The company said its executive VP and CTO K Ananth Krishnan will retire in October, and will immediately cease to be an SMP (senior management personnel).

Harrick Vin, TCS fellow and chief services innovation officer, is among the new SMPs and he replaces Krishnan. He has been in academia and industry for over 30 years and has been with TCS for 18 years. Prior to this role, Harrick headed Digitate, TCS's software venture that uses AI and automation to transform digital operations.

TCS chief marketing officer Rajashree R is no longer an SMP. Abhinav Kumar is taking over as the interim head of marketing and communication units globally. Five other leaders were designated as SMPs. These include Shankar Narayanan, V Rajanna, Siva Ganesan, Ashok Pai, and Reguraman Ayyaswamy.

Narayanan is an SVP at TCS and has been with the company for over 30 years. Rajanna is SVP and the head of the communications, media and technology businesses. Ganesan is SVP and the global head of the Microsoft business unit. Pai is SVP and the global head of the cognitive business operations. Ayyaswamy is SVP and the global head of the internet of things (IoT) and digital engineering units.

The new appointments are effective August 1. Krithivasan, in an email to employees, said, "I believe these changes will help in deepening customer centricity which is pivotal to our growth..."

Cognizant sees exit of old guard after Kumar's entry

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Bengaluru: Ravi Kumar, who took over as CEO of Cognizant Technology Solutions (CTS) earlier this year, looks to be refashioning his leadership team. Several of his predecessor Brian Humphries' key hires have left the organisation following Kumar's entry.

The latest exit is that of Cognizant's president for global growth markets, Rob Walker. He had joined Cognizant in 2021 as MD of the UK & Ireland business, but most recently covered all of Cognizant's markets outside of the Americas region. An email to Cognizant on Walker's exit did not elicit a response.

Others who left recently include Anil Cheriyan, who was EVP of strategy and technology. Before joining Cognizant, Cheriyan had served as the US presidential appointee in charge of technology transformation services. Earlier this year, Becky Schmitt, who was chief people officer, resigned.

'A \$1 difference can boost Scotch imports'

Domestic Cos Want Duty Cuts For Whisky Imported At Over \$5 A Bottle In UK FTA

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New Delhi: A difference of \$1 a bottle in the import price of whisky could lead to a significant surge in the shipment of popular brands such as Johnnie Walker Black Label and Chivas Regal into India through the proposed free trade agreement (FTA) with the UK.

The trade deal, which is close to finalisation, will prescribe a minimum import price (MIP) and all bottled Scotch above the threshold will see import duty reduced to 100% from 150%, while those coming in casks could see it halved to 75%. While the details are still being negotiated, there have been discussions around reducing customs duty on bottled Scotch to 50% over 10 years.

Based on the experience with Australia — where customs duty on wine was slashed under the interim FTA — the domestic industry is seeking an MIP of \$5 for every 750ml bottle. The calculation is that popular brands, such as Johnnie Walker Black Label and Chivas Regal, will not make the cut as their basic price is just over \$4 a bottle, based on an exchange rate of Rs 80 to a dollar (see graphic).

There are now suggestions that India should agree to an MIP of \$4 a bottle, which domestic players believe would result in a flood of imports from the UK and wipe out several homegrown players and Indian-made foreign liquor (IMFL) brands.

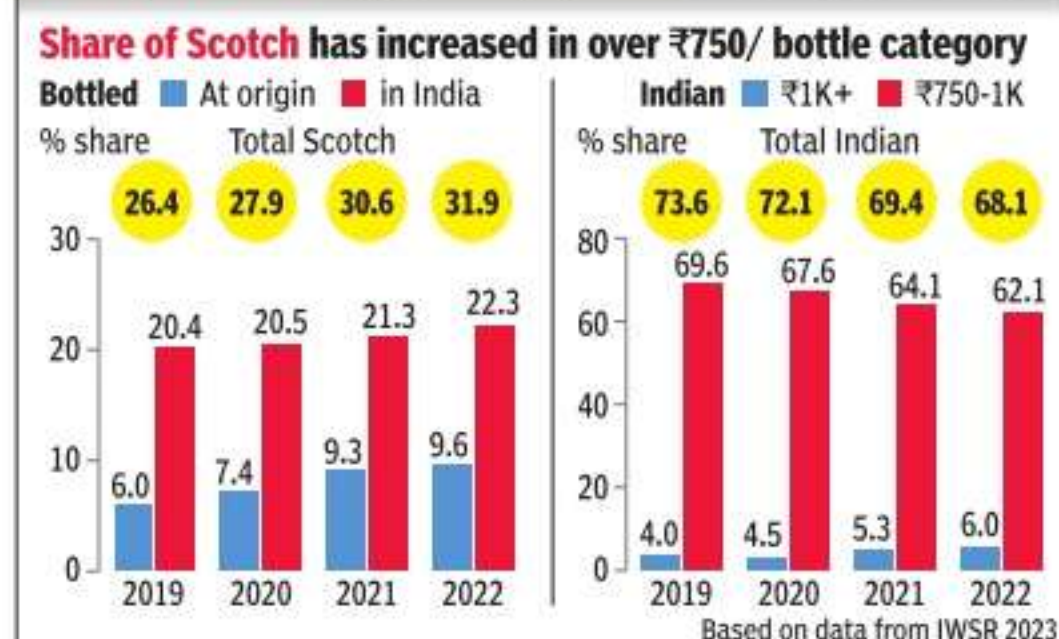
"It is going to cause a lot of damage as domestic players will find it tough to compete and foreign players, who have set up bottling units here, will not add fresh capacity and may go to the extent of reducing capacity,

HOW WHISKY IS PRICED

(in ₹/ bottle)	Red Label	Black Label
CIF value	175	330
Profit & margin	373	803
Total landed	548	1,133
Customs @ 150%	262	495
Excise @ 85%	467	920
VAT @ 25%	320	637
Total	1,597	3,185
Retail margin	82	100
VAT on retail margin	21	25
Retail price	1,700	3,310



All data for Delhi for 750ml bottle; Some numbers have been rounded off; CIF: Customs, insurance & freight; Customs duty levied on CIF value; excise duty is levied on the total landed cost; VAT of 25% is levied on the cost after levy of customs and excise duty; Source: Industry



which will hit employment," a source told TOI.

With a 3.3% share, imported products are a small portion of the overall Indian whisky market, but when it comes to the middle and the premium segment — defined as those over Rs 750 a bottle — the share of Scotch is nearly 32% and rising fast. In fact, there has been an over five percentage point increase in the last four years, shows data from IWSR, an international agency tracking the alcohol market (see graphic).

Domestic players have told the government that even without a reduction in import duty, there has been a surge in bottled Scotch in recent years.

For instance, during 2022-23, bottled whisky imports more than doubled to \$316 million from \$152 million. In contrast, during this period, the value of bulk whisky shipments are estimated to have increased by over 40% to around \$149 million.

"All the Scotch is coming from the UK, although in several cases, the origin is shown as Singapore and the UAE, given that they are global trans-shipment hubs," said an industry source. What has further fuelled this is states such as Maharashtra slashing excise duty to 150% from 300% in November 2021, while the levy on domestic produce was kept at 300%.

Over half of I-T returns processed as of July 27

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: The government is clearly upbeat over how income tax (I-T) returns have been filed so far this year, especially over the last few days. Typically, there is a bunching of returns as the deadline nears and the tax department, officials said, has made every effort to cope with the increase in traffic and was seeking to address any concerns that taxpayers had.

"To assist taxpayers in ITR filing, tax payment and other related services, our helpdesk is functioning on a 24x7 basis, and we are providing support through calls, live chats, WebEx sessions & social media. We extend our gratitude to taxpayers and tax professionals for helping us reach this milestone, and urge all those who haven't filed ITR for assessment year 2023-24 (FY2022-23), to file their ITR at the earliest to avoid last minute rush," CBDT tweeted. The number of logins on the income tax website until 6.30pm on Sunday were estimated at 1.3 crore.

Data released by CBDT



earlier in the day pegged filings up to 1pm at 5.8 crore.

A large proportion of taxpayers verified the returns electronically, which has helped the department simultaneously process returns and issue refunds. While the number was not updated on Sunday, until July 27 — when just over five crore returns had been filed — around 4.5 crore had been e-verified and of these 2.7 crore had been processed, income tax data showed. With electronic filing and processing becoming the norm over the last few years, the entire process has been crunched, helping taxpayers get refunds within a matter of days, instead of having to wait for months.

P&W engine woes may lead to aircraft shortage

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New Delhi: The aircraft capacity crunch may worsen and lead to even higher fares ahead of the festive season. The reason: Yet another trouble with Pratt & Whitney's (P&W's) snag-ridden geared turbofan (GTF) engines that power the Airbus 321neo and have almost 50 IndiGo planes grounded apart from the once 60-aircraft strong GoFirst.

DGCA last Friday held a video conference with its American counterpart, Federal Aviation Administration (FAA), and P&W on the latest in a series of GTF's unending snags. Sources said P&W told the Indian regulator it will issue technical guidance on the latest trouble in early August. The issue relates to microscopic contaminants being found in a metal used in parts of



AHEAD OF FESTIVE RUSH

the engine's core. P&W's guidance may decide exactly how many engines will need to be inspected and repaired. If the number is large, it could have a significant impact on IndiGo's capacity. "The extent of the impact will be known only when P&W issues the technical guidance. We are hearing (not from P&W) that the latest engine trouble will impact 11 IndiGo planes, of which six are already grounded. But, the exact number

will be known next month after P&W guidance," said people in the know.

Comments sought from IndiGo and P&W on the issue were awaited till the time of going to press. Clearly, the big concern is the impact on 313-aircraft strong IndiGo. The airline, which accounts for over 60% of domestic passengers and is the largest in terms of international carriage in and out of India on a standalone basis, has 136 A320 family planes with P&W engines. Of these, 47 are grounded for reasons like P&W's inability to supply replacement engines.

If the P&W guidance forces a significant number of planes to be grounded for engine checks, the capacity crunch could lead to higher fares at a time when the post-GoFirst peak summer season saw domestic fares at record levels.



New Hitech 'Shakes'

FPI buying spree continues in July

New Delhi: Foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) continued with their buying spree in July with a net infusion of Rs 45,365 crore in equities on steady earnings growth. AGENCIES

NFRA bans Coffee Day auditors, slaps penalty

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New Delhi: The National Financial Reporting Authority (NFRA) has taken stern action against two auditors and the audit firm of Coffee Day Global for "professional misconduct" and failure to report irregularities in the company's books in 2019-20, despite having access to the details of an investigation that was ordered following the death of the company's chairman V G Siddhartha.

While chartered accountant A S Sundaresha has been slapped with the maximum permissible penalty of Rs 10 lakh and barred from practicing for 10 years, his colleague, Madhusudan UA, has received a five-year ban on practicing and has to

pay a penalty of Rs 5 lakh. The audit firm, ASRMP & Co, has also been handed a Rs 2-crore penalty and banned for four years, which will run concurrently with the debarment in the case related to 2018-19. NFRA said in a 44-page order issued on Friday.

DID NOT REPORT IRREGULARITIES

"Despite the fraud being revealed after the suicide of group chairman V G Siddhartha, and the reports of investigations by Ashok Kumar Malhotra, retired DIG of CBI, the auditors displayed no professional scepticism and due diligence. The auditors also failed to obtain sufficient appropriate audit evidence... the total material and pervasive

misstatements amounted to Rs 1,615 crore, which the auditors did not identify and report in their independent audit report," it said.

The regulator for auditors and audit firms dealing with listed and large companies also said there was an attempt to mislead the agency by "adding and altering documents in their audit files, which amounted to tampering". Besides, they have violated the code of ethics issued by the Institute of Chartered Accountants of India as they had audit and non-audit work from a large number of Coffee Day companies and the promoters, which amounts to conflict of interest and the professional fees received from these entities were over 40% of the total fees.

70 startups cut over 17k jobs in 1st half of '23

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New Delhi: The prolonged funding winter has forced Indian startups to leave thousands of employees out in the cold. In the first half of 2023, about 70 startups have laid off more than 17,000 employees, data sourced from recruitment and staffing firm CIEL HR showed.

Startups, which typically depend on external investments for growth, downsized after a slump in investor funding forced them to cut costs and conserve cash. "The funding crunch is the biggest challenge for these startups with a dearth of new investments flowing into the industry," said Aditya Mishra, MD & CEO at CIEL HR.

FUNDING DROPS NEARLY 80% IN A YEAR

A slump in investor funding has forced startups to cut costs and conserve cash. "Funding crunch is the biggest challenge for these startups," says an official	like grocery, baby care, personal care), fintech, edtech, logistics tech, health-tech are among sectors that have seen layoffs
Funding for startups fell 79% to \$3.8bn in the first half of 2023 from \$18.3bn in the year-ago period	Companies including unicorns like Meesho, Unacademy, Swiggy and ShareChat have cut jobs
E-commerce (segments	In edtech, Byju's alone has fired some 500-1,000 employees this year

segments like grocery, baby care, and personal care), fintech, edtech, logistics tech, health-tech are among sectors that have seen layoffs, the data showed. Companies including unicorns like Meesho, Unacademy, Swiggy and ShareChat have cut jobs. In

edtech, Byju's — which has been battling a series of crises — has alone fired 500-1,000 employees this year.

Funding for startups declined to \$3.8 billion in the first half of 2023 from \$18.3 billion in the year-ago period, recording a year-on-year fall

of nearly 80%, according to estimates by PwC. This is not to say that there is a dearth of capital in the ecosystem — India focused funds are sitting on an unallocated capital of an estimated \$18 billion, according to analysts. However, the flow of capital into startups has become selective amid the economic downturn and investors are writing cheques only for companies that are demonstrating a path to profitability.

"All investors are asking their portfolio companies to improve on unit economics and look at sustainable growth as against growth at any cost," Amit Jain, co-founder & CEO at the CardDekho Group told TOI earlier.

A report by RedSeer said sustained startup funding con-

tinues to be impacted due to the increasing cost of capital, interest rates, and a decline in the value of technology stocks. The firm's analysis of about 100 unicorns suggests that nearly 20% of them are likely to struggle in the coming years due to unclear business models, regulatory challenges, and plummeting demand. Some could shut, pivot to new models or get acquired.

EV startups, though, are faring better and some are even thriving, said Mishra. In fact, startups experimenting with emerging technologies and operating in areas like AI, EVs, climate tech, deep tech and space tech are seeing a surge in investor interest as they attempt to build products and solutions in line with the changing tech narrative.

COLOMBIAN CARNIVAL



DEFYING THE ODDS: Linda Caicedo (C) celebrates scoring Colombia's first goal with teammates

Caicedo Shines Again As South Americans Stun Germany With A 97th-Minute Vanegas Winner

Sydney: Believe the hype. Linda Caicedo is for real, and so are Colombia's chances of going far at the Women's World Cup. As for the country's fans, who gave Sydney Football Stadium the feel of a Colombia home game on Sunday, their passionate support created a jubilant atmosphere that lingered long after a 2-1 win over two-time champion Germany provided one of the tournament's great upsets. "This is something historic for us. We've been feeling the whole time the backing from the fans from our country," Colombia assistant coach Angelo Marsiglia said. "Today we were playing as a home team."

Caicedo produced another moment of magic to put Colombia on course for back-to-back wins in Group H with her opening goal in the 52nd minute. She needed treatment late in regulation but stayed on the field and, five minutes later, Alexandra Popp equalized from the penalty spot.

That setback for Colombia in the 89th merely preceded an even later twist when defender Manuela Vanegas headed in a winner in seventh minute of stoppage time.

Cue wild celebrations from Colombia, and looks of disbelief among the German players. Caicedo and her teammates certainly have had a dramatic campaign.

The 18-year-old Real Madrid star had a health scare earlier in the week when she dropped to the ground, holding her chest in a practice session. Team officials said it was fatigue, and she certainly appeared to be in full flight for her stunning second-half strike.

Cancer survivor Caicedo had already scored from distance in the 2-0 win against South Korea on Tuesday. But while that goal involved an error from goalkeeper Yoon Young-geul, on this occasion it was all about individual brilliance.

Collecting the ball from just inside the area after a corner, she worked her way into space by bewildering two German defenders in a fast-stepping move before lashing a shot into the top corner. Caicedo, followed by her teammates, charged toward the corner to get closer to share the moment with the elated crowd.

"Linda Caicedo is a fantastic player. We knew that before the World Cup," Germany coach Martina Voss-Tecklenburg said. "We needed to be very attentive."

"It was a good goal. I have to admit that. But we definitely should be better. We should keep ball."

Germany is unlikely to be the last team to get the Caicedo treatment in

her debut World Cup, provided she remains healthy.

Just days after struggling with fatigue at practice, Caicedo needed medical treatment behind play in the 84th minute. She dropped to the ground and, as she lay face down on the pitch, was checked by trainers as the referee stood nearby. She got up and started walking to the bench but, after signaling she was okay, went back onto the field and continued the game.

Marsiglia later tried to allay concerns, explaining that the teenager had been exhausted but adding that there was a "bit of acceleration" in her heart.

While Caicedo has been her country's inspiration at the tournament, Vanegas' late strike embodied the wide spread of talent in the team.

She rose to head in substitute Leicy Santos' corner deep into time added on to move Colombia to the top of the group. "This was a decisive match to qualify for the next round," Marsiglia said. "This is a great win for the whole country but the game and tournament still continues."

Germany now must regroup, having gone so close to salvaging a draw when Colombia goalkeeper Catalina Perez was penalized for bringing down Lena Oberdorf in the box.

Germany has never failed to advance from the group stage of the World Cup and this was its first loss in a group game since 1995. AP

CO-HOSTS NZ BOW OUT OF CUP IN TEARS

Dunedin: New Zealand captain Ali Riley admitted there were plenty of tears among the Football Ferns after the co-hosts bowed out of the Women's World Cup on Sunday. A goalless draw against Switzerland in Dunedin was not enough for New Zealand to reach the knock-out stages, while the Swiss advanced after finishing top of Group A.

"There are a lot of tears out there, but they should be so proud to finish on four points," Riley said as Norway, who thrashed the Philippines 6-0, advanced on goal difference at New Zealand's expense, having chalked up the same points tally. "We gave everything. It was a really good performance, especially defensively. We fought really hard." New Zealand had high hopes of reaching the last 16 after a 1-0 win over Norway in their opening game. AFP

“THIS IS SOMETHING HISTORIC FOR US. WE’VE BEEN FEELING THE WHOLE TIME THE BACKING FROM THE FANS FROM OUR COUNTRY. TODAY WE WERE PLAYING AS A HOME TEAM.”
— Angelo Marsiglia | Colombia assistant coach

Benzina is 1st sr-level Women's WC player to compete in hijab

Adelaide: Stepping onto the field against South Korea in Morocco's second Women's World Cup match, defender Nouhaila Benzina made history as the first player to wear a hijab while competing at a senior-level global tournament.

History was also made as a 1-0 victory after Ibtissam Jrai-di struck early saw Morocco triumph in a Women's World Cup match for the first time.

A Fifa ban on playing in religious head coverings in its sanctioned games for "health and safety reasons" was overturned in 2014 after advocacy from activists, athletes, government and football officials.

"I have no doubt that more and more women and Muslim girls will look at Benzina and just really be inspired - not just the players, but I think decision makers, coaches, other sports as well," said Asmaah Helal, a co-founder of the Muslim Women in Sports Network.



Nouhaila Benzina played a key role in defence against South Korea

I have no doubt that more and more women and Muslim girls will look at Benzina and just really be inspired - not just the players, but I think decision makers, coaches, other sports as well. — Asmaah Helal | CO-FOUNDER OF THE MUSLIM WOMEN IN SPORTS NETWORK

Network. Benzina plays professional club football for the Association's Sports of Forces Armed Royal - the eight-time defending champion in Morocco's top women's league.

She did not play in Morocco's opening 6-0 loss to Germany in Melbourne, and had to wait six days to finally get her start in the Group H game in Adelaide.

It was worth it. The Atlas

Lionesses played with more freedom in an afternoon game against South Korea, scoring in the 6th minute and hanging on for a 1-0 win.

Benzina played an important role in the defensive line, and picked up a yellow card late in the game as South Korea counter-attacked. Morocco is the first Arab or North African nation to qualify for the Women's World Cup. AP

Barca and the woodwork defeat Real Madrid in Texas 'Clasico'

Arlington: Barcelona beat Real Madrid 3-0 in a fiercely contested friendly match on Saturday with an early strike from Ousmane Dembele and late goals from Fermin Lopez and Ferran Torres.

The result was harsh on Carlo Ancelotti's team, who struck the woodwork five times and created plenty of opportunities. But Spanish champions Barcelona's more clinical finishing proved to be the difference. A packed

AT&T Stadium, home of the NFL's Dallas Cowboys, witnessed a game which had all the passion and commitment of a real derby despite being a pre-season warm-up. Barcelona coach Xavi Hernandez admitted the scoreline flattered his team.

"The result could have been different, the result is a bit misleading, Madrid also had many chances and we shouldn't be overconfident," he said. Xavi also questioned



whether he had enough depth for the upcoming season.

"I think Madrid have a much bigger squad than us," he said.

Ancelotti also played down the scoreline and was pleased by many aspects. "The result is the least important thing. It hurts to lose, but I'll keep the good things we did," said Ancelotti.

"Five (against the woodwork) in a game is quite rare, I don't think it has ever happened to me. But it's better if it happens in pre-season," added the Italian. AFP

TEN HAG MUM OVER MAN UTD'S REPORTED DEAL FOR HOJLUND

Las Vegas: Manchester United have reportedly agreed a deal worth an initial £64 million to sign Atalanta striker Rasmus Hojlund. The Denmark international is the third major arrival at Old Trafford during the

summer transfer window after the signings of Chelsea midfielder Mason Mount and Inter Milan goalkeeper Andre Onana.

United are understood to have agreed a fee of £64 million (\$82 million) for Hojlund, with a further £8 million in add-ons. The 20-year-old is reported to have agreed terms



on a five-year deal with the option of a further season.

United manager Erik ten Hag was tight-lipped about the reports when asked by reporters on Saturday ahead of Sunday's friendly against Borussia Dortmund in Las Vegas. "I can't talk about the player who is still under contract (with) another club," said the Dutchman. AFP

SNAPSHOTS

IOA asks Randhir to continue as OCA chief

India's veteran sports administrator Randhir Singh will be in charge of the Olympic Council of Asia (OCA) during the upcoming Asian Games in Hangzhou, China, after the International Olympic Committee refused to recognise the recent election at OCA. The IOA has asked Randhir to continue discharging his duties as the acting president of the OCA. PTI

Gogoi is 61kg junior Asian champion

India's Siddhanta Gogoi clinched men's 61kg junior title while Gyaneshwari Yadav and Koyel Bar won silver in the women's 49kg event at the Asian Youth and Junior Weightlifting Championships in Greater Noida on Sunday. Siddhanta lifted 265kg (116kg+149kg) to give India their first gold of the ongoing edition. While Gyaneshwari lifted a total of 175kg (78kg+97kg) to finish runner up among the juniors, Koyel came second in the youth category with 69kg in snatch and 86 kg in clean and jerk for a total effort of 155kg. PTI

Archers, shooters win a gold each

India won a gold each in shooting and archery as it maintained its fourth position in the medals tally at the 31st FISU World University Games in Chengdu (China), with five gold, two silver and four bronze medals. Archers Aman Saini and Pragati bagged a gold in the Compound Mixed Team event. Shooter Aishwary Pratap Singh Tomar won the other gold on Sunday in the Men's 50m Rifle 3-positions. IANS

Zverev boosts ATP Finals hopes

Germany's Alexander Zverev swept past Serb Laslo Djere 7-5, 6-3 for his first title in nearly two years at his home Hamburg Open on Sunday, boosting his hopes of qualifying for the ATP Finals.

Swiatek wins home WTA title

Iga Swiatek cruised to the title in her home tournament, the Warsaw Open with a 6-0, 6-1 victory over exhausted Laura Siegemund on Sunday. AFP

Rinku credits IPL for Asiad berth

Crediting the "special IPL innings" for changing his life, Uttar Pradesh batter Rinku Singh said he was left emotional when he received his maiden India call up for the Asian Games. "Everyone at home danced," Rinku said in a BCCI video. PTI

ACTION TODAY

CRICKET: England vs Australia, 5th Test, Day 5, 3.30 pm (Sony); Major Cricket League, Final, 6am (JioCinema, Sports18)
FOOTBALL: Fifa Women's WC: Costa Rica vs Zambia, 12.30 pm; Japan vs Spain, 12.30 pm; Ireland vs Nigeria, 3.30 pm; Canada vs Australia, 3.30 pm (FanCode)
TENNIS: ATP-250, Los Cabos, 5.30 am (Eurosport)

Shroff's Swift claims feature

Pune: Pesi Shroff-schooled filly Swift won the JE Hughes Trophy, feature of the Pune Races held on Sunday. Trainers Shroff and MK Jadhav registered two winners each to emerge as the most successful professionals.

Results with dividends

1. Ismail Khan Plate (Div-2): Adamas 1, Zacapa 2, Fashion Icon 3, Come Back Please 4, 1-1/4, 1, 1. T:1:28.05. Tote: Rs 29 win; 19, 35, 19 places; Shp 94; Fc 382; Q 217; Tanala: 1540 & 404.

2. Bushtops Plate: Sea The Sun 1, Transcend 2, Alpha Domino 3, Kimiko 4, 2-1/4, 3/4, T:1:54.47. Tote: Rs 23 win; 15, 27, 16 places; Shp 59; Fc 102; Q 54; Tanala: 289 & 131.

3. Classic Talk Plate: Miss American Pie 1, Zafirah 2, Racing Romance 3, Armoury 4, 1-3/4, Hd, 1/2, T:1:00.29. Tote: Rs 64 win; 15, 21, 18 places; Shp 42; Fc 692; Q 246; Tanala: 922 & 320.

4. JE Hughes Trophy: Swift 1, Gazino 2, Magileto 3, Cellini 4, 3/4, Ln, 3/4, T:1:10.43. Tote: Rs 24 win; 14, 38, 21 places; Shp 251; Fc 409; Q 242; Tanala: 1448 & 342.

5. P Hadow Trophy: It's My Time 1, Lord And Master 2, Lit 3, Vincent Van Gogh 4, 2-1/2, Ln, 2-1/4, T:1:26.98 Tote: Rs 17 win; 15, 18, 33 places; Shp 91; Fc 123; Q 101; Tanala: 1521 & 614.

6. Selfie Star Plate: Pure 1, Northern Singer 2, Commandment 3, Jet-firm 4, 1-1/4, No, 1/2, T:1:11.74. Tote: Rs 87 win; 26, 16, 26 places; Shp 65; Fc 557; Q 520; Tanala: 8755 & 1407.

7. Ismail Khan Plate (Div-1): Alpine Star 1, Doc Martin 2, Stunning Vivalis 3, The Flutist 4, 8-3/4, 2, Shd, T:1:27.18. Tote: Rs 24 win; 10, 16, 23 places; Shp 44; Fc 75; Q 48; Tanala: 1000 & 857.

Jackpot: 70% Rs 2667 (42 Tkt) & 30% 500 (96); Super Jackpot: 70% 3626 (9) & 30% 699 (20); Treble: 390 (64). TNN

Meilutyte rewrites 50m breaststroke world record

Sjoestroem Goes Past Phelps's Tally; Australia Finish Above USA & China

Fukuoka (Japan): Ruta Meilutyte of Lithuania set her second world record in as many days in the women's 50 metres breaststroke, powering to the gold medal in a superb time of 29.16 seconds on the final day of swimming action at the World Aquatics Championships on Sunday.

WORLD AQUATICS

Meilutyte obliterated the record of 29.30 seconds that she had jointly held with Benedetta Pilato of Italy, after setting that mark in the semifinals on Saturday and she sent out a warning to her rivals ahead of next year's Paris Olympics.

She was 0.78 seconds ahead of silver medalist Lilly King of the United States. Pilato took bronze in 30.04 seconds.

Sweden's Sarah Sjoestroem had broken her own world record in the women's 50m freestyle semifinals in a time of 23.61 seconds a day earlier and the 29-year-old was almost as quick in the final to claim gold in style.

Sjoestroem finished only one hundredth of a second away from her blistering effort for the record to beat Australia's Shayna Jack, who



BLAZING AWAY: Lithuania's Ruta Meilutyte competes in the final of the women's 50m breaststroke event in Fukuoka, Japan on Sunday

clocked 24.10.

Sjoestroem's freestyle victory meant the evergreen swimmer went past American great Michael Phelps with her 21st individual medal at the Worlds.

Zhang Yufei took bronze in 24.15 to further swell China's medal tally.

Ahmed Hafnaoui ensured a second gold of the meeting for Tunisia after edging past Bobby Finke of the United States in a fiercely contested men's 1,500m freestyle.

He finished in 14 minutes 31.54 seconds to miss out on Sun Yang's world record of 14:31.02. Finke was a mere 0.05 seconds behind the champion and Australia's Sam Short, who led for the first half of the race, settled for bronze.

Hunter Armstrong had got the US off to a golden start on

the final day of swimming at the Marine Messe Fukuoka Hall as he wrapped up the men's 50m backstroke title to secure his first individual crown.

The 22-year-old touched the wall in 24.05 seconds, 0.19 seconds ahead of compatriot Justin Ress with China's Xu Jiayu taking bronze after finishing 0.45 seconds behind the winner.

Canada's world record-holder Summer McIntosh proved too good for the field in the women's 400m individual medley, roaring to gold in a championship record time of 4:27.11 for her second victory at the meeting and fourth world title overall.

Australia finished the meeting with 13 gold to top the table, ahead of the United States who had seven while China were third with five. The next edition of the worlds will be hosted by Doha in February 2024. REUTERS

Eighth straight win for unstoppable Verstappen

Spa-Francorchamps (Belgium):

Formula One championship leader Max Verstappen roared to a crushing eighth win in a row, one short of the all-time record, in a Red Bull one-two with Sergio Perez at the Belgian Grand Prix on Sunday.

Red Bull's 13th consecutive victory made the team the first in the sport's 73-year history to win the opening 12 races of a season, one more than McLaren managed in 1988 with Ayrton Senna and Alain Prost.

BELGIAN GP

Verstappen, who started sixth after a five-place grid penalty, extended his championship lead over Perez to 125 points — effectively five races — after taking the chequered flag 22.3 seconds ahead of the Mexican.

"I knew we had a great car, it was just about surviving turn one," said the double world champion, who has now won in Belgium for the last three years in a row including from 14th on the grid last year.

"From there onwards we made the right overtakes and moves."

He is heading for a third title with plenty of races to spare, the only real doubt being where he might seal it.

Charles Leclerc, who started on pole for Ferrari, completed the podium with Lewis Hamilton fourth and securing fastest lap for Mercedes.

The one-two was Red Bull's fifth of the season and so comfortable for Verstappen that his feisty radio



INVINCIBLE: Red Bull's Max Verstappen celebrates with sparkling wine on the podium after winning the race

chats with race engineer Gianpiero Lambiase provided much more of a talking point.

They also showed his supreme confidence.

"I could also push on and we do another stop? A little bit of pit stop training," Verstappen suggested with 14 laps remaining.

"No, not this time," came the reply. Lambiase had earlier told Verstappen sharply to "use your head a bit more" and questioned whether it had been sensible for the driver to push so hard on the tyres on his out lap after a stop.

"Max, please follow my instruction and trust it," Lambiase told his driver as early as lap 12 after his word had been questioned.

Results (Top 5): 1 M Verstappen (Red Bull) 1:22:30.450s, 2 S Pérez (Red Bull) +22.305s, 3 C Leclerc (Ferrari), 4 L Hamilton (Mercedes) +49.671s, 5 F Alonso (Aston Martin) +56.184s. REUTERS

Indian men's hockey team edges out Netherlands 2-1

Barcelona: The Indian men's hockey team notched up a 2-1 win over reigning FIH Hockey Pro League champions Netherlands 2-1 in the third-fourth placing match here at the 100th Anniversary Spanish Hockey Federation — International Tournament on Sunday. Captain

INT'L TOURNAMENT

Harmanpreet Singh (15th) and Dilpreet Singh (50th) scored in India's hard-fought victory, while Thierry Brinkman (25th) scored the lone goal for the Dutch side.

Interestingly, all goals came from penalty corners.

The Indian team will arrive in Chennai in the early hours of Tuesday morning to play the much-awaited Asian Champions Trophy start-

ing August 3 at the Mayor Radhakrishnan Hockey Stadium.

Women outclass Spain

The Indian women's hockey team produced a dominant performance to beat hosts Spain 3-0 in Barcelona on Sunday. Vandana Katiariya (22nd minute), Monika (48th) and Udita (58th) were the goalscorers as India remained unbeaten in the multinational tournament.

Riding on the success of Saturday's match against England, where Lalremliam's hat-trick helped them win 3-0, table toppers India got off to strong start in the first quarter.

The Indians started cautiously and maintained a disciplined structure with short, accurate passes that allowed them to create space in the circle. AGENCIES



RAHANE PULLS OUT OF COUNTY STINT WITH LEICESTERSHIRE CITING 'HECTIC SCHEDULE'

OLYMPIC BADMINTON CHAMPION AXELSEN AND SE-YOUNG CLINCH JAPAN OPEN TITLES



“Surya would be the first one to admit his ODI numbers probably haven't been up to his high standards or the standard that he has set in T20Is. He is learning about ODI cricket. He is learning how to bat through the middle overs. He is a talent. We want to give as many opportunities we can to him.”
— Rahul Dravid

India Coach Defends Resting Rohit And Kohli, Wants To Look At Bigger Picture Ahead Of World Cup

Bridgetown: India head coach Rahul Dravid said that the team was “not worried about every single game and single series” and will have to try out other players ahead of the World Cup, as he defended his decision to rest Rohit Sharma and Virat Kohli in the second ODI against West Indies.

chance to try out some of our players. We have got few of our players injured who are in NCA. With a month to go until Asia Cup, we are running out of time in a lot of ways. We are hopeful that some of them (injured players) will be fit for Asia Cup and World Cup, but we can't take those chances.
“We just felt that in a series like

‘NO WORRIES’

decision to rest regular skipper Rohit and star batter Virat Kohli badly backfired as the visitors were bowled out for 181 in 40.5 overs. The home team chased down the target with 80 balls to spare for an easy six-wicket victory to level the three-match ODI series 1-1. “We will always look at the bigger picture. At this stage in the cycle, the Asia Cup and World Cup coming up we have to look at the bigger picture because of some of the injuries we have. We can't worry about every game, every series,” Dravid said.

“To give people chances, Virat and Rohit sat out. We have to take those risks, we might have to take those chances in situations like that looking at big events. We want to give the young players as many chances we possibly can.”

Dravid said with some players injured and recovering at the National Cricket Academy (NCA) in Bengaluru, it was imperative for the management to give chances to other team members ahead of the Asia Cup (August 30-September 17) and the World Cup (October-November).

“Honestly, this was our last

this with two, three matches to go for the Asia Cup, playing Virat and Rohit would not have given us too many answers.” **PTI**

78.41
Shai Hope's average in ODI wins — his tally being 2274 runs, including eight hundreds and nine fifties, in 41 matches. His fifth fifty against India is his 24th overall.

1 After losing nine successive ODIs between December 18, 2019 and July 27, 2023, West Indies' win by six wickets is their first vs India in ten matches.

— Rajesh Kumar

BRIEF SCORES: India: 181/10 in 40.5 overs (Ishan Kishan 55, Shubman Gill 34; Gudakesh Motie 3/36, Romario Shepherd 3/37) **lost to West Indies 182/4 in 36.4** (Shai Hope 63*, Keacy Carty 48*, Shardul Thakur 3-42) by six wickets.



IND VS WI
2ND ODI

KNOCK-KNOCK... TROUBLE: Indian coach Rahul Dravid (R) and captain Rohit Sharma need to zero in on their combinations for the World Cup in India in October

I'M A TURTLE RIGHT NOW, NOT RABBIT: HARDIK PANDYA

Bridgetown: India ODI stand-in captain Hardik Pandya has admitted that he is right now “a turtle not rabbit”, but is keen to increase his bowling workload to prepare himself for the World Cup at home in October-November.

Pandya has been used sparingly as a bowler in international matches in recent times due to a spate of injuries — shoulder and back to be precise. He



bowled three overs in the first match and took one wicket giving away 17 runs.

He, however, went wicketless in the second ODI here on Saturday, conceding 38 runs from 6.4 overs.

Plagued by injuries, Pandya, who last played Tests for India in September 2018, has limited himself to only playing white-ball cricket.

“My body is fine. I have to bowl more overs and get my workload up for the World Cup. I'm a turtle right now not the rabbit and hoping everything goes right as the World Cup comes on,” Pandya said after India's disappointing six-wicket defeat in a rain-marred second ODI here. **AGENCIES**

Warner, Khawaja help Oz to 135-0 in chase of 384

London: The fourth day's play in the final Ashes Test at The Oval on Sunday was abandoned due to rain after Australian openers David Warner (58) and Usman Khawaja (69) shared a partnership of 135 as they chase a target of 384 to beat England. The pair withstood a barrage of hostile bowling as they steamed past 100 on their way to the highest opening partnership in the Ashes in England since 2009.

James Anderson floored Warner with an unintended beamer when Australia were



Usman Khawaja (L) and David Warner battled through a hostile spell from Mark Wood but survived

just short of a hundred, the batter managing to fend off the shoulder-height ball with his bat handle. Fast bowler Mark Wood hit Khawaja on the helmet with a bouncer, leading to a lengthy concussion check before the rain set in.

England's Stuart Broad, who on Saturday announced his retirement from cricket after this match, and Anderson, celebrating his 41st birthday, had opened the bowling after ending England's second innings together in the morning, with Broad smashing the final

ball of his batting career for six. Chris Woakes, Moeen Ali, Joe Root and Wood all joined the attack for spells under the floodlights on an overcast day, but were unable to break through the openers' defences.

No team has chased down more than 263 at The Oval — a record set by England against Australia back in 1902 — although 10 sides have scored more than 300 to draw.

Australia retained the Ashes after the fourth Test was washed out, leaving them 2-1 up. They are hoping to win the series outright to become the first Aussie side to win in England since 2001. **REUTERS**

Brief Scores: England 283 and 395 (Root 91, Bairstow 78, Crawley 73, Starc 4-94, Murphy 3-110) lead Australia 295 and 135-0 (O Warner 56, U Khawaja 69) by 248 runs.

2 Broad is just the second all-rounder to manage 3,000 runs (3662 at 18.03) and capture 600-plus wickets in Tests — the first being Australia's Shane Warne — 3154 (ave 17.32) runs and 708 (25.41) wickets in 145 Tests.

151 He remains the only bowler in the history of Tests to bag 150 wickets or more vs Australia.

1034 Runs at an average of 57.44, including three hundreds in 11 Tests by **Usman Khawaja**. He has become the first man this year to score 1,000-plus runs.

Retiring Broad recalls how Yuvraj's Durban assault in T20 World Cup toughened him

London: England fast bowler Stuart Broad, who announced on Saturday that he would retire from all forms of cricket at the end of the Ashes series against Australia, had an illustrious Test career with 602 victims in 167 matches.

His white-ball record though, especially in T20Is, wasn't anything great to write home about. And in the 2007 World T20, in Durban, against India, he came face to face with the format's unforgiving nature as he became the first bowler to be hit for six sixes in an over in T20Is by Yuvraj Singh.

Broad was carted around in different parts of Kingmead in the 19th over of India's innings as Yuvraj scored 50 off just 12 balls in a breathtaking display of power hitting.

While such a harsh outing can potentially be career-ending for a young man, who was still only in his second year in international cricket, Broad revealed that it was a vital moment in his career.

“Yeah, it was obviously a pretty tough day. What would I have been: 21, 22? I learned loads. I pretty much based a whole mental routine through that experience knowing that I was left very short as an international performer in that moment. I'd

rushed my preparation. I didn't have any sort of pre-ball routine. I didn't have any focus, particularly, and I started building my 'warrior mode' that I call it after that experience,” Broad said in the press conference. **REUTERS**



“Ultimately, of course, I wish that didn't happen. I think what helped me was it was a dead rubber, so it didn't feel like I'd knocked us out of the World Cup or something. But I think it steeled me up to make me the competitor I am to this day and has driven me forward a huge amount,” Broad added.

His tormentor of the day, Yuvraj, was magnanimous enough to wish him well on his retirement.

Taking to Twitter, he posted, “Take a bow Stuart Broad. Congratulations on an incredible Test career, one of the finest and most feared red ball bowlers, and a real legend! Your journey and determination have been super inspiring. Good luck for the next leg Broadway!” **AGENCIES**

MLC final is also a battle of corporate giants

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

A blockbuster clash is expected when Seattle Orcas take on MI New York in the final of the inaugural Major League Cricket (MLC) at the Grand Prairie Stadium in Dallas on Sunday. The final, a culmination of some intense cricket over the last three weeks, is also being termed as a faceoff between corporate honchos Satya Nadella — one of the co-owners of Orcas and the CEO of Microsoft — and Reliance boss Mukesh Ambani, whose company owns MI New York.

The Seattle Orcas have been the best team in the league so far, winning five

out of the six games they played, and will look to continue their consistent show in the summit clash. They defeated Texas Super Kings by nine wickets in the Qualifier to march into the final.

MI New York, who scraped through to the playoffs, managed to enter the final by first winning the Eliminator against Washington Freedom by 16 runs, and then handing out a six-wicket defeat to Texas Super Kings in the Challenger.

The Orcas had the upper hand in the league match involving the two sides, coming out victors by two wickets. It

was South African Heinrich Klaasen's breathtaking 44-ball 110 (9x4, 7x6) that helped Orcas chase down 194 against an attack that had Trent Boult and Rashid Khan in their ranks.

With 251 runs from 7 games at an average of 41.83, MI New York's Nicholas Pooran is the tournament's leading run-scorer and the West Indian looks in good form. Boult has been a star for MI New York with the ball. With 19 wickets from 7 games, the Kiwi pacer has scalped the most in the league and will look to add more to his tally.

For Orcas, Klaasen has been the in-form player, scoring 231 runs at an av-

erage of 77.00 and more importantly at an astounding strike-rate of 206.25. He is not far from Pooran in terms of total runs scored and is the only centurion in the league. There have been a lot of great bowling performances from the Orcas team, but the most consistent has been local lad Cameron Gannon — who hails from Sydney, Australia — with 11 wickets from 6 games.

The Seattle Orcas seem to be the favourites to win the inaugural MLC due to their consistent performances throughout the tournament, but MI New York is still a side filled with match-winners. Overall, the stage is set for a cracker of a contest.

Dube powers West to six-wicket victory

Puducherry: Dashing all-rounder Shivam Dube went on a six-hitting spree as West Zone registered a comfortable six-wicket win over North Zone in a round-robin match of the Deodhar trophy here on Sunday.

The left-handed batter, who plays for Chennai Super Kings in the IPL, depos-

DEODHAR TROPHY

ited the ball into the stands five times besides hitting three fours in an unbeaten 78-ball 83 as West Zone knocked off a target of 260 in 48.5 balls.

Dube shared an unconquered 138-run partnership for the fifth wicket with Kathan Patel (63) to complete the job after Harvik Desai (56) set the platform with a fine fifty at the top.

Opting to bat, North Zone posted a competitive 259 for six, riding on the three fifties scored by Himanshu Rana (54), Nitish Rana (54) and Shubham Rohilla (56) but it was not enough in the end. For West Zone, Shams Mulani (3-29) was the most successful bowler, while RS Hangargekar (1/43), Sarfaraz



Shivam Dube hit five sixes and three fours in his 78-ball 83 to help West Zone beat North Zone

Khan (1/17) and Rahul Tripathi (1/26) scalped one wicket each.

Rishi Dhawan (1/30), Mayank Yadav (1/39) and Nitish Rana (1/46) took one wicket each for North Zone.

West Zone are placed at the third spot with 12 points following three wins in four matches, while North Zone are at the fifth position with one win from four games.

South Zone maintain winning streak Mayank Agarwal and Sai Sudharsan came up with superb half-centuries as South Zone produced an all-round show to continue its unbeaten run, coasting to a comfortable five-wicket win over East Zone in a round-robin match of the Deodhar Trophy here on Sunday. Agarwal (84) and Sudharsan (53) shared an 118-run partnership for the second wicket, studded with 10 fours and two sixes, in South Zone's emphatic 230-run chase in 44.2 overs. **AGENCIES**

Brief Scores: **North Zone** 259-6 in 50 overs (Himanshu Rana 54, Nitish Rana 54, Shubham Rohilla 56*, Shams Mulani 3-29) **lost to West Zone** 260-4 in 48.5 overs (Harvik Desai 56, Shivam Dube 83, Kathan Patel 63*).

East Zone 229 all out in 40 overs (Virat Singh 49, Subhranshu Senapati 44, Akash Deep 44, Mukhtar Hussain 33; Vasuki Koushik 3-37, Sai Kishore 3-45) **lost to South Zone** 230-5 in 44.2 overs (Mayank Agarwal 84, Sai Sudharsan 53, Narayan Jagadeesan 32).

North East Zone 164 in 49 overs (Ashish Thapa 31, Kamsha Yangfo 35; Aditya Sarwate 3-19) **lost to Central Zone** 165-2 in 33 overs (Shivam Chaudhary 85*, Yash Dubey 72).

42 runs in 1 over!

Kabul: Afghan international cricketer Sediqlullah Atal smashed an astonishing 42 runs off one over Saturday in a Kabul Premier League Twenty20 match, bettering Chris Gayle's 37 in the IPL in 2011.

The onslaught over came as the Shaheen Hunters were playing Abasin Defenders. Atal, a 21-year-old all-rounder who has one T20 International cap, was on 76 — and his team on 158 for six — when spinner Amir Zazai trundled in to deliver his first ball of the 19th over: Zazai overstepped the crease and Atal smashed him for six. The next ball was a wide — which beat the 'keeper as well for four byes. Five out of six deliveries were sent soaring over the boundary ropes by Atal in an astonishing display of power hitting as he finished on 118 not out off 56 balls. **AFP**

Harmanpreet set to play for Trent Rockets in The Hundred

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Mumbai: Slapped with a two-match ban by the International Cricket Council due to her boorish behaviour in the third ODI against Bangladesh on July 22, Indian women's team captain **Harmanpreet Kaur** is set to return to the field on August 1 when she turns out for the Trent Rockets in The Hundred competition in England.

Harmanpreet will be in action on day one of the event when she turns out for Trent Rockets against Southern Brave, at Trent Bridge, Nottingham. In an Instagram video posted on Saturday, the India skipper said: “Hi guys, this is

Harmanpreet Kaur. Just arrived in Trent Bridge. We've a game on the 1st. Come and watch us. Thank you.” Apart from her, three other top players of the Indian women's team — vice-captain Smriti Mandhana, Jemimah Rodrigues and Richa Ghosh will play in The Hundred.

Harmanpreet's suspension applies to international games, which means that she won't be available for the first two games (quarterfinal & semifinal) of the Asian Games in China. She has played in The Hundred for Manchester Originals in the past.

Shaw gets visa, flies off to UK for maiden county stint

After an inordinate delay, Prithvi Shaw has finally received his UK visa, which will

enable him to begin his maiden stint in County cricket, with Northamptonshire. “Shaw received his UK visa on Saturday and flew to England via Dubai on Sunday. He will make his County debut for the Northants” on Friday in a Royal London One-Day Championship match against Gloucestershire at Cheltenham,” a reliable source told TOI.

The Mumbaier was supposed to join Northamptonshire after the conclusion of the Duleep Trophy, and missed the ongoing Deodhar Trophy, before a delay in getting the UK visa kept him waiting for longer than he would've expected.

Three former India captains of repute-Bishan Singh Bedi, Sourav Ganguly and Anil Kumble have represented the Northants in the past.





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AFGHAN INT'L CRICKETER SEDIQULLAH ATAL HITS AN ASTONISHING 42 RUNS OFF 1 OVER IN KABUL PREMIER LEAGUE TWENTY20 MATCH 17

Shah to table Delhi services bill in LS today

Home minister Amit Shah is set to introduce in the LS on Monday a bill that seeks to replace the ordinance that wrested the control of bureaucracy from Delhi government by neutering an SC verdict that had vested superintendence of "services" in the elected regime. **P 6**

Girl turned away by 4 hosps after snake bite, dies

A 12-year-old girl from Raigad's Pen who was bitten by a snake died after delay in administering the anti-snake venom (ASV). She was taken to four hospitals before reaching MGM hospital in Kamothé. Activists alleged she died due to lack of ASV injections in hospitals. **P 4**

ATS confirms Colaba area pics seized from duo

ATS officials confirmed they have seized a drone, images of Chabad House and Colaba area and some locations in Pune besides 500 GB data from the phones and a pen drive of 2 members of an ISIS-inspired group arrested in Pune on July 18. **P 3**

UP man drinks poison on FB Live over rape charge

BJP Kisan Morcha district convenor in UP who was recently booked for raping a woman, consumed poison and broadcast the act on Facebook Live, saying he "couldn't face" his daughter after the serious accusation". **P 6**

Scolded often for coming late, Hyd woman kills dad

A 45-year-old man from Hyderabad died after his daughter, who is in her twenties and works as a salesperson at a store, stabbed him in the neck with a broken bottle for reprimanding her over coming home late frequently. **P 12**

Bhide row: Ex-CM gets death threat

Kolhapur: The Karad city police in Satara district are investigating an email received on Sunday by former CM Prithviraj Chavan's office in Karad. The letter abused and issued a death threat to Chavan for demanding right-wing activist Sambhaji Bhide's arrest for his objectionable remarks against Mahatma Gandhi. A case of criminal intimidation has been registered. Chavan, a senior Congress leader, represents the Karad South assembly constituency in Satara. Abhijeet Patil reports.

► 'BJP leaders' silence', **P 4**

Isro records 6th successful launch this yr

Chennai: Isro's workhorse PSLV-C56 placed seven Singapore satellites into orbit in a picture-perfect launch early Sunday, marking its sixth successful blast-off this year and adding to the afterglow of a hitch-free start to the Chandrayaan-3 mission just over two weeks ago. With this, Isro has so far launched 431 satellites belonging to 34 countries. **reports U Tejanyam.**

Other upcoming major missions later this year include Gaganyaan test flight, SSLV's third developmental flight and GSLV mission carrying INSAT-3DS.

► Puts 7 sats into orbit, **P 12**

Don't seek classmates' JEE (A) ranks, says IIT-B

Attempt To Stop Discrimination Based On Caste

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Mumbai: In a step towards making the institute more inclusive in the wake of a first-year student, Darshan Solanki, dying by suicide on campus, IIT-Bombay has asked its students to refrain from asking each other's JEE (Advanced) ranks or GATE scores or any information that may reveal their caste or other related aspects. Asking the rank 'could appear like an attempt to find the caste and may set the stage for discrimination', mentioned a set of 'anti-discrimination' guidelines made public by the institute as the new batch of 2023-24 joins the campus.

The guidelines urge students to bond with each other irrespective of their caste, religion or socio-economic status. It also prohibits students from sending messages or jokes that are abusive, casteist,

SOLANKI SUICIDE THE TRIGGER

► Guidelines issued by the institute for 2023-24 say asking about the rank 'could appear like an attempt to find the caste and may set the stage for discrimination'

► They urge students to bond with each other irrespective of their caste, religion or socio-economic status

► The institute also prohibits students from sending messages or jokes that are



abusive, casteist, sexist, or exhibit bigotry

► The family of **Darshan Solanki**, who ended his life on the campus on Feb 12, had reportedly alleged that a college mate 'reduced talking to him after knowing his JEE rank'

► The institute also says it considers it inappropriate to ask a fellow student about their birth/admission category, as it could lead to conscious or subconscious bias

Plagiarism charge on 2 colleges over reports

A Mumbai teacher training college that was accredited by the NAAC recently alleged that two other institutes had submitted identical self-study reports as their own. When the college complained, NAAC closed the cases after accepting an "excuse" of "technical glitch". **P 3**

sexist, or exhibit bigotry.

Solanki's family had reportedly alleged that a college mate 'reduced talking to him after knowing his JEE rank'. An institute spokesperson, however, said that various institute bodies/cells have always

emphasised on IIT-Bombay's zero tolerance policy towards any form of discrimination, during every orientation session for undergraduate and postgraduate entrants.

► No casteist, sexist jokes, **P 3**

29 cases pending before top court's constitutional benches, oldest since 1992

Pradeep.Thakur @timesgroup.com

New Delhi: At last count, the Supreme Court had 69,766 cases pending before it for adjudication. But what catches the eye is the pendency before its constitution benches. The oldest case before a five-judge constitution bench has been pending for 31 years now, and another before a seven-judge bench has been undecided for 29 years. In all, 29 cases are pending before constitution benches.

Five cases are pending before nine-judge constitution benches, the oldest since 1999. Two other cases before such benches have been pending for 21 years.

The Supreme Court and high courts are called constitutional courts as their judgments interpreting the

19 DISPOSED IN 4 YRS

Period	SC Bench Strength	Cases Disposed Of
1950-1959	11	440
1960-1969	14	956
1970-1979	18	292
1980-1989	26	110
1990-1999	26	157
2000-2009	31	138
2010-2019	34	71
2020-2023	34	19
Total	--	2,183

Source: Supreme Court and Union govt

Constitution act as reference points for the subordinate judiciary while adjudicating matters. However, both tiers of the higher judiciary are clogged with routine matters, such as issues related to service, bail and the like.

► Disposal rate down, **P 12**

6cr I-T returns filed with a day to go; tops '22

New Delhi: With over 24 hours to go for submission of income tax returns, without paying any penalty, annual filings reached the six-crore mark by Sunday evening, having crossed last year's level in the afternoon itself.

CBDT said that on Sunday close to 26.8 lakh returns were filed up to 6.30pm, indi-

► **NFRA bans Coffee Day auditors, slaps penalty, P 15**
► **Local units of foreign cos under GST lens for esops, P 15**
► **A \$1 difference can boost Scotch imports, P 15**

ating a glitch-free process. July 31 is the deadline for filing returns by salaried individuals and non-audit cases and those who miss the date can file until December 31, but they will have to shell out a late filing fee of up to Rs 5,000. **TNN**

► Over 50% processed, **P 15**

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If not tamed, Manipur crisis may be threat to nat'l security: INDIA

Oppn Team Writes To Guv, Criticises PM's 'Indifference'

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Guwahati: The conflict in Manipur has been allowed to rage for so long that it could pose a threat to national security if left untamed, opposition alliance INDIA's 21-member delegation to the state told governor Anusuiya Uikey on Sunday while handing her a memorandum that criticises PM Narendra Modi's "brazen indifference to the violence". "Justice should be the cornerstone" of the effort to get the state back on the rails after almost three months of violence, the members from 16 non-NDA parties said before wrapping up their two-day trip.

They blamed the BJP-led government of N Biren Singh for violence flaring up every few days, and continued internet blockade for a cycle of misinformation fuelling mistrust between communities. "You are requested to apprise the Union government of the complete breakdown of law and order in Manipur for the last 89 days," states the memorandum. "The failure of both the Central and state governments to protect the lives and properties of the people of the two communities is apparent from the figures citing more than 140 deaths, burning of more than 5,000 houses, and internal displacement of 60,000 people." The delegation, which visited relief camps in Churachandpur, Moirang and Imphal, said they found the condition in which displaced people have been living "pathetic to say the least".

Congress MP and West Bengal PCC chief Adhir Ranjan Chowdhury told reporters outside Raj Bhavan in Imphal, "A discussion should be held in Parliament at the earliest to find a solution to the Manipur crisis, lest the deteriorating situation pose a threat to India's security." *(With inputs from Chennai)*



A Meitei woman with her child arrives from Mizoram at a relief camp in Imphal on Sunday

Solution lies in creating 3 separate UTs: Kuki leader

Kuki leader and BJP MLA Paolienlal Haokip said the way forward to finding a solution to the state's racial conflict is by creating three separate Union territories. Haokip in an interview to PTI advocated giving "political and administrative recognition to the ethnic separation" in the state, upping the ante from earlier vaguely explained demands for a "separate administration" for Kuki areas made by fellow Kuki community leaders. However, Manipur chief minister N Biren Singh and Meitei groups have voiced their opposition to any moves to "break up" the state. AGENCIES

50 more may be held for Satana rally violence

A day after a march to protest the Manipur strife turned violent in Satana town of Nashik, the police said 50 people are on their radar, and they could soon be arrested, reports **Santosh Sonawane**. Nashik Rural SP Shahaji Umaph told **TOI** 31 people were arrested on Saturday. He added more arrests likely as local cops are scanning CCTV footage.

Hand over reins of state to guv: Cong MP to BJP

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: Amid the unending ethnic strife in Manipur, Congress leader **Vivek Tankha** lavished praise on governor Anusuiya Uikey and urged the BJP leadership to impose Central Rule in the state and hand over its reins to her.

He said the situation can change dramatically if Uikey is given the charge, calling her as possessing a "motherly touch". Pointing out that Uikey, a tribal, hails from his state of Madhya Pradesh, Tankha said, "Anusuiya Uikey is not just the governor of Manipur, but is a very sensible and thinking woman... If PM Narendra Modi and home minister Amit Shah repose faith in her and impose Governor's Rule or President's Rule in Manipur, the situation in the state can change," he said.

Uikey is a senior BJP leader serving as governor, while Tankha is a Congress MP in Rajya Sabha. Tankha's tweet came in response to a post showing Uikey speak to media after her visit to a relief camp in Churachandpur. Uikey said, "I have come among the people to share their pain and sorrow. They all are wondering when peace will return, and they have tension and fear in their minds. I hope normalcy returns fast and these people can start their lives afresh."



45 airlifted to Imphal

About 45 people from Manipur, who had fled Mizoram and were camping in Assam since last week, were flown to Imphal on Sunday. They had fled Mizoram after a former insurgent group issued a warning asking them to leave the state "for their own safety".

Raman effect: How Oppenheimer's PhD guide came to do a stint at IISc

Renowned Physicist And Mathematician Max Born Spent 6 Months At Bengaluru Institute As CV Raman Went All Out To Bring The Best Scientific Minds To India

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Be it critics or the fans, director Christopher Nolan has wowed audiences the world over with his Oppenheimer, a biopic that has brought the attention back to atomic physics, the Manhattan Project and, of course, to J Robert Oppenheimer, the director of that project, which led to the US creating the world's first nuclear bomb and putting it to devastating use as World War II wound down.

But here's a nugget from years before that, even before World War II had begun: quantum physicist and mathematician Max Born, Oppenheimer's PhD guide, had spent six months at Bengaluru's IISc thanks to the efforts of Nobel laureate CV Raman.

Born was paid Rs 15,000 for his IISc stint, which was more than what Cambridge, where he held a temporary position, was paying him at the time. Born and his wife also had an IISc bungalow for accommodation.

But first, the Born-Oppenheimer connection. In 1926, many years before he was to head the Manhattan Project, Oppenheimer left Cambridge for the University of Göttingen – then one of the world's leading centres for theoretical physics – to study under Max Born. This was about three decades before Born would win the physics Nobel.

Raman's Vision

According to IISc's quarterly magazine 'Connect', when Raman was appointed director in 1933, nearly 25 years after IISc was founded, the institute only had four departments: general chemistry, organic chemistry, biochemistry, and electrical technology, leaving research skewed heavily towards industrial applications. "Among his main tasks was to establish a physics department, a recommendation that had been made by two government-appointed review committees, the Pope Committee (1921) and the Sewell Committee (1931)," says the December 2022 issue of the magazine.

He was quick to set up the department, albeit with him as its only faculty member, and initiated investigations in theoretical and experimental physics with his students, leading to several publications of high quality.

But Raman felt that if Bengaluru had to be a world-class centre for physics, it



QUANTUM ENTANGLEMENT: (Clockwise from top) IISc students with Max Born (fourth from left) and his wife Hedi seated on either side of CV Raman. Born – a co-recipient of the 1954 physics Nobel – and his wife in Indian attire in Bengaluru. Oppenheimer in 1957; he had Born for his guide at the University of Göttingen

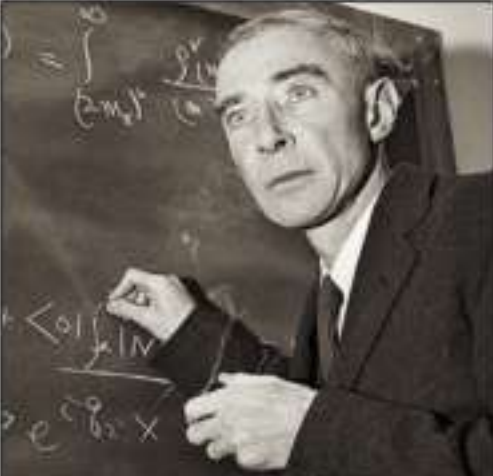
would need world-class physicists. He was particularly keen that IISc become a hub for atomic physics.

Raman's tenure as director coincided with the rise of the Nazi party in Germany and many physicists of Jewish heritage were being forced out of the country. Raman believed he could convince some of them to come to IISc. Former IISc director and Raman's nephew S Ramaseshan says in a Current Science article that Raman identified the gaps in knowledge in India and adopted a strategy of trying to recruit "faculty from among the reputed scientists who were fleeing from the tyranny of Hitler".

Born Comes To IISc

It was around this time that Born was invited to IISc. After exchanging multiple letters, on January 17, 1935, Raman sent Born his appointment letter for the position of Reader in Theoretical Physics. It was a special appointment for six months beginning October 1, 1935, with an honorarium of Rs 15,000.

This was after Raman's initial offer that he take up a permanent position was turned down by Born citing several reasons, including his age – he was 52 then – and the climate. Born had in turn suggested that he would first like to visit IISc for a few months and give lectures. Born's Cambridge University profile page says that although a convert to Lutheranism, Born was tar-



geted for his Jewish descent according to Nazi Germany's anti-Semitic laws. "Fleeing from Germany in 1933, Born accepted the position of Stokes Lecturer of Applied Mathematics at Cambridge before moving to Bengaluru for a period of six months."

"When Born arrived in IISc on September 28, 1935, with his wife Hedi, he was already a distinguished physicist... In the 1920s, along with the likes of Erwin Schrodinger, James Franck, and Werner Heisenberg, he had been instrumental in developing the foundations of quantum mechanics, the theory that describes nature at the scale of atoms and subatomic particles," Connect tells us.

Briton Who Got In The Way Historical notes published by Raman Research Institute (RRI) in 1998 say that "Born enjoyed his stay at IISc and his lectures were greatly appreciated. He found that research students at IISc were very intelligent and accepted Raman's original offer of a permanent position."

However, this was not to be. As per the RRI notes, at a meeting to decide on Born's permanent position, "Raman spoke of the extraordinary merits of Born... Then, unbelievably, an Englishman (little known in the field of either science or engineering) spoke in a most derogatory manner about Born..." Connect identifies the man as Kenneth Aston.



What happened? According to IISc, Raman was keen to create a permanent chair for Born and with the latter being open to the idea, two search committees were set up, one in Bengaluru (led by Raman), and the other in London (led by the physicist Ernest Rutherford). "This seemed a mere formality – both committees were in favour of offering the position to Born."

However, Raman also had to seek the approval of the Senate – the faculty body – and the Council. With some persuasion, he was able to convince them to create a Professorship in Mathematical Physics. During the Senate meeting, Aston, an Englishman recently hired as a professor in the electrical technology department, attacked not just Raman but also Born.

"Aston went up and spoke in a most unpleasant way against Raman's motion, declaring that a second-rank foreigner driven out from his own country was not good enough for them. This was particularly disappointing since we had been kind to the Atons... (they had stayed as guests with the Borns when they arrived until their bungalow was ready). I was so shaken that when I returned to Hedi, I simply cried," Connect quotes Born as having written later. Per the Indian Academy of Sciences archives, between November 1935 and April 1936, Born authored several scientific papers at IISc. Scientists have since lamented India's missed chance to become home to a mind like Born.